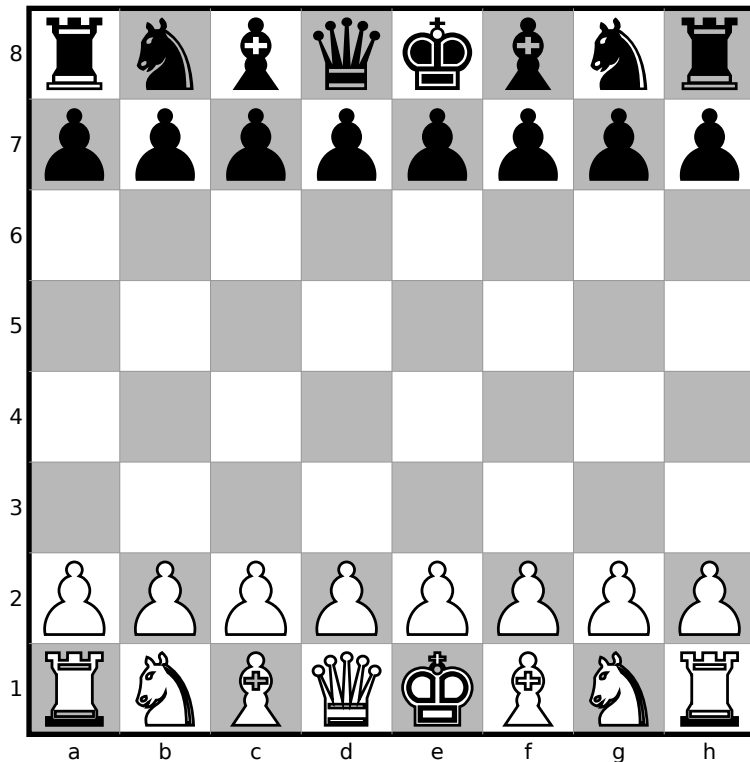


BIRATI CHESS ACADEMY™

CHESS CHAMPION TRAINING WORKBOOK

LEVEL 1

*Build Chess Skills, Solve Challenges,
Improve Your Game!*



For young chess players aged 8-16 • Beginner to early-intermediate

Written by

KUNAL SAHA

BIRATI CHESS ACADEMY™

www.biratichessacademy.com

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CHESS CHAMPION TRAINING WORKBOOK - LEVEL 1

Build Chess Skills, Solve Challenges, Improve Your Game!

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ORIGINAL CONTENT

All explanations, exercises, questions, chess positions, diagrams and page designs in this workbook are original educational content created for this book. The diagrams are drawn as simple vector graphics; no photographs, screenshots or third-party logos are used.

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EDUCATIONAL USE

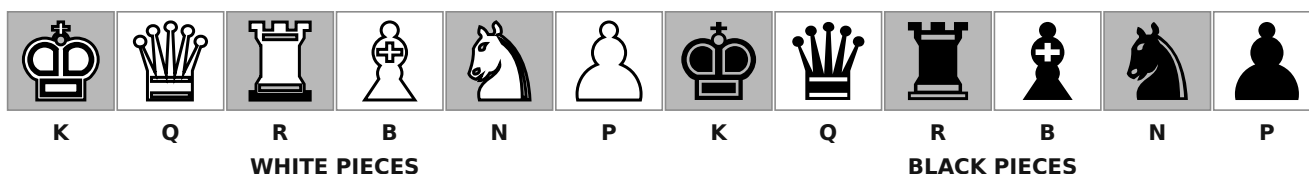
This workbook is written to help students learn and practise chess. Good habits, regular practice and helpful coaching can help players improve, but every learner is different. This book does not promise any tournament result, rating or title.

The rules of chess are explained in simple language for beginners. Tournaments have their own detailed rules, and the decisions of the arbiter (the tournament referee) are final. Always follow the rules of your event.

ABOUT THE DIAGRAMS

White pieces are drawn with a black outline and a white centre; Black pieces are solid black. Unless a caption says otherwise, White starts at the bottom of every diagram and moves up the board.

Piece letters used in this book: **K** = King, **Q** = Queen, **R** = Rook, **B** = Bishop, **N** = Knight, **P** = Pawn (often written with no letter at all).



First edition, 2026. Visit www.biratichessacademy.com

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook is a training course. Work through it in order, one section at a time. Each lesson is short and is followed by exercises to practise what you learned.

For students

- Read the short lesson, then look carefully at every diagram.
- Think first. Write your answer in pencil, then check.
- Write down **why** you chose a move, not only the move.
- Cover the Coach's Answer Key strip until you finish.
- Practise little and often: 20 minutes a day is better than one long session.

For coaches

- Use one section every one or two sessions.
- Use the **Think First** boxes for group discussion.
- Levels A, B and C let you match each student's strength.
- Use the analysis pages after tournament games.

For parents

- You do not need to be a chess player. Ask your child to explain each answer in their own words.
- Praise effort, careful thinking and good questions – not only correct answers.
- Try positions on a real board so your child can see the moves.

Why write the answers?

Writing slows your thinking down. A slow, careful player notices checks, captures and threats that a quick player misses. Writing also shows your coach exactly how you think.

THINK BEFORE YOU MOVE

Before you touch a piece, ask: **What did my opponent just do? Are there checks, captures or threats?** A good move starts with a good question.

HOW TO RECORD MISTAKES

When you get an answer wrong, do not rub it out. Write the correct answer beside it and say what you missed (for example: *I did not see the check*). Then add a tick to the Mistake Log on page 94. Mistakes are the best teachers in chess.

HOW TO READ THE DIAGRAMS

White pieces have a white centre; Black pieces are solid. White moves up the board unless the caption says otherwise. Circled letters (A, B, C) or numbers mark squares you are asked about. A black dot ● shows a square a piece can move to. Files and ranks are labelled around every board.

My details

STUDENT NAME: _____

AGE: _____ **START DATE:** _____

CHESS CLUB / ACADEMY: _____

COACH: _____

My Chess Training Promise

Great players are made by good habits. Read each promise carefully. Tick the box when you agree, then sign at the bottom.

- ☐ **1. I will think before I move.**
I will take a breath and look at the whole board first.
- ☐ **2. I will look for checks, captures and threats.**
I will ask what my opponent wants to do.
- ☐ **3. I will check that my piece is safe.**
I will not let go until I have checked.
- ☐ **4. I will learn from my mistakes.**
I will write them down and try again.
- ☐ **5. I will practise regularly.**
A little practice every day makes me stronger.
- ☐ **6. I will respect my opponent.**
I will also respect the arbiter, my coach and the rules.
- ☐ **7. I will be kind in victory and calm in defeat.**
I will shake hands and say "good game".
- ☐ **8. I will keep trying when a position is difficult.**
Tough puzzles help my brain grow.
- ☐ **9. I will ask questions.**
If I do not understand something, I will ask my coach.
- ☐ **10. I will enjoy chess.**
I will help other players enjoy it too.

"I promise to do my best, to play fair and to keep learning."

Student Signature: _____

Date: _____

Coach / Parent Signature: _____

SECTION 1 • PAGES 5-14

Chess Foundations

Learn the board, the pieces and the rules

Chess is played on a square board with **64 squares**, half light and half dark. To talk about chess, every square needs a name. The name comes from a **file** (a column, letters a-h) and a **rank** (a row, numbers 1-8).

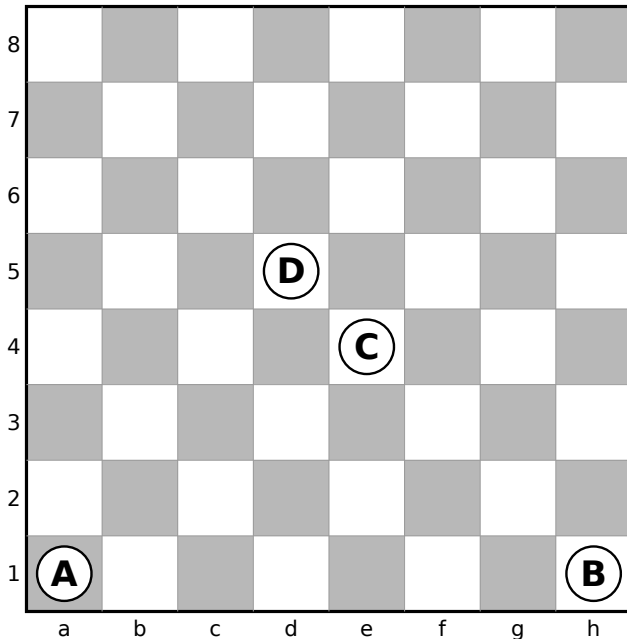


Diagram 1. An empty board. Files a-h run along the bottom; ranks 1-8 run up the side.

KEY FACTS

- **Files** run up and down and have **letters**: a b c d e f g h.
- **Ranks** run across and have **numbers**: 1 to 8.
- A square's name is its **file letter first**, then its **rank number**. The square where the e-file and the 4th rank cross is **e4**.
- The bottom-left corner is **a1**, a **dark** square. Remember: "**light square on the right**" - h1 is light.
- White always sits at the bottom of the diagram.

Exercise 1 - Quick Start Questions

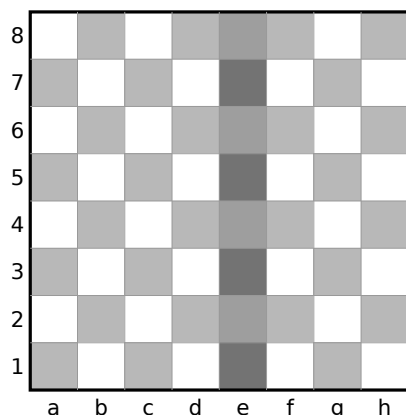
1. Name the circled squares in Diagram 1: A _____ B _____ C _____ D _____
2. How many squares are on a chessboard? _____
3. The columns of the board have the letters _____ to _____ and are called _____.
4. The rows of the board have the numbers _____ to _____ and are called _____.
5. The square a1 is a _____ square. The square h1 is a _____ square.
6. Name the four corner squares of the board: _____
7. Name the four central squares of the board: _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY*(cover this strip while you work)*

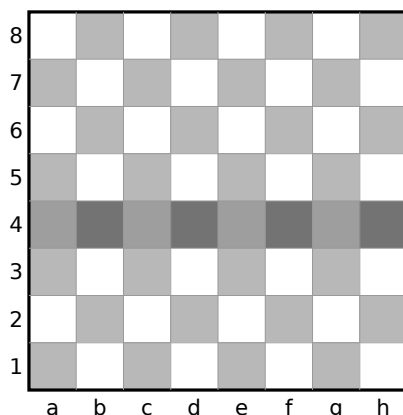
Exercise 1: 1. A = a1, B = h1, C = e4, D = d5 • 2. 64 squares (32 light + 32 dark) • 3. files, a to h • 4. ranks, 1 to 8 • 5. a1 is dark and h1 is light ("light square on the right") • 6. a1, h1, a8, h8 • 7. d4, e4, d5, e5

Files, Ranks and Diagonals

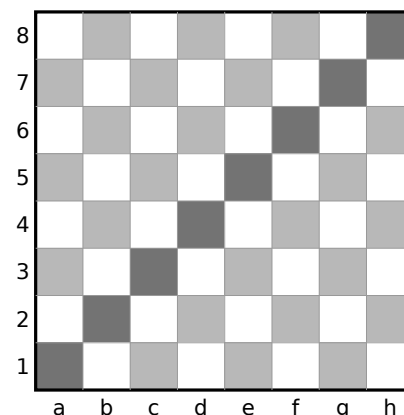
A **file** is a line of squares going **up and down**. A **rank** is a line going **across**. A **diagonal** is a line of squares of the **same colour** that touch corner to corner.



A file: the e-file (e1 to e8).



A rank: the 4th rank (a4 to h4).



A diagonal: a1 to h8.

Exercise 2 - File and Rank Detective

Look at the circled squares in Diagram 2. Fill in the table.

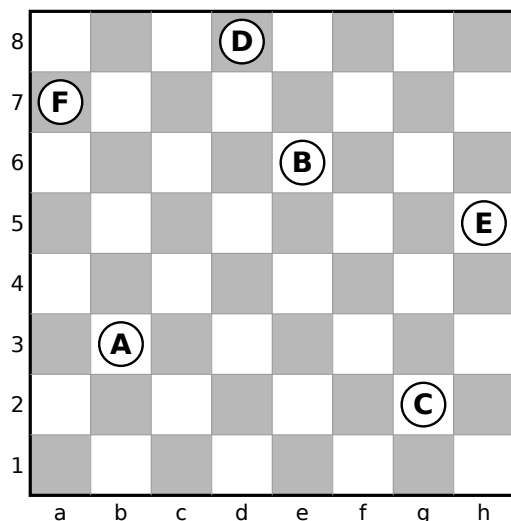


Diagram 2

Circle	File	Rank	Square name
A			
B			
C			
D			
E			
F			

Exercise 3 - True or False? (circle one)

- Files run up and down the board.
- Ranks are named with letters.
- The White pieces start on the 1st and 2nd ranks.
- A chessboard has 8 files and 8 ranks.
- The square e4 is on the e-file and the 4th rank.

TRUE	FALSE
TRUE	FALSE
TRUE	FALSE
TRUE	FALSE
TRUE	FALSE

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

Exercise 2: A = b3 (file b, rank 3); B = e6 (file e, rank 6); C = g2 (file g, rank 2); D = d8 (file d, rank 8); E = h5 (file h, rank 5); F = a7 (file a, rank 7) • **Exercise 3:** 1. True 2. False (ranks use numbers) 3. True 4. True 5. True

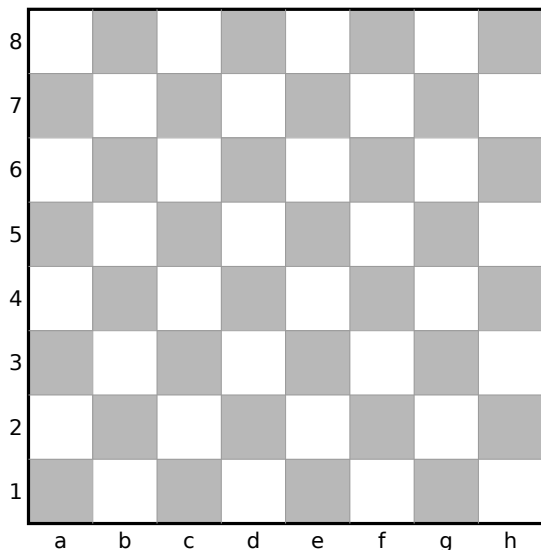
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Name That Square!

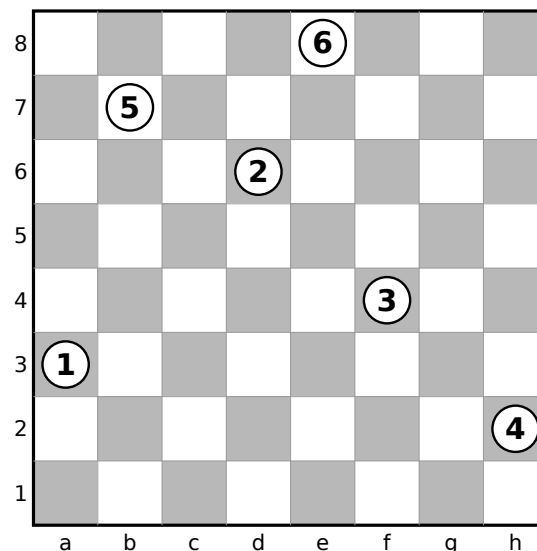
Always say the **file letter first**, then the **rank number**: **e4**, never 4e. Good players can see the name of any square in a blink. Let's train your eyes.

Exercise 4 - Mark and Name

Mark: Put a dot on b2, e5, h8, c7, g3 and f1.



Name: Write the name of each numbered square below.



Names: 1 ____ 2 ____ 3 ____ 4 ____ 5 ____ 6 ____

Light or Dark?

Trick: a1 is dark. Turn the file letter into a number (a = 1, b = 2, ... h = 8) and add the rank number.

Even total = dark square. Odd total = light square.

Square	File no. + Rank	Total	Colour
a1	1 + 1	2	dark
h1	8 + 1	9	light
d4	4 + 4	8	dark
e4	5 + 4	9	light

Exercise 5 - Circle the Colour

Square	Colour	Square	Colour
e4	LIGHT DARK	c4	LIGHT DARK
g2	LIGHT DARK	f6	LIGHT DARK
d1	LIGHT DARK	a8	LIGHT DARK
b7	LIGHT DARK	h3	LIGHT DARK

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 4: Dots on b2, e5, h8, c7, g3, f1. Right board: 1 = a3, 2 = d6, 3 = f4, 4 = h2, 5 = b7, 6 = e8 • **Exercise 5:** e4 light, g2 light, d1 light, b7 light, c4 light, f6 dark, a8 light, h3 light

The Starting Position

Every game starts the same way. Each player has **16 pieces**: 1 king, 1 queen, 2 rooks, 2 bishops, 2 knights and 8 pawns. Learn this picture by heart!

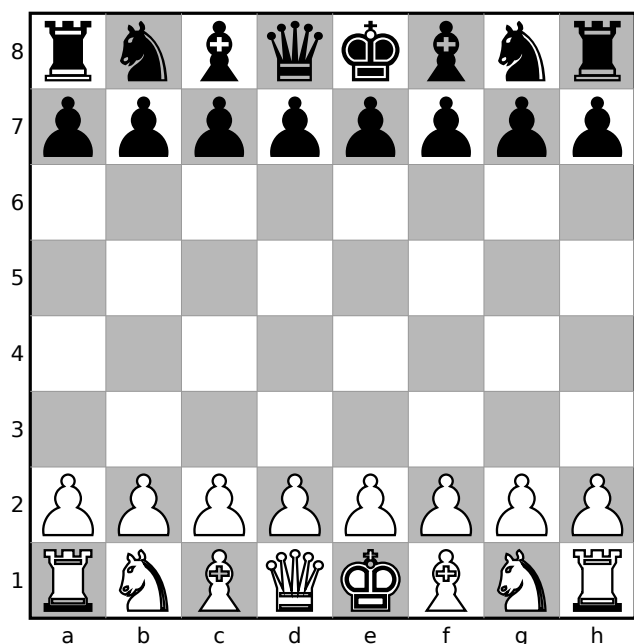


Diagram 3. The starting position.

SET-UP RULES

- **Rooks** go in the corners (a1, h1, a8, h8).
- **Knights** go next to the rooks (b and g files).
- **Bishops** go next to the knights (c and f files).
- **Queens** go on their own colour: the White queen on a *light* square (d1), the Black queen on a *dark* square (d8).
- **Kings** take the last squares, on the e-file.
- **Pawns** fill the 2nd rank (White) and the 7th rank (Black).

Memory trick: "Queen on her colour."

Exercise 6 - Fill in the Blanks

1. The White king starts on _____.
2. The Black queen starts on _____.
3. The White bishops start on _____ and _____.
4. The Black knights start on _____ and _____.
5. The White rooks start on _____ and _____.
6. White's pawns start on rank ____; Black's pawns start on rank ____.
7. The White queen starts on _____, a _____ square.
8. Which two pieces stand between the White bishops? _____

Exercise 7 - Opposite Squares

Each Black piece starts on the same file as its White partner. Fill in the missing square.

White piece	Starts on	Its Black partner starts on
Rook	a1	
Knight	g1	
Queen	d1	
King	e1	
Bishop	c1	
Pawn	e2	

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

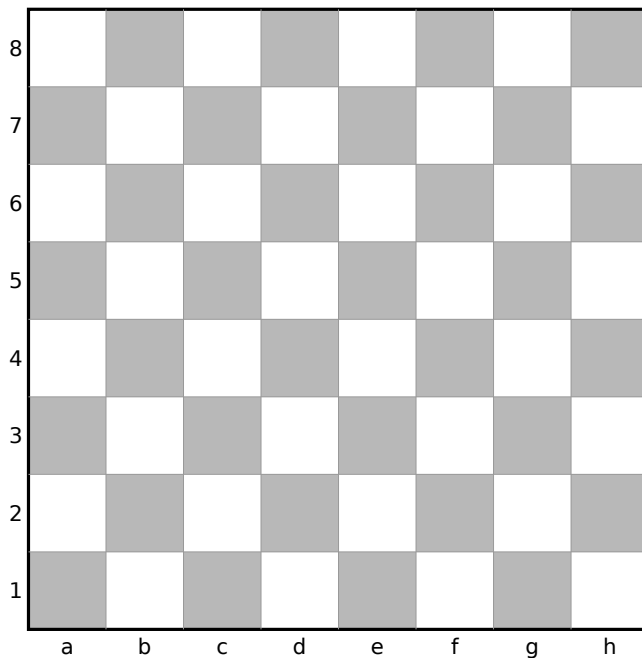
(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 6: 1. e1 2. d8 3. c1 and f1 4. b8 and g8 5. a1 and h1 6. rank 2 (White) and rank 7 (Black) 7. d1, a light square 8. the queen and the king (d1 and e1) • **Exercise 7:** 1. a8, 2. g8, 3. d8, 4. e8, 5. c8, 6. e7

Set Up the Board - Practice

Now set up the pieces yourself, from memory! Use **capital letters** for White (K Q R B N P) and **small letters** for Black (k q r b n p). Then check your work on page 8.

Exercise 8 - Fill the Board



Blank board. Write all 32 pieces.

Exercise 9 - Set-up Checklist

- ☐ A light square is in my right-hand corner.
- ☐ Rooks are in the corners.
- ☐ Knights are next to the rooks.
- ☐ Bishops are next to the knights.
- ☐ Queens are on their own colour.
- ☐ Kings face each other on the e-file.
- ☐ A full row of pawns is in front of each side.

Exercise 10 - Fill the Ranks (write the letters)

Rank	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h
Black - rank 8								
Black - rank 7								
White - rank 2								
White - rank 1								

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

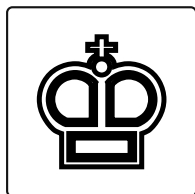
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Exercise 10 (fill the ranks): White rank 1 = R N B Q K B N R; White rank 2 = P P P P P P P; Black rank 7 = p p p p p p p; Black rank 8 = r n b q k b n r. • **Exercise 8:** Compare your board with Diagram 3 on page 8. The White king (e1) faces the Black king (e8), and each queen stands on her own colour.

Know Your Chess Pieces

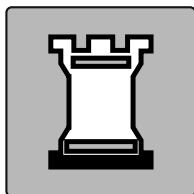
There are six kinds of chess pieces. Learn their names and their letters. Remember: the knight uses **N** because the king already uses K.

Exercise 11 - Name the White pieces (write the name and its letter)



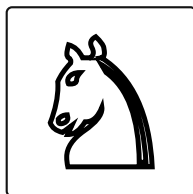
1. _____

Letter: _____



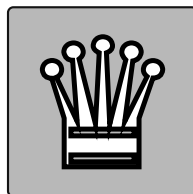
2. _____

Letter: _____



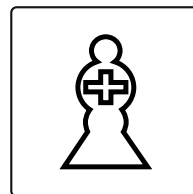
3. _____

Letter: _____



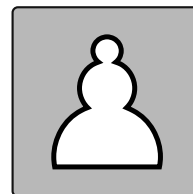
4. _____

Letter: _____



5. _____

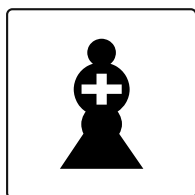
Letter: _____



6. _____

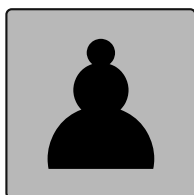
Letter: _____

Exercise 12 - Name the Black pieces (write the name and its letter)



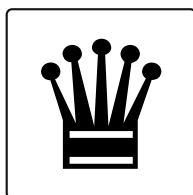
7. _____

Letter: _____



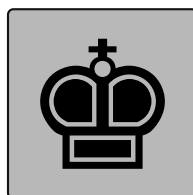
8. _____

Letter: _____



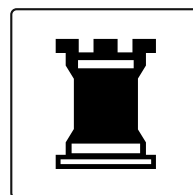
9. _____

Letter: _____



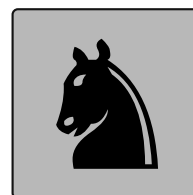
10. _____

Letter: _____



11. _____

Letter: _____



12. _____

Letter: _____

Exercise 13 - Count the Pieces at the Start of a Game

Piece	How many does each player have?	How many on the whole board?
Pawns		
Knights		
Bishops		
Rooks		
Queens		
Kings		
ALL PIECES		

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 11: 1 King (K), 2 Rook (R), 3 Knight (N), 4 Queen (Q), 5 Bishop (B), 6 Pawn (P) • **Exercise 12:** 7 Bishop (B), 8 Pawn (P), 9 Queen (Q), 10 King (K), 11 Rook (R), 12 Knight (N) • **Exercise 13:** Pawns 8 / 16; Knights 2 / 4; Bishops 2 / 4; Rooks 2 / 4; Queens 1 / 2; Kings 1 / 2; ALL PIECES 16 / 32

White, Black and Chess Notation

White always moves first. Then the players take turns, one move each. You may not skip a turn. To record a game, players write each move using a short code called **notation**.

Symbol	Meaning	Example
K Q R B N	King, Queen, Rook, Bishop, Knight (pawns have no letter)	Nf3 = knight to f3
no letter	A pawn move	e4 = pawn to e4
x	Captures	Bxc6 = bishop captures on c6
+	Check	Qh5+ = queen gives check
#	Checkmate	Qh7# = queen gives mate
O-O / O-O-O	Castling: kingside / queenside	O-O = short castling
=	Promotion	e8=Q = pawn becomes a queen

Exercise 14 - Read the Move

Write each move in words.

1. **Nf3** means:

2. **e4** means:

3. **Bc4** means:

4. **Qxd5** means:

5. **Rxa8+** means:

6. **O-O** means:

Exercise 15 - Write the Move

1. A knight goes to c6: _____

2. A pawn goes to d4: _____

3. A bishop captures on e5: _____

4. A queen gives checkmate on h7: _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 14: 1. Nf3 = A knight moves to f3. 2. e4 = A pawn moves to e4. 3. Bc4 = A bishop moves to c4. 4. Qxd5 = A queen captures a piece on d5. 5. Rxa8+ = A rook captures on a8 and gives check. 6. O-O = The king castles on the kingside (short castling). • **Exercise 15:** 1. Nc6 2. d4 3. Bxe5 4. Qh7#

How the Pieces Move - Overview

You will study each piece in Section 2. Here is a quick map to look back at.

Piece	How it moves	Can it jump?
	King – one square in any direction.	No
	Queen – any number of squares along a rank, file or diagonal.	No
	Rook – any number of squares along a rank or file.	No
	Bishop – any number of squares along a diagonal.	No
	Knight – two squares one way, then one square sideways (an L-shape).	Yes!
	Pawn – forward one square (two from its start square); captures diagonally forward.	No

Exercise 16 - Which Piece Am I?

1. "I move in an L-shape and I can jump over other pieces." _____
2. "I move along ranks and files, and I start in a corner." _____
3. "I move along diagonals and I always stay on one colour." _____
4. "I can move like a rook or like a bishop. I am the strongest piece." _____
5. "If I am checkmated, the game is over." _____
6. "I move straight ahead, but I capture diagonally." _____

Exercise 17 - Quick Fire

Which piece is the answer? Write it after each clue.

1. Moves in straight lines only: _____
2. Moves diagonally only: _____
3. The only piece that jumps: _____
4. Moves in all eight directions, any distance: _____
5. Can be promoted to something else: _____
6. Moves one square only, in any direction: _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

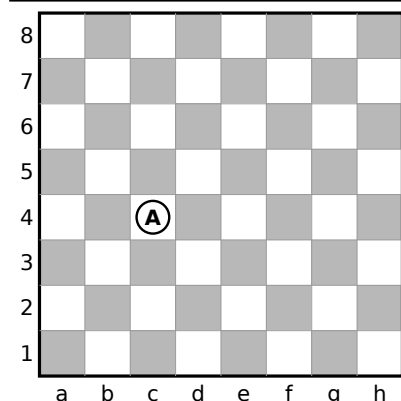
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Exercise 16: 1. Knight 2. Rook 3. Bishop 4. Queen 5. King 6. Pawn • **Exercise 17:** 1. Rook 2. Bishop 3. Knight 4. Queen 5. Pawn 6. King

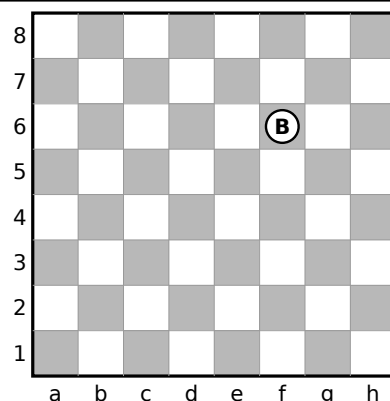
Foundations Workout 1

Time to test yourself! Write your answers in pencil.

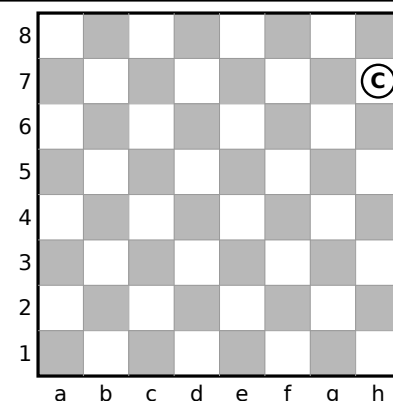
Exercise 18 - Name the Square and Its Colour



A. Square: _____ Colour: _____



B. Square: _____ Colour: _____

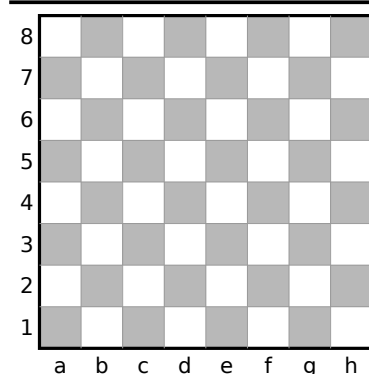


C. Square: _____ Colour: _____

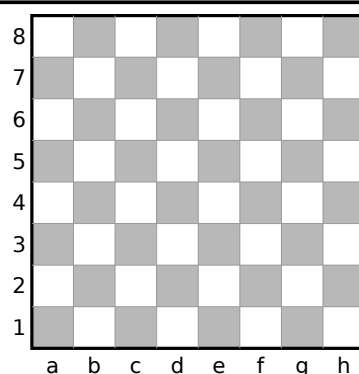
Exercise 19 - Mixed Questions

- How many squares are on a chessboard? (A) 32 (B) 64 (C) 81 (D) 100
- Which square is on the d-file and the 5th rank? _____
- Which of these is the name of a **file**? (a) 5 (b) f (c) 12
- The square e4 is a _____ square. (light / dark)
- The square h1 is a _____ square. (light / dark)
- The White queen starts on _____.
- True or False: Black moves first in a game of chess. _____
- True or False: The rooks start in the corners. _____
- Which two pieces stand between the White bishops at the start? _____
- Which letters name the files? _____ to _____

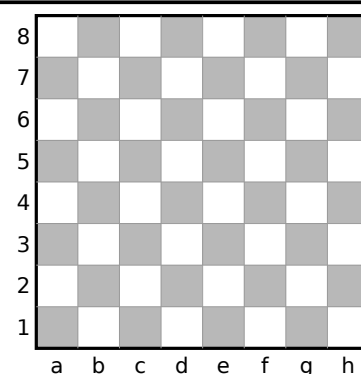
Exercise 20 - Draw on the Boards



A. Shade the **c-file**.



B. Shade the **6th rank**.



C. Put dots on the **4 central squares**.

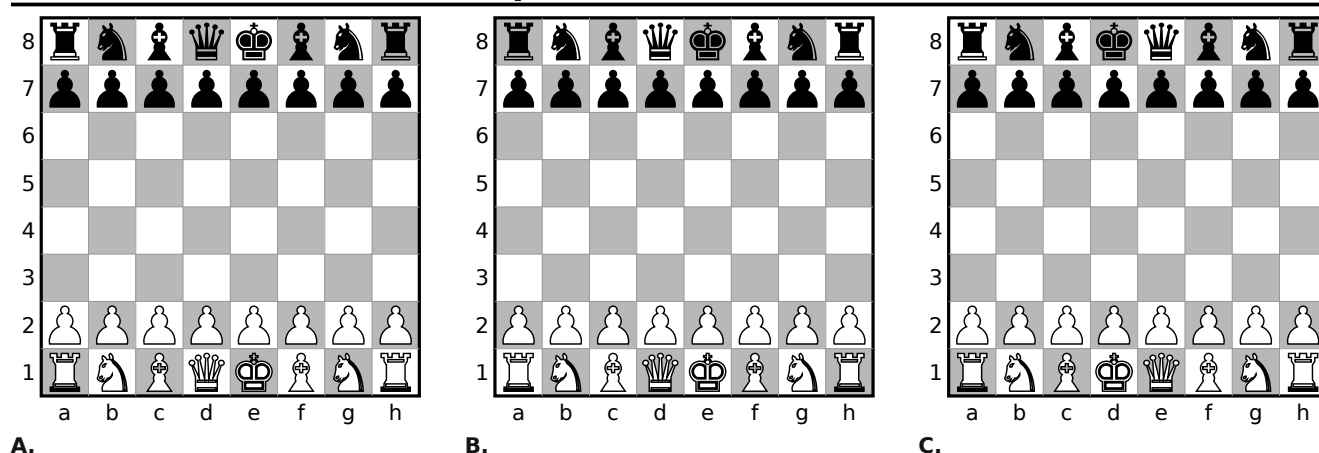
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

Exercise 18: A = c4 (light), B = f6 (dark), C = h7 (light) • **Exercise 19:** 1. B (64) 2. d5 3. f 4. light 5. light 6. d1 7. False (White moves first) 8. True 9. the queen and the king 10. a to h • **Exercise 20:** Shade all of c1-c8; shade all of a6-h6; dots on d4, e4, d5 and e5.

(cover this strip while you work)

Foundations Workout 2

Exercise 21 - Which Set-up Is Correct?



A.

B.

C.

The correct set-up is Diagram _____. Why are the other two wrong?

Exercise 22 - Legal or Illegal Start?

At the very **start** of a game, is each piece placement legal or illegal? Circle your answer.

#	Placement at the start of the game	Your answer	
1	A White knight on b1	LEGAL	ILLEGAL
2	A White queen on e1	LEGAL	ILLEGAL
3	A Black king on e8	LEGAL	ILLEGAL
4	A Black rook on b8	LEGAL	ILLEGAL
5	A White pawn on e3	LEGAL	ILLEGAL
6	A Black bishop on c8	LEGAL	ILLEGAL

Section 1 Checkpoint

Tick each box when you are sure. If not, look back at that page.

- ☐ I can name any square on the board.
- ☐ I can tell a file from a rank.
- ☐ I can tell if a square is light or dark.
- ☐ I can set up all 32 pieces from memory.
- ☐ I can read simple chess notation.

Exercises 21-22 score: ____ / 7

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 21: Diagram A is correct (a light square in the right-hand corner and each queen on her own colour). In B the board is turned the wrong way (a1 is light). In C the kings and queens are swapped. • **Exercise 22:** 1. Legal 2. Illegal (the queen starts on d1) 3. Legal 4. Illegal (rooks start on a8 and h8) 5. Illegal (the pawn starts on e2) 6. Legal

SECTION 2 • PAGES 15-24

Know Your Pieces

King • Queen • Rook • Bishop • Knight • Pawn

The King

The king is the most important piece. If your king is checkmated, you lose the game! The king moves **one square in any direction**: up, down, sideways or diagonally.

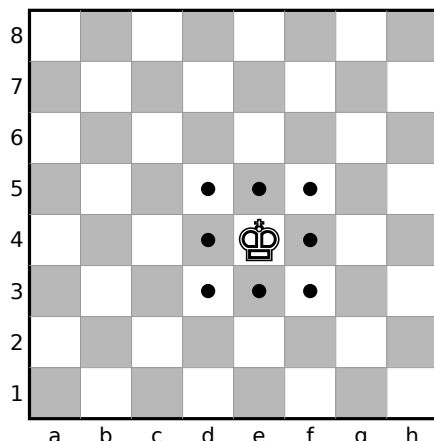


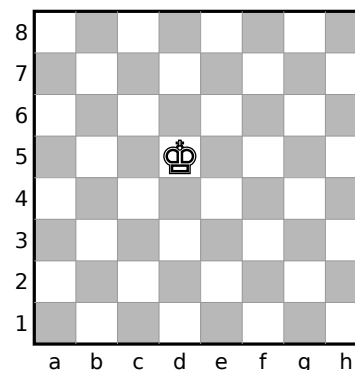
Diagram 1. A king can move to any dotted square.

KING RULES

- The king moves **one square** in any direction.
- The king may **never move into check** (onto a square attacked by an enemy piece).
- The king may capture an enemy piece only if that piece is **not protected**.
- Two kings can **never stand next to each other**.
- The king has a special move with a rook called **castling** (see Section 3).

Exercise 1 - Mark the King's Moves

Put a dot on every square the White king on d5 can move to. How many are there? _____



Exercise 2 - Legal or Illegal?

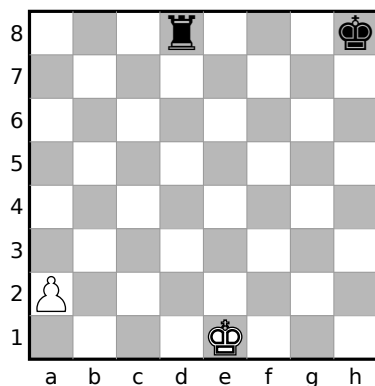


Diagram 2. White to move.

The White king is on e1. Write LEGAL or ILLEGAL for each king move.

1. Kd1 _____
2. Kd2 _____
3. Ke2 _____
4. Kf2 _____
5. Kf1 _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 1: c4, d4, e4, c5, e5, c6, d6, e6 (8 squares). • **Exercise 2:** 1. Kd1 illegal (rook on d8 attacks d1) 2. Kd2 illegal (rook attacks d2) 3. Ke2 legal 4. Kf2 legal 5. Kf1 legal.

The Queen

The queen is the most powerful piece. She moves like a **rook and a bishop together**: any number of squares along a rank, a file or a diagonal. She **cannot jump** over other pieces.

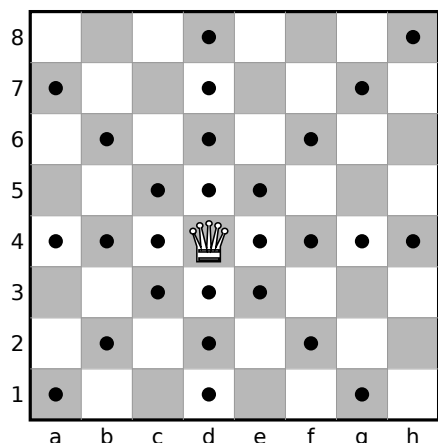


Diagram 3. The queen on d4 controls 27 squares.

COMMON QUEEN MISTAKES

- Bringing the queen out **too early**. Enemy pieces can chase her with tempo.
- Leaving the queen **unprotected** where a pawn or knight can attack her.
- Forgetting that a **less valuable piece** can capture her.
- Grabbing a pawn and getting the queen **trapped**.

Exercise 3 - Count the Squares

1. On an empty board, how many squares can a queen on **d4** move to? _____
2. On an empty board, how many squares can a queen in the corner **a1** move to? _____
3. Why does the queen on d4 have more squares than the queen on a1?

Exercise 4 - What Can the Queen Capture?

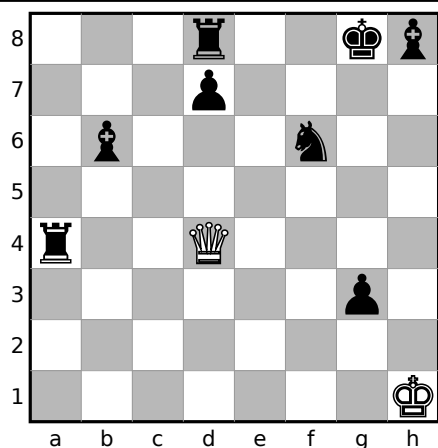


Diagram 4. White to move.

List every Black piece the White queen on d4 can capture, and say which Black pieces she **cannot** capture and why.

Exercise 5 - True or False?

1. The queen can jump over pieces. _____
2. The queen is worth more than a rook. _____
3. It is always a good idea to bring the queen out on move 1. _____
4. The queen can move like a rook and like a bishop. _____
5. A pawn can capture a queen. _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 3: 1. 27 squares 2. 21 squares 3. The queen on d4 is in the centre, so she has the most squares. • **Exercise 4:** She can capture on a4, b6, d7 and f6. She cannot capture the rook on d8 or the bishop on h8 (other pieces are in the way) or g3 (it is not on her lines). • **Exercise 5:** 1. False 2. True 3. False 4. True 5. True

The Rook

The rook moves **any number of squares along a rank or a file**. It **cannot jump** and it cannot move diagonally. Rooks start in the corners, and they work best on **open files** – files with no pawns on them.

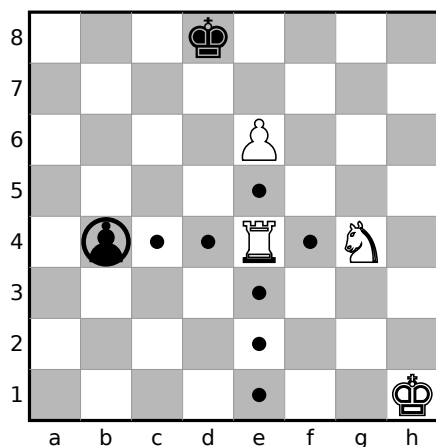


Diagram 5. Dots = moves. Ring = capture. The rook cannot jump over its own pieces.

ROOK FACTS

- The rook is worth about **5 pawns**.
- A rook on an **open file** is powerful.
- Two rooks that protect each other are called **connected rooks**.
- The rook joins the king in **castling**.

Exercise 7 - Where Can the Rook Go?

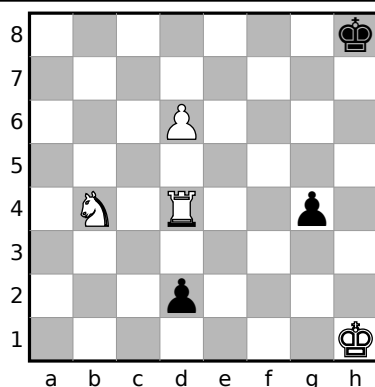


Diagram 6. White to move.

The White rook is on d4. Write down **every square it can move to** (moves and captures).

How many squares? _____

Exercise 8 - Open Files

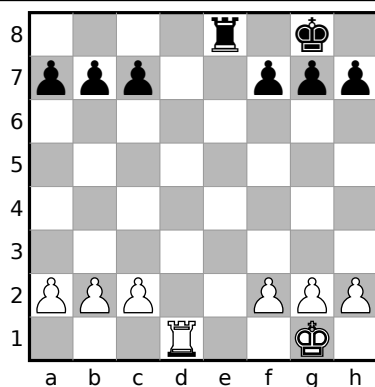


Diagram 7.

1. Which files are open (no pawns at all)? _____

2. Why are rooks strong on open files?

3. Which two rooks are already on open files?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 6: Dots: c4, d4, e1, e2, e3, e5, f4. Capture: b4 (Rxb4). • **Exercise 7:** The rook can reach 7 squares: c4, d2, d3, d5, e4, f4, g4. Captures: d2, g4. • **Exercise 8:** 1. The d-file and the e-file are open (no pawns on them). 2. Rooks are strongest on open files because they can travel far and attack the enemy position. 3. Rd1 and Re8.

The Bishop

The bishop moves **any number of squares along a diagonal**. It cannot jump. A bishop always stays on the **same colour** of square it started on.

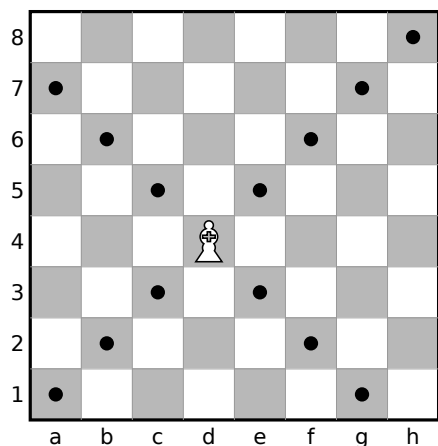


Diagram 8. A bishop on d4 can reach 13 squares (all dark).

BISHOP FACTS

- Each player has **two bishops**: one light-squared and one dark-squared.
- Together they cover **all 64 squares**. This is called the **bishop pair**.
- A bishop is worth about **3 pawns**.
- Bishops are strongest on **long open diagonals**.

Exercise 9 - Can the Bishop Get There?

A bishop starts on **c1** (on an empty board). For each square below, write **1 move**, **2 moves** or **never**.

Target square	d2	d1	e5	b1	h6	f5
Moves needed						

Exercise 10 - Which Bishop?

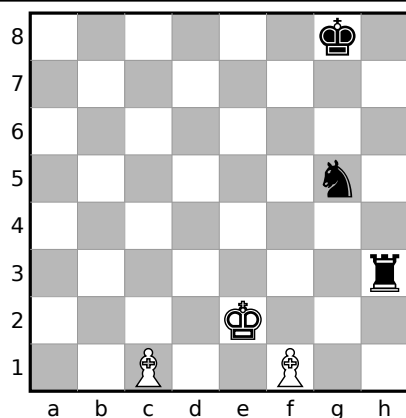


Diagram 9. White to move.

1. Which White bishop can capture the rook on h3? _____
2. Which White bishop can capture the knight on g5? _____
3. Which bishop is light-squared and which is dark-squared?

Exercise 11 - True or False?

1. A bishop can change to a square of the other colour. _____
2. A bishop can move along a file. _____
3. The two bishops together can reach every square. _____
4. A bishop can jump over a pawn. _____
5. A bishop is usually worth the same as a knight. _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 9: d2: 1 move, d1: never, e5: 2 moves, b1: never, h6: 1 move, f5: never. (c1 is a dark square, so the bishop can only ever reach dark squares.) • **Exercise 10:** 1. The bishop on f1 captures the rook on h3 (Bxh3). 2. The bishop on c1 captures the knight on g5 (Bxg5). 3. The f1 bishop is light-squared; the c1 bishop is dark-squared. • **Exercise 11:** 1. True 2. False 3. True 4. False 5. True

The Knight

The knight moves in an **L-shape**: two squares in one direction, then one square sideways. It is the only piece that can **jump over** other pieces. Every knight move goes to a square of the **opposite colour**.

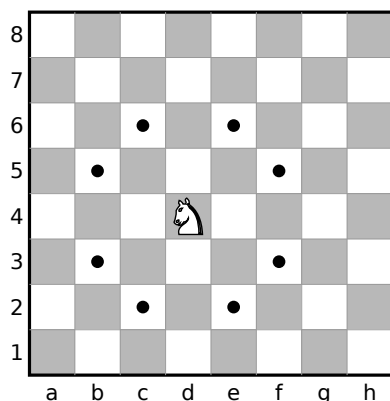


Diagram 10. A knight on d4 can jump to 8 squares.

KNIGHT FACTS

- A knight is worth about **3 pawns**.
- It is strongest in the **centre**; on the edge it controls fewer squares.
- A knight attacks up to **8 squares**.
- A knight can attack **two pieces at once**. This is called a **fork**.

Exercise 12 - The Knight's Journey

On an empty board, what is the **smallest number of knight moves** needed to travel from one square to the other?

From	g1	g1	b1	b1	a1	e4
To	f3	e4	d4	h8	c3	e5
Moves						

Exercise 13 - Jump!

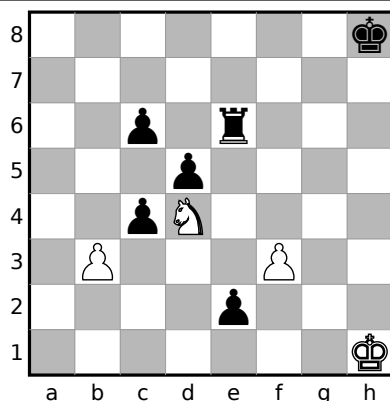


Diagram 11. White to move.

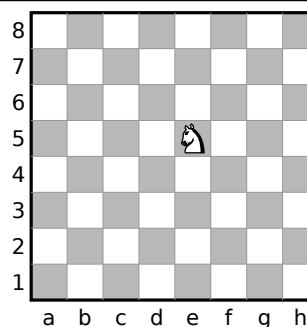
The White knight on d4 is surrounded! Write down **every square** it can move to (moves and captures).

Which of those moves are captures?

Why can the knight not go to b3 or f3?

Exercise 14 - Mark the Attacks

Put a dot on every square the White knight on e5 attacks. How many? _____



COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 12: g1→f3: 1, g1→e4: 3, b1→d4: 3, b1→h8: 5, a1→c3: 4, e4→e5: 3 moves. • **Exercise 13:** The knight on d4 can move to b5, c2, c6, e2, e6, f5. Captures: c6, e2, e6. It cannot go to b3 or f3 (its own pawns). • **Exercise 14:** A knight on e5 attacks c4, c6, d3, d7, f3, f7, g4, g6 (8 squares).

The Pawn

Pawns are small but very important. A pawn moves **straight forward** but **captures diagonally**. It can never move backwards. If a pawn reaches the far end of the board, it is **promoted**!

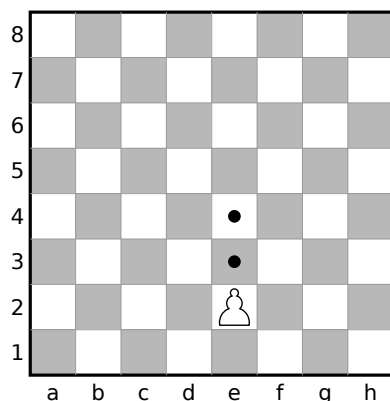


Diagram 12. From its start square a pawn may move one or two squares forward.

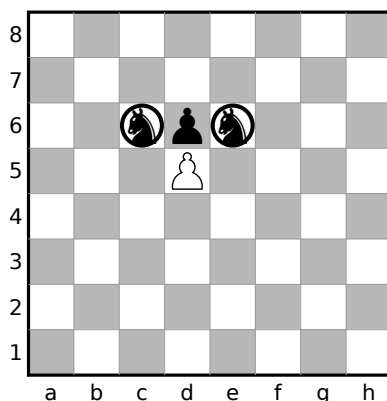


Diagram 13. A pawn captures one square diagonally forward (rings). It cannot capture straight ahead.

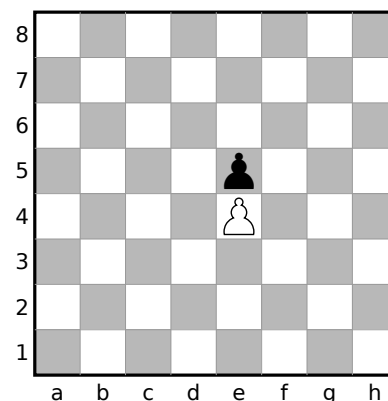


Diagram 14. Two pawns that face each other are blocked. Neither can move forward.

PAWN RULES

- Forward only: **one square** at a time (two squares on its very first move).
- Captures **one square diagonally forward**.
- A blocked pawn cannot move. A pawn cannot capture a piece straight in front of it.
- On the 8th rank (for White) a pawn **promotes** to a queen, rook, bishop or knight.
- There is a special pawn capture called **en passant** (see Section 3).

Exercise 15 - Legal or Illegal Pawn Move?

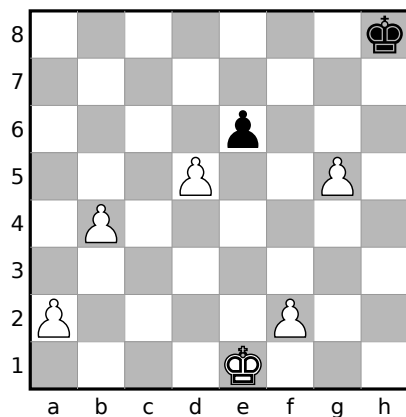


Diagram 15. White to move.

Write LEGAL or ILLEGAL for each White pawn move.

1. a2-a4 _____
2. b4-b6 _____
3. d5xe6 _____
4. d5-d6 _____
5. f2xg3 _____
6. g5-g4 _____

Exercise 16 - Promotion

1. A pawn that reaches the 8th rank can become a _____, a _____, a _____ or a _____.
2. A pawn can **never** become a _____ or stay a _____.
3. Which piece do most players choose, and why?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

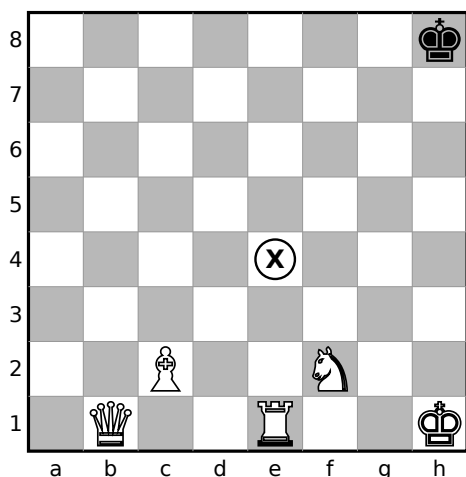
Exercise 15: 1. a2-a4 legal (first move: two squares). 2. b4-b6 illegal (only one square after the first move). 3. d5xe6 legal (captures diagonally). 4. d5-d6 legal (one square forward, d6 is empty). 5. f2xg3 illegal (nothing on g3 to capture). 6. g5-g4 illegal (pawns never move backwards). • **Exercise 16:** A pawn can become a queen, rook, bishop or knight - never a king or a pawn. Most players choose the queen. A knight is sometimes better when it gives an immediate check or fork.

Which Piece Can Reach the Square?

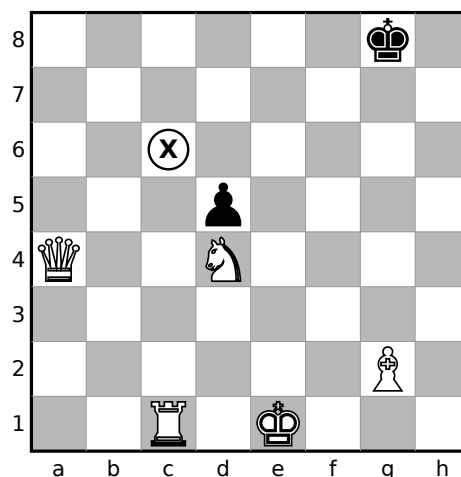
To choose a good move you must know exactly **where each piece can go**. Remember: pieces (except the knight) cannot jump over other pieces, and a pawn moves straight ahead when it is not capturing.

Exercise 17 - Find the Pieces

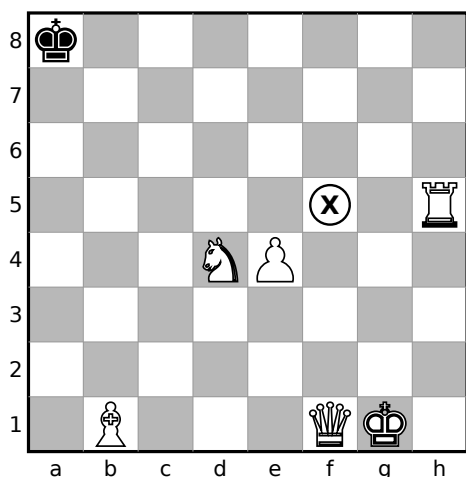
In each diagram, write the letter and square of **every White piece** that can move to the circled X in one move (for example: R e1).



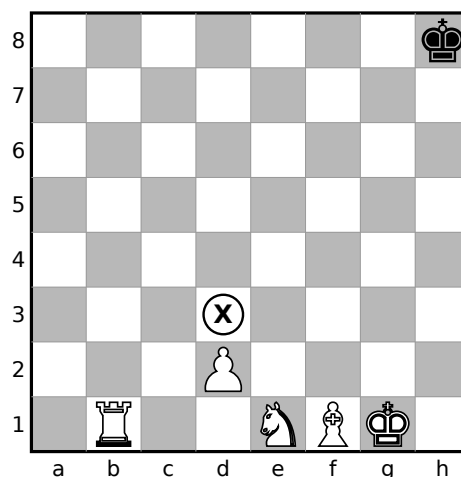
A. White to move. Which White pieces can move to X?



B. White to move. Which White pieces can move to X?



C. White to move. Which White pieces can move to X?



D. White to move. Which White pieces can move to X?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

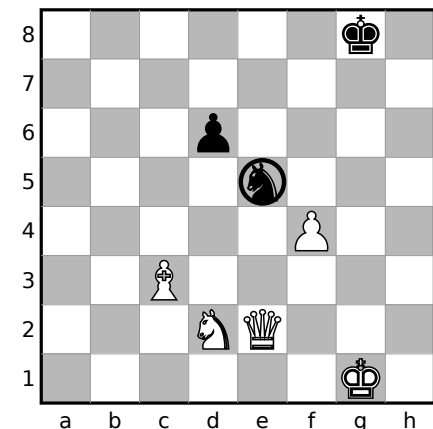
(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 17: **A** Bc2, Re1, Nf2; **B** Qa4, Rc1, Nd4; **C** Nd4, Qf1, Rh5; **D** pawn d2, Ne1, Bf1. (In A the queen on b1 is blocked by the bishop on c2; in B the bishop on g2 is blocked by the pawn on d5; in C the bishop on b1 is blocked by the pawn on e4; a pawn moves straight, so it can reach only the square in front of it.)

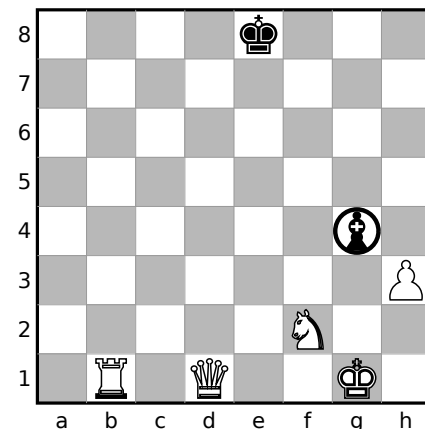
Attack and Protect

A piece is **attacked** when an enemy piece could capture it on the next move. A piece is **protected** (or defended) when a friendly piece could recapture if it is taken. Before you move, always ask: **What is attacked? What is protected?**

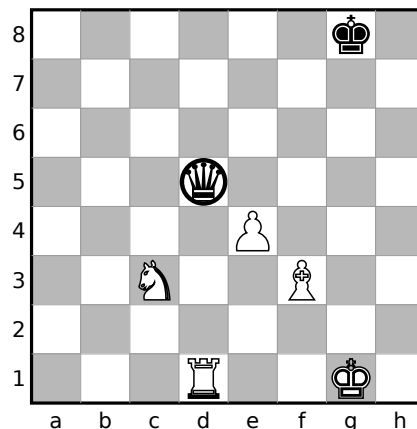
Exercise 18 - Who Attacks?



A. Which White pieces attack the ringed Black piece?



B. Which White pieces attack the ringed Black piece?



C. Which White pieces attack the ringed Black piece?

Exercise 19 - Attackers and Protectors

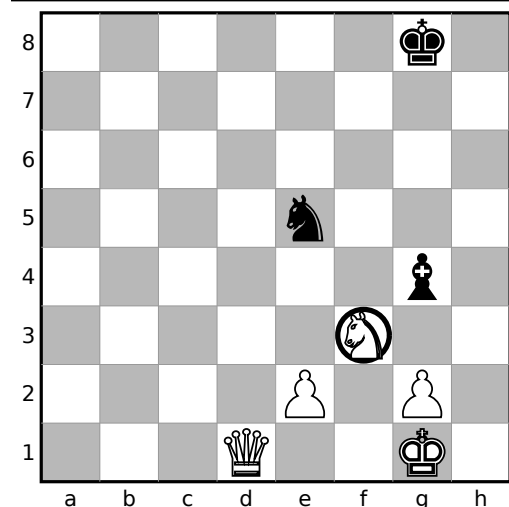


Diagram 16. Look at the ringed White knight.

1. Which Black pieces attack the knight on f3?

2. Which White pieces protect the knight on f3?

3. Does the White queen protect f3? Why or why not?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

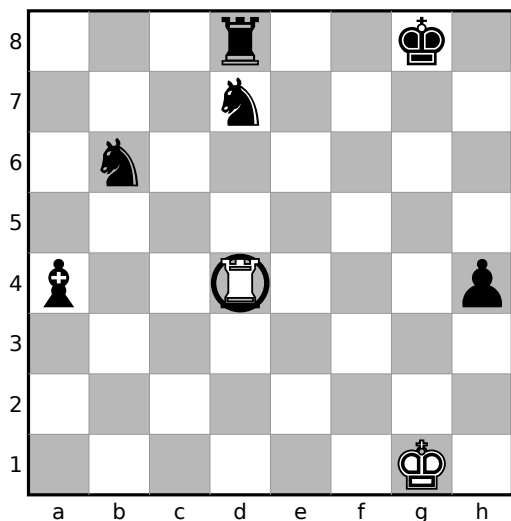
Exercise 18: **A** bishop c3, queen e2, pawn f4; **B** queen d1, knight f2, pawn h3; **C** knight c3, rook d1, pawn e4. (In C the bishop on f3 is blocked by the pawn on e4, so it does not attack the queen.) • **Exercise 19:** 1. Attackers: bishop g4 and knight e5 (2). 2. Protectors: pawn e2 and pawn g2 (2). 3. The queen on d1 does not protect f3 because the pawn on e2 blocks her.

What Can It Capture?

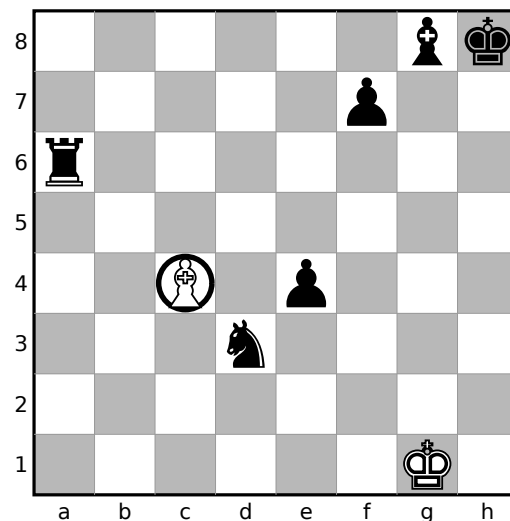
A capture is a move that lands on an enemy piece and removes it from the board. Each piece captures the **same way it moves** (the pawn is the only exception). A king may capture only a piece that is **not protected**.

Exercise 20 - Find the Captures

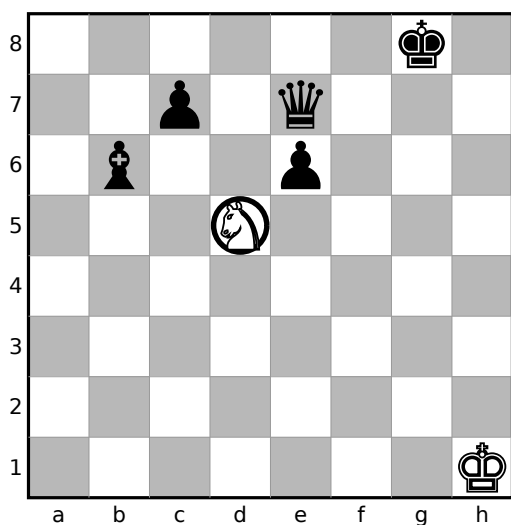
Write the squares of the Black pieces the ringed White piece can capture (for example: a4, h4).



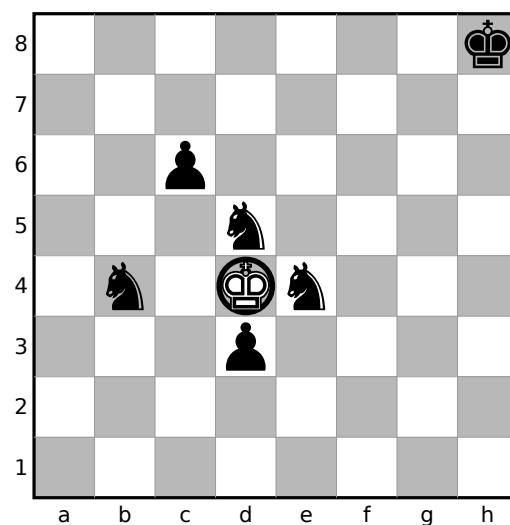
A. White to move. List every capture the ringed White rook can make.



B. White to move. List every capture the ringed White bishop can make.



C. White to move. List every capture the ringed White knight can make.



D. White to move. List every capture the ringed White king can make.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

Exercise 20: **A** a4, d7, h4; **B** a6, d3, f7; **C** b6, c7, e7; **D** e4. (A: the rook cannot capture the knight on b6 or the rook on d8 – one is off its lines, one is blocked. D: the king cannot capture d5 or d3 because those pieces are protected.)

(cover this strip while you work)

Section 2 Check-Up

Exercise 21 - Which Piece Made the Move? (empty board)

Each move happens on an empty board. Write every kind of piece that could make it in one move.

#	Move	Which piece(s)?
1	g1 → f3	
2	a1 → a5	
3	c1 → g5	
4	d4 → f6	
5	e4 → e5	
6	h8 → a8	

Exercise 22 - Which Is Worth More?

Pair	Circle the answer		
Queen or Rook	FIRST	SECOND	EQUAL
Rook or Knight	FIRST	SECOND	EQUAL
Bishop or Pawn	FIRST	SECOND	EQUAL
Knight or Bishop	FIRST	SECOND	EQUAL
Rook or Queen	FIRST	SECOND	EQUAL

Exercise 23 - Piece Passport

Complete the table. Write how each piece moves, whether it can jump, and about how many pawns it is worth.

Piece	How it moves	Can it jump?	Worth (pawns)
King			
Queen			
Rook			
Bishop			
Knight			
Pawn			

Exercise 24 - Mystery Piece

Write the name of each mystery piece.

- Moves forward, captures diagonally: _____
- If I am checkmated the game ends: _____
- I jump in an L-shape: _____
- I start in the corners: _____
- I never leave my colour: _____
- I move like a rook and a bishop: _____

Section 2 score: ____ / 23

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 21: 1. Knight 2. Rook or Queen 3. Bishop or Queen 4. Bishop or Queen 5. King, Queen, Rook or Pawn (White) 6. Rook or Queen • **Exercise 22:** 1. Queen 2. Rook 3. Bishop 4. equal (both about 3) 5. Queen • **Exercise 23:** King: one square, no jump, value: priceless. Queen: rook + bishop, no jump, about 9. Rook: ranks and files, no jump, about 5. Bishop: diagonals, no jump, about 3. Knight: L-shape, jumps, about 3. Pawn: forward, no jump, about 1. • **Exercise 24:** 1. Pawn 2. King 3. Knight 4. Rook 5. Bishop 6. Queen

SECTION 3 • PAGES 25-32

Rules & Special Moves

Check • Checkmate • Castling • En passant • Promotion

Check

A king is in **check** when an enemy piece attacks it. You must **always** get out of check at once. You are never allowed to make a move that leaves your own king in check.

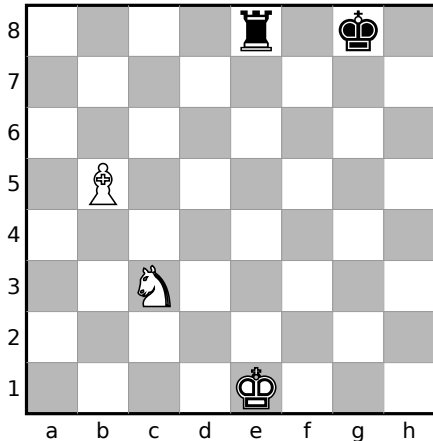


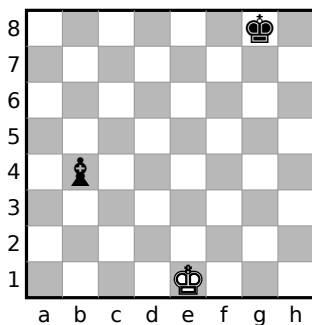
Diagram 1. The White king is in check from the rook on e8. White must answer the check.

THREE WAYS TO ANSWER A CHECK

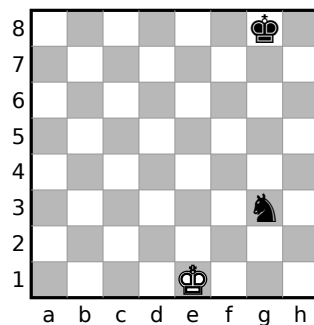
- 1. Move** the king to a safe square.
- 2. Block** the line between the attacker and the king (this does not work against a knight, which jumps).
- 3. Capture** the piece that gives check.

If none of these is possible, it is **checkmate**.

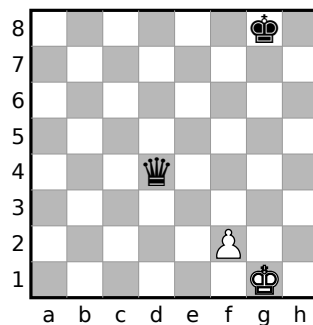
Exercise 1 - Is the King in Check?



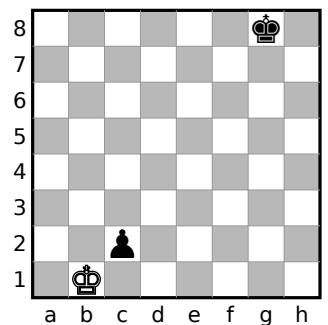
A. Is the White king in check?
YES / NO



B. Is the White king in check?
YES / NO



C. Is the White king in check?
YES / NO



D. Is the White king in check?
YES / NO

Exercise 2 - Answer the Check

In Diagram 1, find **every** legal move for White. Write them under the right heading.

Capture the checker	Block the check	Move the king

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 1: A YES, B NO, C NO, D YES. (In B the knight on g3 does not attack e1. In C the pawn on f2 blocks the queen.) • **Exercise 2:** Capture the checker: Bxe8. Block: Be2, Ne2 or Ne4. Move the king: Kd1, Kd2, Kf1, Kf2. Not a way out: any move that leaves the rook on e8 attacking the king.

Checkmate

Checkmate means the king is in check and there is **no way out**: it cannot move to safety, the check cannot be blocked and the attacker cannot be captured. The game ends at once and the player who delivered checkmate **wins**. (The king is never really captured.)

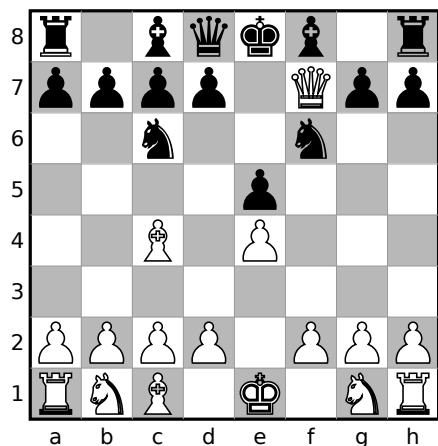


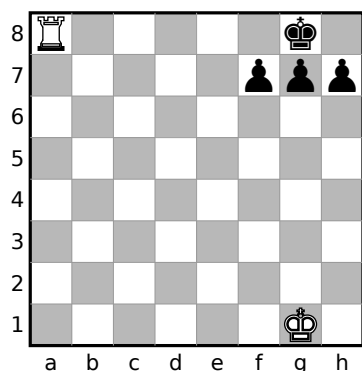
Diagram 2. Scholar's Mate: 1.e4 e5
2.Bc4 Nc6 3.Qh5 Nf6?? 4.Qxf7#

DON'T FALL FOR IT!

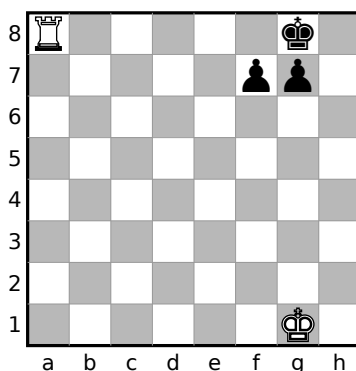
- The queen and bishop aim at the weak f7 square. It is guarded only by the king.
- After 3.Qh5, good defences are **3...g6** (it attacks the queen), **3...Qe7** or **3...Nh6**. Then f7 is safe.
- Beginners fall for this trap again and again - look before you move!

Exercise 3 - Checkmate, Check or Neither?

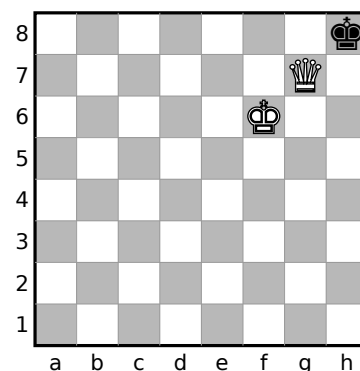
In each diagram it is **Black's move**. Write **CHECKMATE**, **CHECK** (Black can escape) or **NEITHER** under the diagram.



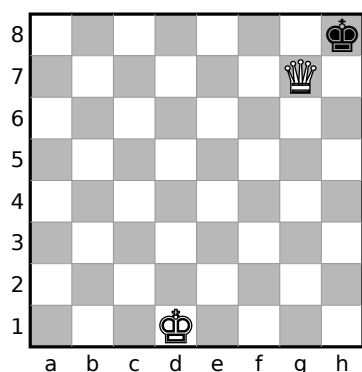
A. Black to move.



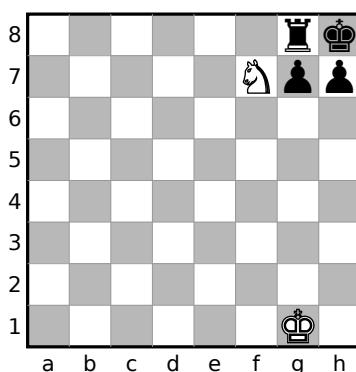
B. Black to move.



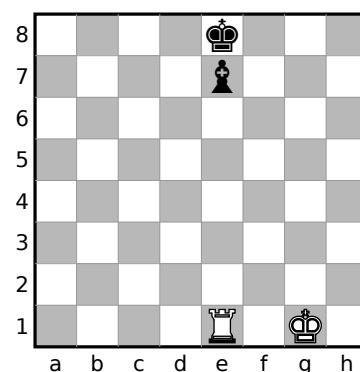
C. Black to move.



D. Black to move.



E. Black to move.



F. Black to move.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 3: A CHECKMATE (the king has no escape square); B CHECK (the king can step to h7); C CHECKMATE (the queen is protected by the king, so it cannot be captured); D CHECK (the king can capture the unprotected queen); E CHECKMATE (the knight cannot be captured and the king is boxed in); F NEITHER (the bishop on e7 blocks the rook).

Stalemate and Draws

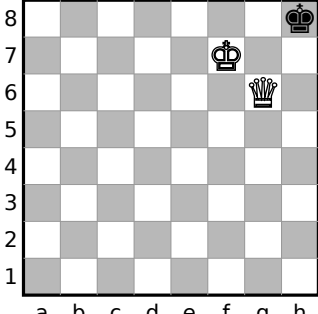
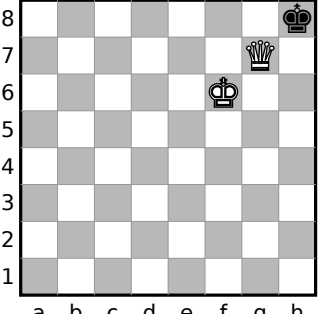
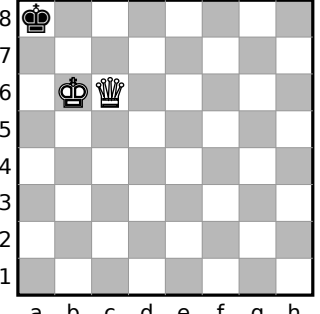
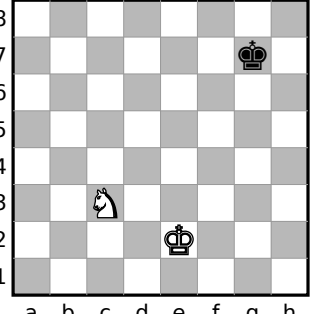
A game does not always end with a winner. If the player to move is **not in check** but has **no legal move**, it is **stalemate** and the game is a **draw** (a tie).

WAYS A GAME CAN BE DRAWN

- **Stalemate:** no legal move and not in check.
- **Agreement:** both players agree to a draw.
- **Threefold repetition:** the same position appears three times (a player may claim the draw).
- **Fifty-move rule:** 50 moves by each side with no pawn move and no capture (a player may claim the draw).
- **Not enough pieces:** for example king v king, king and bishop v king, or king and knight v king – nobody can checkmate.

Exercise 4 - Stalemate, Checkmate or Something Else?

In every diagram it is **Black's move**. Choose: STALEMATE, CHECKMATE, CHECK ONLY or DRAW (not enough material).

 A. Black to move.	 B. Black to move.	 C. Black to move.	 D. Black to move.
---	---	--	---

Exercise 5 - True or False?

1. King against king is a draw. _____
2. King and bishop against king is a draw. _____
3. Stalemate is a win for the player who is not to move. _____
4. A player may claim a draw if the same position appears three times. _____
5. After 50 moves by each side with no pawn move and no capture, a player may claim a draw. _____

Exercise 6 - The Repetition Puzzle

Both players keep shuffling their rooks: White plays Ra1-a2, Black plays Ra8-a7, White plays Ra2-a1, Black plays Ra7-a8. This **four-move cycle** brings back the starting position. The starting position has appeared **once** so far.

1. After the cycle has been played **once**, how many times has the position appeared? _____
2. After the cycle has been played **twice**, how many times? _____ Can a draw be claimed now? _____

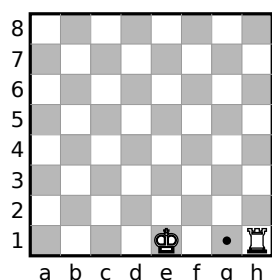
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

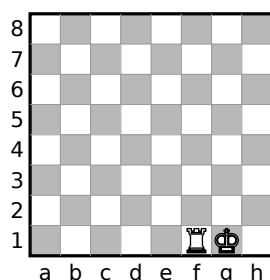
Exercise 4: A STALEMATE (draw); B CHECKMATE; C CHECK only; D DRAW (not enough material). • **Exercise 5:** 1. True 2. True 3. False 4. True 5. True (3 is false: stalemate is always a draw.) • **Exercise 6:** 1. Twice. 2. Three times – yes, a draw can be claimed (threefold repetition).

Castling

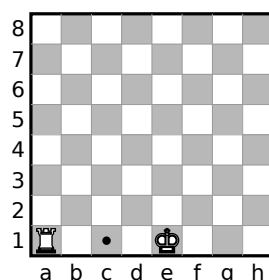
Castling is the only move where you move **two pieces at once**. The king moves **two squares** towards a rook, and the rook jumps over the king to the square next to it. It keeps your king safe and brings your rook into play.



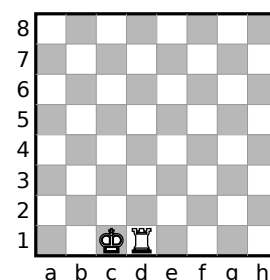
Before O-O (kingside):
the king goes to g1.



After O-O: king on g1,
rook on f1.



Before O-O-O
(queenside): the king
goes to c1.

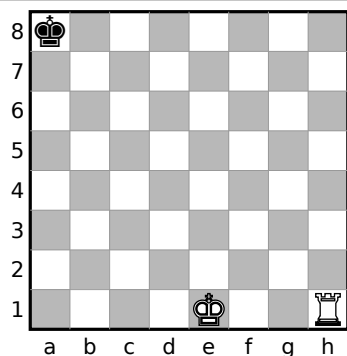


After O-O-O: king on c1,
rook on d1.

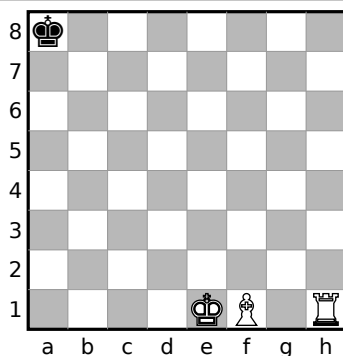
YOU MAY CASTLE ONLY IF...

- the king and that rook have **never moved**;
- there are **no pieces between** the king and the rook;
- the king is **not in check**;
- the king does **not pass through** or land on a square that is **attacked**.

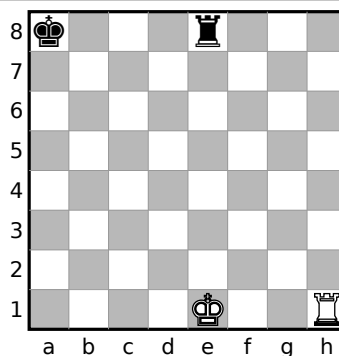
Exercise 7 - Can White Castle?



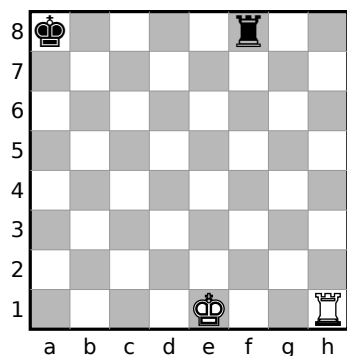
A. The White king has not moved before. Can White castle kingside? **YES / NO**



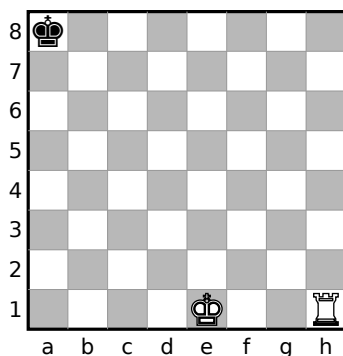
B. The White king has not moved before. Can White castle kingside? **YES / NO**



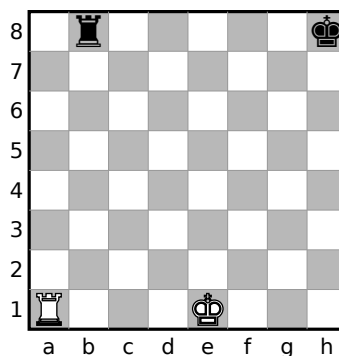
C. The White king has not moved before. Can White castle kingside? **YES / NO**



D. The White king has not moved before. Can White castle kingside? **YES / NO**



E. The White king moved earlier in the game. Can White castle kingside? **YES / NO**



F. The White king has not moved before. Can White castle queenside? **YES / NO**

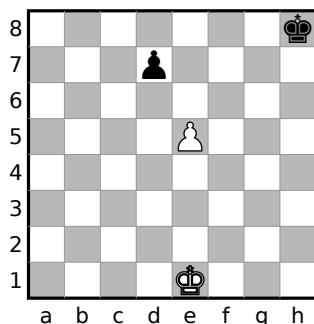
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

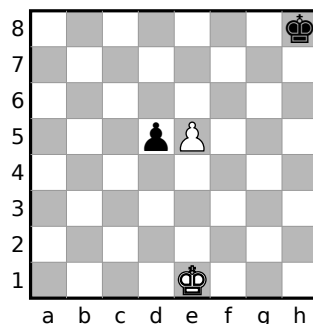
Exercise 7: **A** Yes - all the rules are met. **B** No - the bishop on f1 is between the king and the rook. **C** No - the king is in check. **D** No - the king would pass through f1, which the rook attacks. **E** No - the king has already moved earlier in the game. **F** Yes - only d1 and c1 matter. The rook may be attacked on b1 (the king does not cross it).

En Passant and Promotion

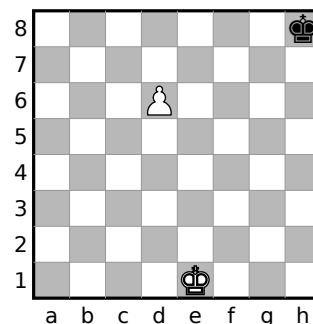
En passant (French for “in passing”) is a special pawn capture. It happens when an enemy pawn moves **two squares** and lands **right beside your pawn**. On your very next move only, you may capture it as if it had moved just one square.



1. Black to move. The pawn on d7 may go to d5.



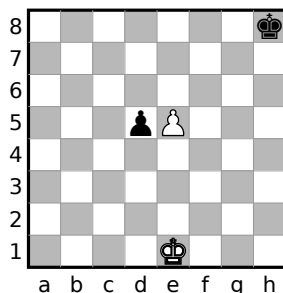
2. Black played d7-d5. White may capture en passant.



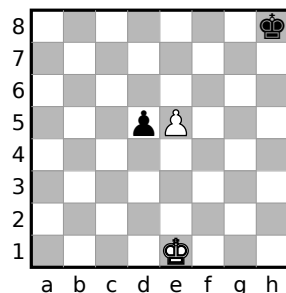
3. exd6 e.p. The d5 pawn is removed.

Promotion: when a pawn reaches the last rank it must become a queen, rook, bishop or knight of its own colour. Write it like this: **e8=Q**.

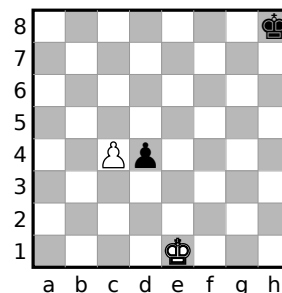
Exercise 8 - Is En Passant Possible?



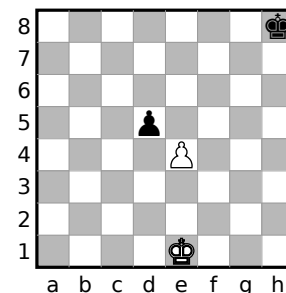
A. White to move. Last move: Black played d7-d5. Is **exd6 e.p.** legal? **YES / NO**



B. White to move. Last move: not a two-square pawn move. Is **exd6 e.p.** legal? **YES / NO**



C. Black to move. Last move: White played c2-c4. Is **dx c3 e.p.** legal? **YES / NO**



D. White to move. Last move: Black played d7-d5. Is **exd6** legal? **YES / NO**

Exercise 9 - Write the Promotion

1. A White pawn on b7 captures a piece on a8 and becomes a queen: _____

2. A White pawn on e7 moves to e8 and becomes a knight: _____

3. A Black pawn on g2 moves to g1 and becomes a rook: _____

Exercise 10 - Which Promotion Wins?

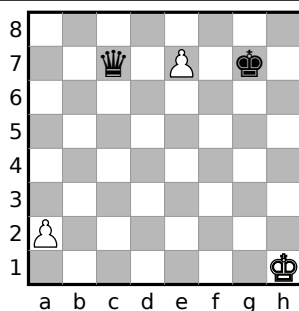


Diagram 3. White to move.

White will promote the pawn on e7. Which piece should it become, and why? Hint: look at the Black king and queen.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 8: A YES - Black has just played d7-d5, passing the pawn on e5. B NO - Black's pawn was already on d5 earlier. The chance is gone. C YES - White has just played c2-c4, passing the pawn on d4. D NO - The White pawn must stand on its 5th rank beside the enemy pawn. • **Exercise 9:** 1. bxa8=Q 2. e8=N 3. g1=R • **Exercise 10:** 1. e8=N+ (a knight). It gives check and attacks the queen on c7 at the same time (a fork), so White wins the queen. A new queen would not win anything extra here. (The spare pawn on a2 matters too: king+knight alone cannot checkmate, so it helps White actually win.)

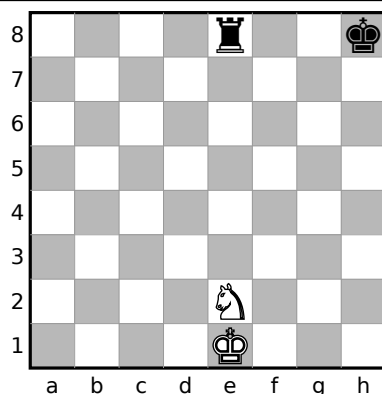
Legal and Illegal Moves

A move is **legal** if it follows the rules for that piece **and** does not leave your own king in check. If you play an illegal move by mistake, the move must be taken back and a legal one played instead.

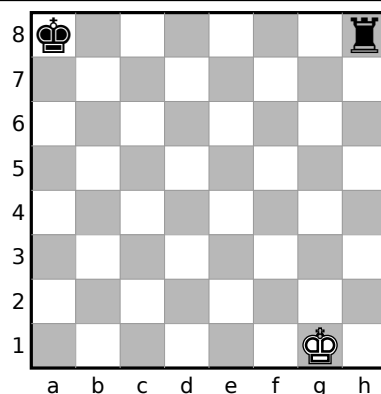
REMEMBER

- You **cannot capture your own pieces**, and you cannot jump over pieces (except with a knight).
- A piece that stands between its king and an enemy attacker is **pinned**: it may not move away if that exposes the king.
- A king may **never move into check**, and two kings may never touch.
- If you are in check, your move **must** stop the check.

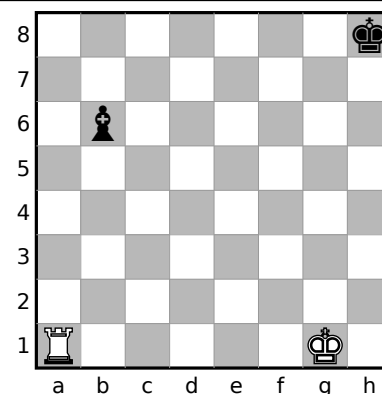
Exercise 11 - Legal or Illegal? Explain Why



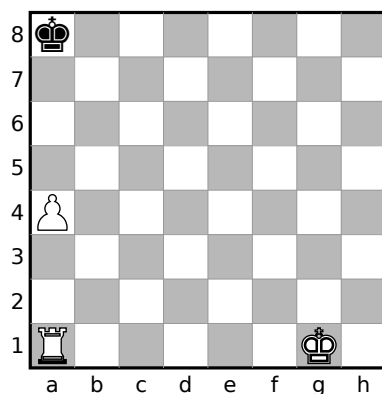
A. White wants to play **Nc3**. LEGAL / ILLEGAL?



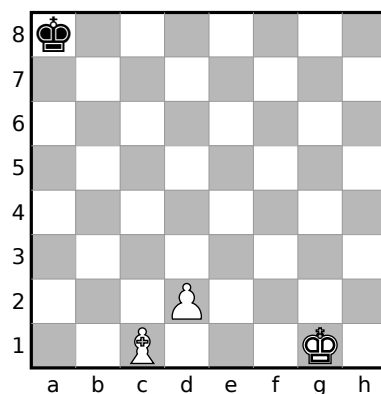
B. White wants to play **Kh1**. LEGAL / ILLEGAL?



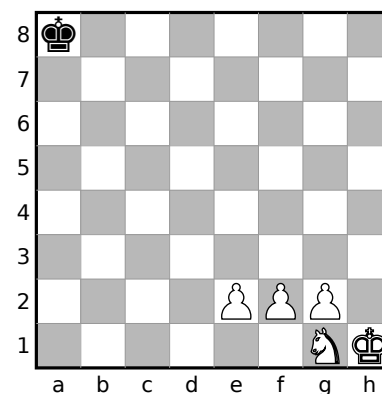
C. White wants to play **Ra2**. LEGAL / ILLEGAL?



D. White wants to play **Rxa4**. LEGAL / ILLEGAL?



E. White wants to play **Bh6**. LEGAL / ILLEGAL?



F. White wants to play **Nf3**. LEGAL / ILLEGAL?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 11: **A** ILLEGAL - The knight is pinned to its king by the rook. Moving it would leave the king in check. **B** ILLEGAL - The king may not step onto a square attacked by the rook (the h-file). **C** ILLEGAL - White is in check from the bishop and Ra2 does not answer it. **D** ILLEGAL - You may never capture your own piece. **E** ILLEGAL - A bishop cannot jump over the pawn on d2. **F** LEGAL - A knight can jump over pieces.

Tournament Rules and Good Manners

In a tournament you play in a quiet hall, with a clock, against players you may not know. A few simple rules keep every game fair. *(Rules can differ a little between events, so always listen to the arbiter.)*

KEY RULES

- **Touch-move:** touch a piece on purpose and you must move it (if it can legally move).
- **Say "I adjust"** before you straighten a piece.
- **Move with one hand** and press the clock with the same hand.
- **Write your moves** on the score sheet if the event asks for it.
- **Do not talk** about your game, and keep phones switched off.

GOOD MANNERS

- Shake hands before and after the game.
- Be quiet when others are still playing.
- Never argue: call the **arbiter** (the referee).
- Win kindly, lose politely, and learn from every game.

Exercise 12 - What Should You Do?

1. You touch your knight, then decide you would rather move your bishop. May you?

2. A piece is not standing neatly in the middle of its square. What must you do before you straighten it?

3. You deliberately touch an enemy pawn that you could legally capture. What must you do?

4. Your opponent is thinking. May you chat to a friend about the game?

5. You think your opponent made an illegal move. What should you do?

6. Your phone is in your pocket and it starts ringing. What is wrong?

7. The game ends. What is the polite thing to do?

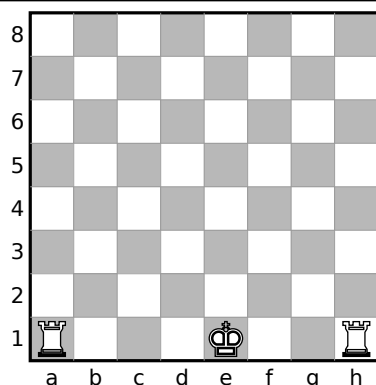
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

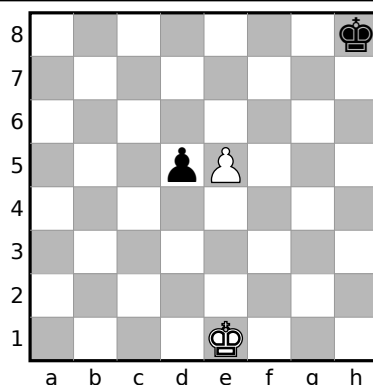
Exercise 12: 1. No. If a touched piece has a legal move, you must move it (the touch-move rule). 2. Say "I adjust" (or "J'adoube") before you touch it. It is your turn when you do this. 3. Capture that pawn with the piece you could capture it with (touch-move applies to enemy pieces too). 4. No. Do not talk about the game or disturb others. Speak only to offer a draw or to call the arbiter. 5. Stop the clock and call the arbiter. Do not argue. 6. Phones and other devices must be switched off (or handed in) in most tournaments. You might lose the game. 7. Shake hands, say "good game", and set up the pieces for the next players if asked.

Section 3 Rules Review

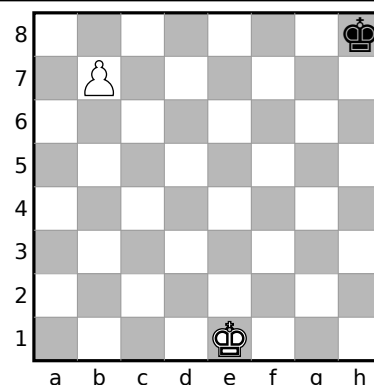
Exercise 13 - Name the Special Move



A. The king moves two squares towards a rook. Name the move:



B. Black just played d7-d5. What special capture can White make?



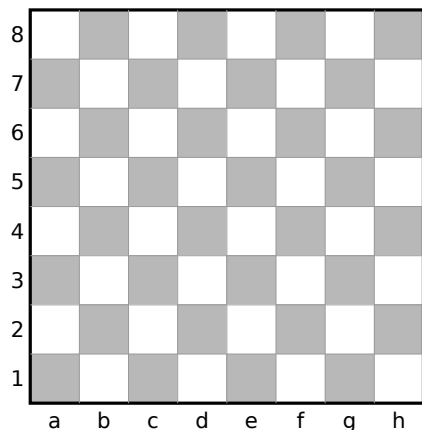
C. The pawn on b7 moves to b8. What happens? _____

Exercise 14 - Quick Rules Quiz

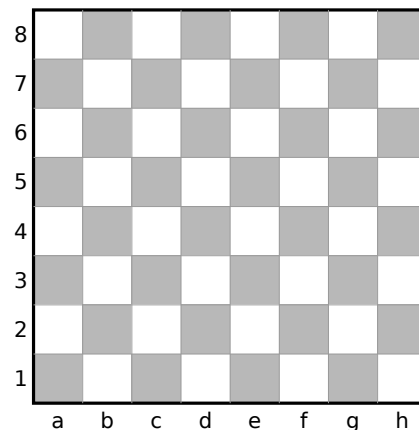
1. The player who is not in check but cannot move is in _____ and the game is a _____.
2. How many ways are there to answer a check? Name them. _____
3. True or False: You may castle while your king is in check. _____
4. True or False: A knight can give check even if pieces are in the way. _____
5. If you touch your rook on purpose, what must you do? _____
6. What is the notation for castling on the kingside? _____

Exercise 15 - Design Your Own Positions

Put a Black king in the corner. Add White pieces (K, Q, R...) to make **checkmate** on the left board and **stalemate** on the right board.



My **checkmate** (Black to move)



My **stalemate** (Black to move)

Section 3 score: ____ / 11

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 13: A castling (O-O-O or O-O) B en passant (exd6 e.p.) C promotion (the pawn becomes a queen, rook, bishop or knight). • **Exercise 14:** 1. stalemate; draw 2. three: move the king, block, capture the checker 3. False 4. True (it jumps) 5. move it, if it has a legal move 6. O-O • **Exercise 15:** A sample checkmate: White Qg7 and Kf6 against a Black king on h8. A sample stalemate: White Qg6 and Kf7 against a Black king on h8 (Black to move). Ask your coach to check your own ideas.

SECTION 4 • PAGES 33-38

Piece Values & Trading

Count material, win trades and avoid bad exchanges

What Are the Pieces Worth?

Chess players give each piece a **value** in “pawn points”. The values help you decide whether a trade (an **exchange**) is good, bad or fair.

 Pawn 1	 Knight 3	 Bishop 3	 Rook 5	 Queen 9	 King ∞
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REMEMBER

- These numbers are **guides**, not laws. A strong attack, an open file or the **bishop pair** can be worth more than a pawn.
- The king has no value because the game ends if it is checkmated. **Checkmate is worth more than all the material on the board.**
- A knight and a bishop are worth about the same (3 points). Two bishops together are a little stronger.

Exercise 1 - Value Quiz

1. How many pawns is a rook worth? _____
2. How many pawns is a queen worth? _____
3. Which two pieces are worth about the same? _____
4. Which is worth more: a rook or a bishop? _____
5. Which piece can never be traded because it is priceless? _____
6. True or False: a queen is worth more than two knights. _____

Exercise 2 - Add It Up

Pieces	Total value
Queen + Rook	
Rook + Bishop + Pawn	
Two Knights + Two Pawns	
Queen + Knight + Bishop	
Three Pawns + Rook	
Two Rooks + Bishop	

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 1: 1. 5 2. 9 3. knight and bishop (3 each) 4. rook (5 against 3) 5. the king 6. True (9 against 6) • **Exercise 2:** Queen + Rook = 14 Rook + Bishop + Pawn = 9 Two Knights + Two Pawns = 8 Queen + Knight + Bishop = 15 Three Pawns + Rook = 8 Two Rooks + Bishop = 13

Trading Pieces

When you capture something and your opponent captures back, we call it a **trade** (or an exchange). To see who won the trade, **add what you win and subtract what you lose**. This total is the **net gain**.

WORKED EXAMPLES

- **Example 1.** Your knight captures a pawn (+1). Their bishop captures your knight (−3). Net: $1 - 3 = -2 \rightarrow$ a **bad** trade.
- **Example 2.** Your rook captures a bishop (+3). Nothing recaptures. Net: **+3** $\rightarrow$ a free piece!
- **Example 3.** Your bishop takes a knight (+3). Their pawn takes your bishop (−3). Net: **0** $\rightarrow$ an **even** trade.

Exercise 3 - Work Out the Net Gain

For each list of captures, write the **net gain for you** (use + or −) and circle **WIN**, **EVEN** or **LOSE**.

#	What happens	Net gain	Result
1	Your bishop captures a knight. Their pawn captures your bishop.		WIN EVEN LOSE
2	Your rook captures a pawn. Their knight captures your rook.		WIN EVEN LOSE
3	Your pawn captures a bishop. Their queen captures your pawn.		WIN EVEN LOSE
4	Your queen captures a rook. Their bishop captures your queen.		WIN EVEN LOSE
5	Your knight captures a rook. Their pawn captures your knight.		WIN EVEN LOSE
6	Your rook captures a rook. Their rook captures your rook.		WIN EVEN LOSE
7	Your pawn captures a knight. Their bishop captures your pawn. Your rook captures their bishop.		WIN EVEN LOSE
8	Your queen captures a pawn. Their pawn captures your queen.		WIN EVEN LOSE

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 3: 1. +0 EVEN 2. -4 LOSE 3. +2 WIN 4. -4 LOSE 5. +2 WIN 6. +0 EVEN 7. +5 WIN 8. -8 LOSE. (Example 1: +3 for the knight, −3 for the bishop = 0.)

Good Trades and Bad Trades

Before you trade, always compare **what you give** with **what you get**. Here are three helpful ideas:

- **Even trade:** both sides give the same value, such as knight for bishop.
- **Winning the exchange:** giving a knight or bishop (3) and getting a rook (5). You win 2 points.
- **When ahead, trade pieces. When behind, avoid trades.** Fewer pieces make an extra piece count more.

Exercise 4 - Which Deal Is Better?

Read both offers. Circle the **better** one for you.

#	Offer A	Offer B	Better?
1	You give a rook (5) and get a knight (3).	You give a knight (3) and get a bishop (3).	A B
2	You give a bishop (3) and get a rook (5).	You give a bishop (3) and get a knight (3).	A B
3	You give a queen (9) and get two rooks (10).	You give a queen (9) and get a rook and a bishop (8).	A B
4	You give a rook (5) and get a bishop and a knight (6).	You give a rook (5) and get a bishop and a pawn (4).	A B
5	You give two knights (6) and get a rook and a pawn (6).	You give two knights (6) and get a rook (5).	A B

Exercise 5 - True or False?

1. When you are ahead in material, trading pieces usually helps you. _____
2. You must accept every trade your opponent offers. _____
3. Trading your queen for a knight is a good deal. _____
4. Giving a rook (5) for a rook (5) is an even trade. _____
5. A player who is behind in material should usually avoid trades. _____

Exercise 6 - Winning the Exchange

1. A rook is worth 5 and a knight is worth 3. How many points do you win if you get a rook for a knight? _____
2. Is that a good deal for you? _____
3. What if you give a rook for a knight? How many points do you lose? _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

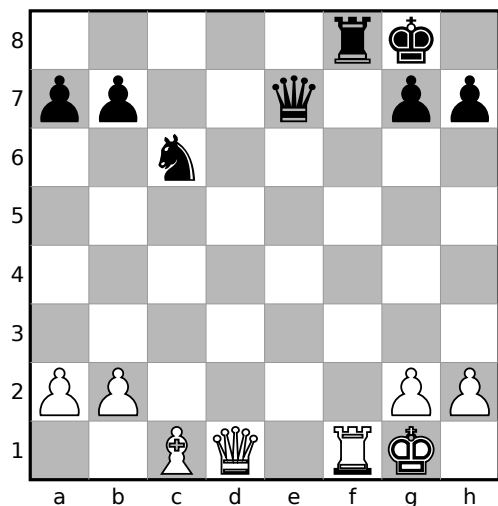
Exercise 4: 1. B (A -2, B +0) 2. A (A +2, B +0) 3. A (A +1, B -1) 4. A (A +1, B -1) 5. A (A +0, B -1) • **Exercise 5:** 1. True 2. False 3. False 4. True 5. True • **Exercise 6:** 1. $5 - 3 = 2$ points. 2. Yes - the exchange is worth 2 points. 3. A rook for a knight loses 2 points.

Count the Material

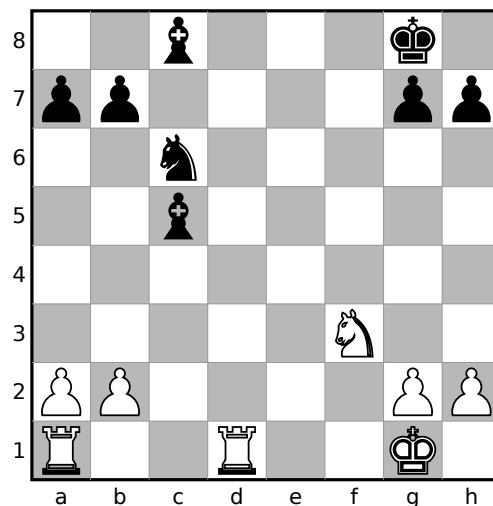
Material means the total value of a player's pieces and pawns. Add up each side, then subtract to see who is ahead. **Do not count the kings.** Take your time and cross off each piece as you count it.

Exercise 7 - Who Is Ahead?

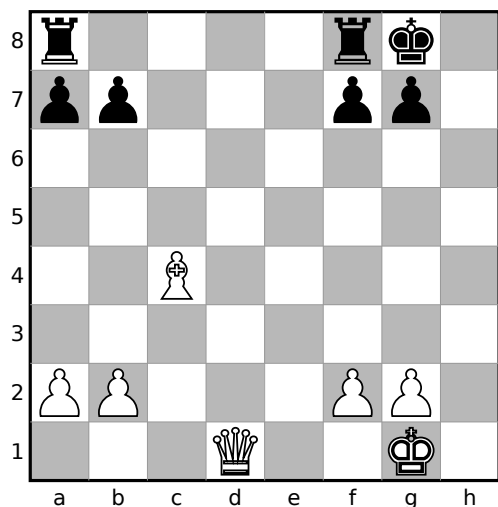
Use P = 1, N = 3, B = 3, R = 5, Q = 9. Count both sides in every diagram.



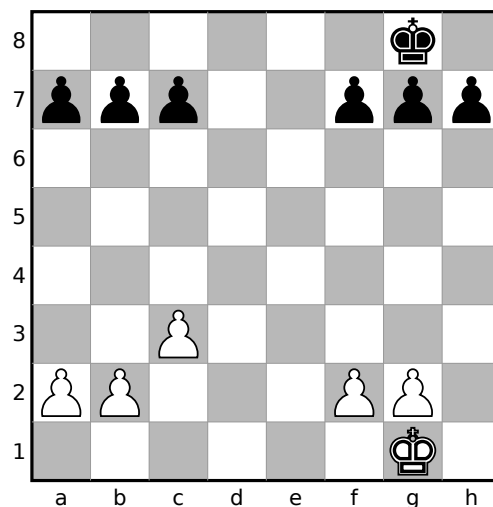
A. White: ____ Black: ____
Who is ahead, and by how many points?



B. White: ____ Black: ____
Who is ahead, and by how many points?



C. White: ____ Black: ____
Who is ahead, and by how many points?



D. White: ____ Black: ____
Who is ahead, and by how many points?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 7: A White 21, Black 21 - equal; **B** White 17, Black 13 - White is ahead by 4; **C** White 16, Black 14 - White is ahead by 2; **D** White 5, Black 6 - Black is ahead by 1. (Kings are not counted.)

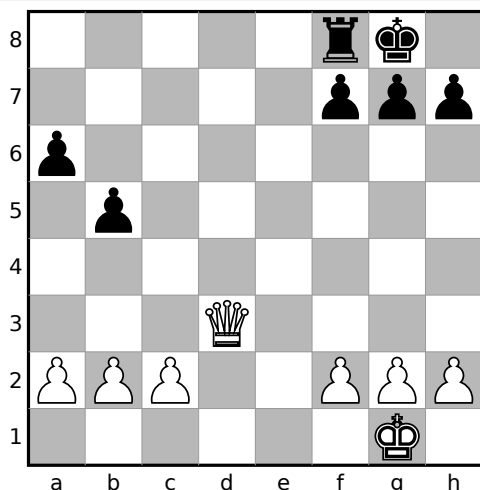
Should You Capture?

A capture is only good if you **come out ahead** after any recapture. Before you capture, ask two questions: **1. Is the piece protected?** **2. If it is, what will I lose when they recapture?**

THE CAPTURE CHECK

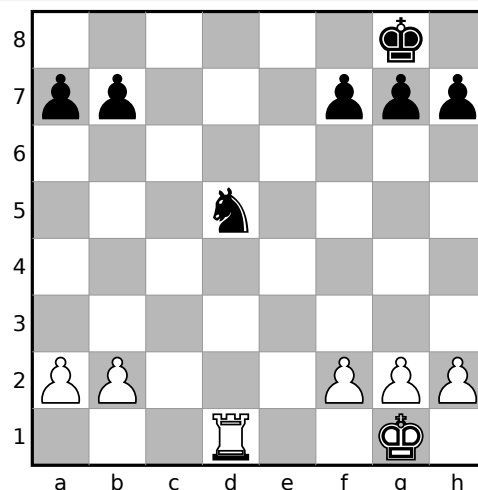
- Unprotected piece → you usually win it for free.
- Protected piece → compare: **what I win** against **what I lose**.
- Capture with your **least valuable** piece when you have a choice.

Exercise 8 - Good Capture or Bad Capture?



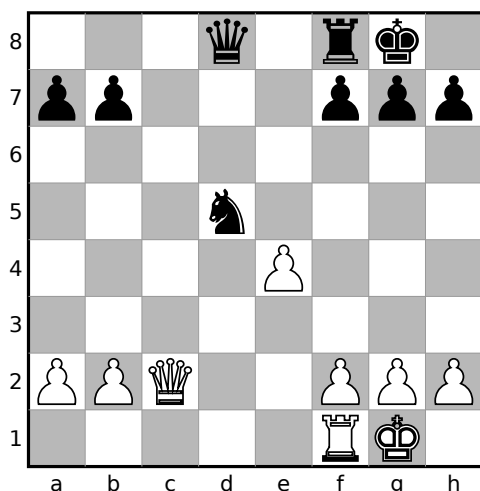
A. White to move. Is **Qxb5** a good idea? **YES** / **NO**

Net gain: _____



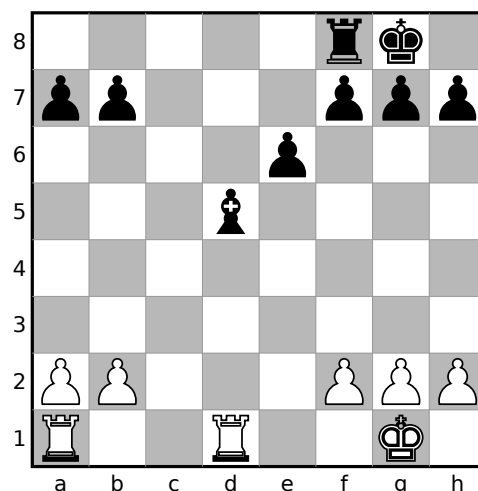
B. White to move. Is **Rxd5** a good idea? **YES** / **NO**

Net gain: _____



C. White to move. Is **exd5** a good idea? **YES** / **NO**

Net gain: _____



D. White to move. Is **Rxd5** a good idea? **YES** / **NO**

Net gain: _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 8: A No. The pawn on b5 is protected by the pawn on a6: White wins a pawn (+1) but loses the queen (−9). Net −8. **B** Yes. The knight on d5 has no protector: White wins 3 points for free. Net +3. **C** Yes. The pawn wins the knight (+3) and only loses a pawn (−1) when the queen recaptures. Net +2. **D** No. The bishop on d5 is protected by the pawn on e6: White wins 3 but loses a rook (5). Net −2.

Section 4 Check-Up

Exercise 9 - Write the Value

Fill in each piece's value in pawn points.

Pawn	Knight	Bishop	Rook	Queen	King

Exercise 10 - Which Side Has More?

Compare each pair. Circle **FIRST**, **SECOND** or **EQUAL**.

Pair	Your answer
Two knights or a rook	FIRST SECOND EQUAL
A rook and a pawn or a bishop and a knight	FIRST SECOND EQUAL
A queen or two rooks	FIRST SECOND EQUAL
A rook or a bishop and a pawn	FIRST SECOND EQUAL

Exercise 11 - True or False?

1. Material is the only thing that matters in chess. _____
2. A knight and a bishop are worth about the same. _____
3. If you are ahead in material, trading pieces is usually a good idea. _____
4. The king is worth 4 points in a trade. _____
5. A pawn that captures a knight gains 2 points, even if it is recaptured. _____

SECTION 4 IN ONE BOX

- P = 1, N = 3, B = 3, R = 5, Q = 9. Add what you win, subtract what you lose.
- Ask before you capture: **Is it protected? What will I lose back?**
- Ahead → trade pieces. Behind → avoid trades. Checkmate beats everything.

Section 4 score: ____ / 15

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 9: Queen 9, Rook 5, Knight 3, Bishop 3, Pawn 1. Order: Queen, Rook, then Knight and Bishop (equal), then Pawn. • **Exercise 10:** 1. FIRST (6 v 5) 2. EQUAL (6 v 6) 3. SECOND (9 v 10) 4. FIRST (5 v 4) • **Exercise 11:** 1. False 2. True 3. True 4. False 5. True (5: +3 - 1 = +2.)

SECTION 5 • PAGES 39-46

Chess Thinking System

A seven-step routine for choosing better moves

Strong players do not just “see a move and play it”. They follow a routine. Follow these **seven steps** for every move until they become a habit.

1**STOP**

Take a breath and sit up. Do not move yet.

2**LOOK**

What did my opponent's last move change on the board?

3**THREATS**

What does my opponent want to do next? What is attacked?

4**CANDIDATES**

Find two or three possible moves. Look at checks, captures and threats first.

5**TEST**

Is each candidate safe? What can my opponent capture or attack after it?

6**CHOOSE**

Pick the move that is safe and helps my plan.

7**PLAY & RE-CHECK**

Make the move, press the clock, then look at the board again.

C-C-T: YOUR FIRST LOOK

At Steps 3 and 4 always look at **Checks, Captures and Threats** - for your opponent and for you. Most tactics start with a check, a capture or a threat.

Exercise 1 - Put the Steps in Order

Write 1 to 7 in the box to show the correct order.

___ Test each candidate for safety

___ Look at what changed on the board

___ Stop and breathe

___ List candidate moves

___ Play the move and re-check

___ Choose the best move

___ Find what my opponent threatens

Exercise 2 - Name the Steps

From memory, write the name of each step: 1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____ 4 _____ 5 _____ 6 _____ 7 _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 1: 1. Step 5 2. Step 1 3. Step 7 4. Step 3 5. Step 2 6. Step 4 7. Step 6 • **Exercise 2:** 1. STOP 2. LOOK 3. THREATS 4. CANDIDATES 5. TEST 6. CHOOSE 7. PLAY & RE-CHECK

Before I Move: The Habit Checklist

Each step has one question to ask yourself. Here are the questions with a chess example.

Step	Ask yourself...	Example
1 STOP	Am I calm and ready?	Sit up. Take one slow breath.
2 LOOK	What just changed?	A bishop now points at my king's pawn.
3 THREATS	What does my opponent threaten?	The bishop attacks a knight that is not protected.
4 CANDIDATES	What are two or three good moves?	Protect the knight, move it, or attack the bishop.
5 TEST	Is each move safe?	If I move the knight, can something take it?
6 CHOOSE	Which move is best?	The one that is safe and improves my position.
7 RE-CHECK	Did my move change anything?	After I play it, look at the board again.

My Move Checklist (use it in every practice game)

- ☐ I stopped and looked at the whole board.
- ☐ I asked what my opponent is threatening.
- ☐ I looked at checks, captures and threats.
- ☐ I found at least two candidate moves.
- ☐ I checked that my move is safe.
- ☐ I chose the best move, then looked again.

Exercise 3 - Which Step Was Missed?

- Mia moved her bishop to a square where a pawn could capture it. Missed step: _____
- Leo did not notice that his opponent's knight was attacking his queen. Missed step: _____
- Aria played the first move that came to her mind. Missed step: _____
- Noah grabbed a piece the second it was his turn. Missed step: _____
- Sana pressed the clock and never looked at the board again. Her opponent then won a pawn she could have saved. Missed step: _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 3: 1. Step 5 - TEST (she did not check that the move was safe). 2. Step 3 - THREATS (and Step 2, LOOK, at the last move). 3. Step 4 - CANDIDATES (she only looked at one move). 4. Step 1 - STOP (he did not pause and breathe). 5. Step 7 - RE-CHECK.

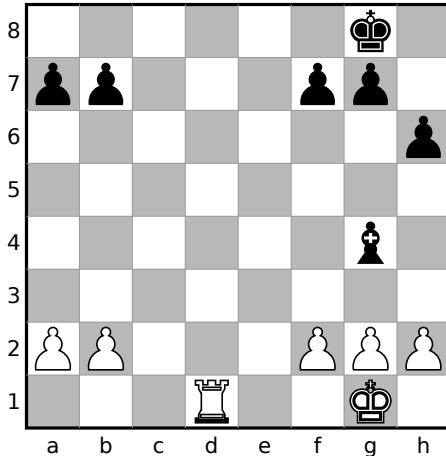
What Is My Opponent Threatening?

Before you play your own plan, find out what your opponent wants to do **next**. A trick that works well: imagine it is **your opponent's turn** and ask, **"What would they capture or attack?"**

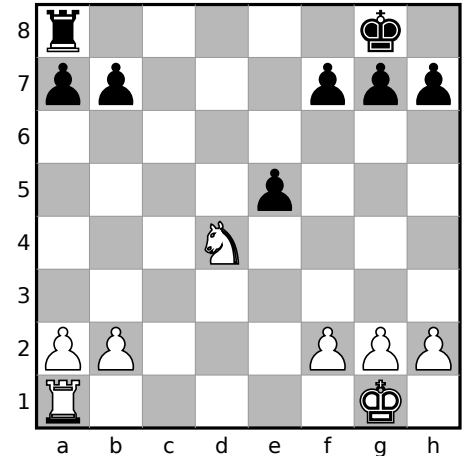
THREAT DETECTIVE

- Which of my pieces are **attacked**? Which are **not protected**?
- Can my opponent give **check** or even **checkmate**?
- Can one enemy move attack **two** of my pieces at once?

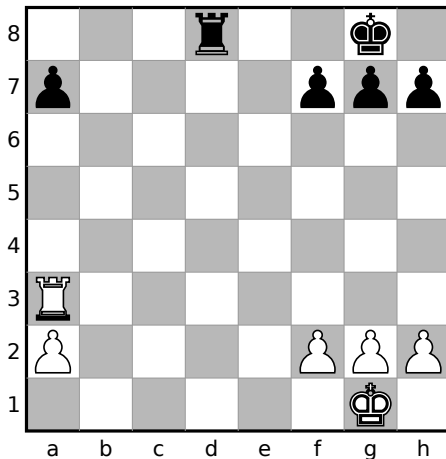
Exercise 4 - Find the Threat



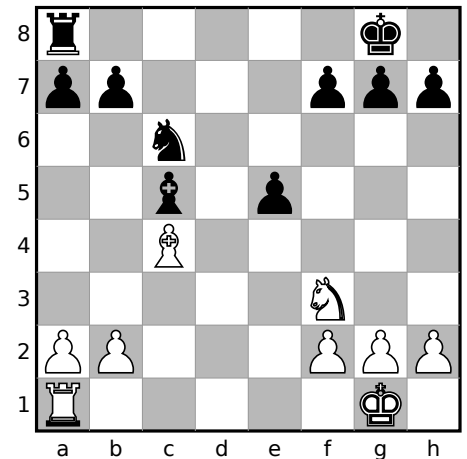
A. White to move. What is Black threatening?



B. White to move. What is Black threatening?



C. White to move. What is Black threatening?



D. White to move. What is Black threatening?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

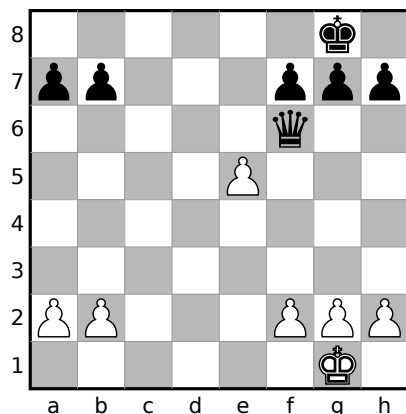
Exercise 4: **A** Black threatens Bxd1, winning the rook. **B** Black threatens exd4, winning the knight. **C** Black threatens Rd1 checkmate (back-rank mate). **D** There is no real threat - Black has no winning capture. (In C, White could play h3 or Rc3 to escape the mate.)

Candidate Moves

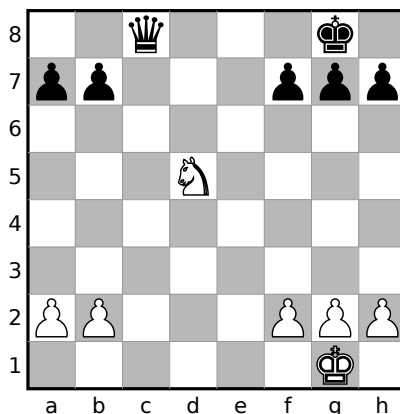
A **candidate move** is a move worth thinking about. Always find **two or three** before you decide. Start with forcing moves: **checks**, then **captures**, then **threats**.

Exercise 5 - List Your Candidates

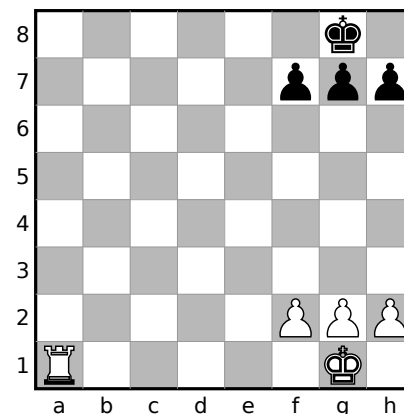
For each diagram write (1) every **check**, (2) every **capture**, and (3) the **best move**.



A. White to move.



B. White to move.



C. White to move.

	Checks	Captures	Best move
A			
B			
C			

Exercise 6 - Sort the Moves

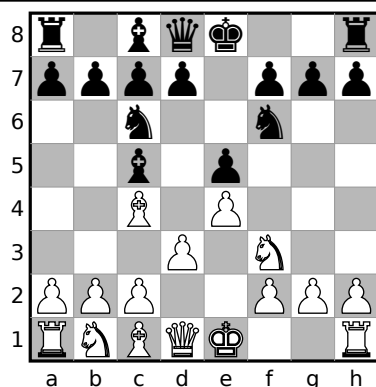


Diagram 1. White to move.

Write **Check**, **Capture**, **Check + Capture** or **Quiet** for each move.

1. Bxf7+ _____
2. Nc3 _____
3. Nxe5 _____
4. O-O _____
5. Ng5 _____
6. Bg5 _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 5: A Checks: none. Captures: exf6. Best: **exf6** (Pawn takes queen!) B Checks: Ne7+, Nf6+. Captures: none. Best: **Ne7+** (A knight fork: the knight checks the king and attacks the queen.) C Checks: Ra8#. Captures: none. Best: **Ra8#** (Back-rank checkmate!) • **Exercise 6:** 1. Bxf7+ = Check+Capture 2. Nc3 = Quiet 3. Nxe5 = Capture 4. O-O = Quiet 5. Ng5 = Quiet 6. Bg5 = Quiet. (Ng5 is a quiet move that makes a threat against f7.)

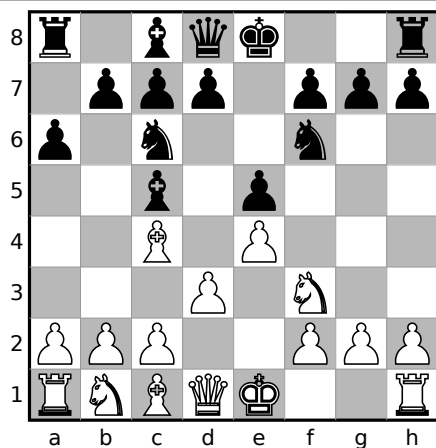
The Blunder Check

A **blunder** is a move that gives away material or the game. You can avoid most blunders with one question asked **before you let go of the piece**:

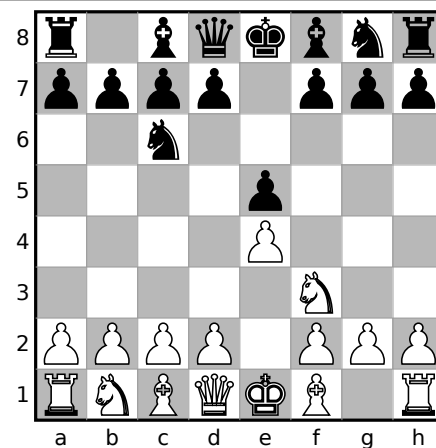
“After my move, what can my opponent capture, attack or check?”

Also check: **Did my move stop protecting something? Did it block one of my own pieces' lines?**

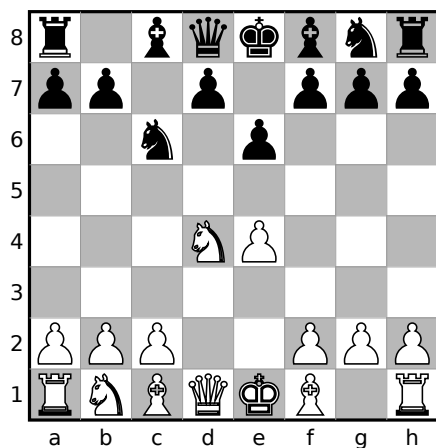
Exercise 7 - Safe or Unsafe?



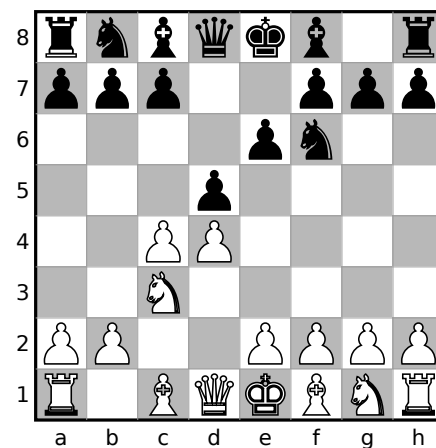
A. White wants to play **Bb5**.
SAFE / UNSAFE? What can Black capture?



B. White wants to play **Bc4**.
SAFE / UNSAFE? What can Black capture?



C. White wants to play **Bd3**.
SAFE / UNSAFE? What can Black capture?



D. White wants to play **cxd5**.
SAFE / UNSAFE? What can Black capture?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

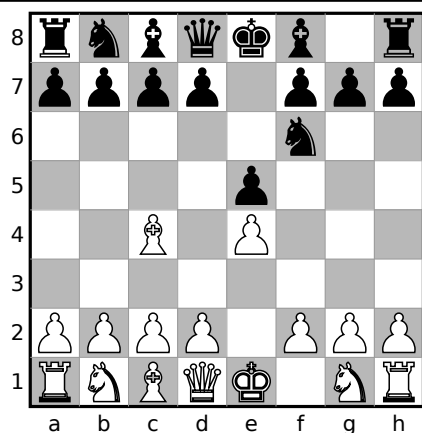
(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 7: A UNSAFE. The pawn on a6 captures the bishop (axb5) and White gets nothing. **B** SAFE. The bishop is not attacked on c4. **C** UNSAFE. The bishop blocks the queen's protection of the knight on d4, so ...Nxd4 wins a piece. **D** SAFE. It is an ordinary capture; after ...exd5 nothing is hanging.

Find the Blunder

In each diagram, White has three possible moves. **Two are safe. One is a blunder.** Use the blunder check on every option, then circle the blunder and explain what goes wrong.

Exercise 8 - Spot the Blunder



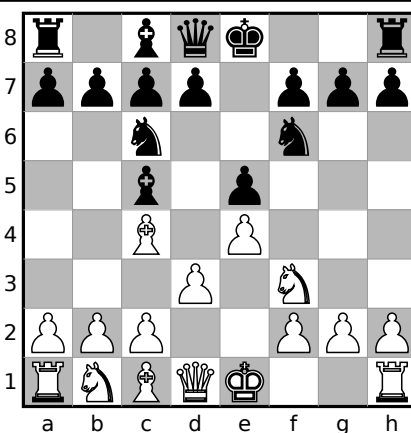
1. White to move. Options:

A Qh5

B Nc3

C d3

The blunder is: ____



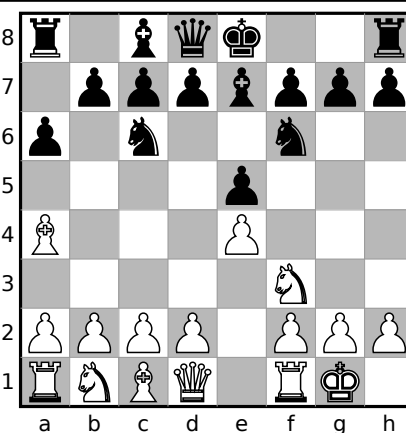
2. White to move. Options:

A Bxf7+

B Nc3

C O-O

The blunder is: ____



3. White to move. Options:

A Re1

B Nxe5

C d4

The blunder is: ____

WHY DO BLUNDERS HAPPEN?

- We move too quickly and do not look at what the opponent can do.
- We think only about our own plan and forget the opponent's pieces.
- We take a "free" pawn without checking if it is protected.

Exercise 9 - My Blunder Story

Think of a blunder you made in a recent game. Write what happened and which step of the routine would have saved you.

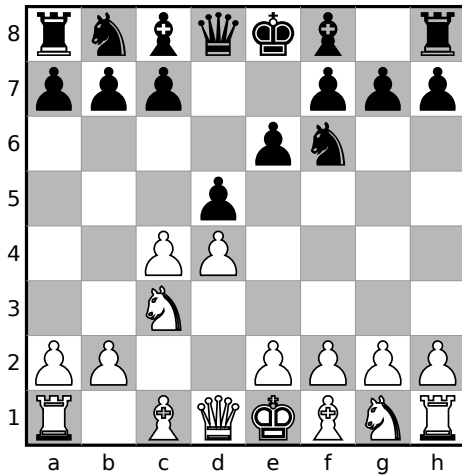
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 8: 1. A (Qh5) - The queen on h5 is captured by the knight (...Nxh5). **2.** A (Bxf7+) - After ...Kxf7 White has lost a bishop for a pawn. **3.** B (Nxe5) - The pawn on e5 is protected by the knight on c6: ...Nxe5 wins a knight for a pawn. • **Exercise 9:** Personal answer. A good answer names the move, says what was missed and which step of the routine would have prevented it.

The Thinking Table

A table helps you **compare** moves instead of guessing. Here is a worked example. It is White's move.



How to use it

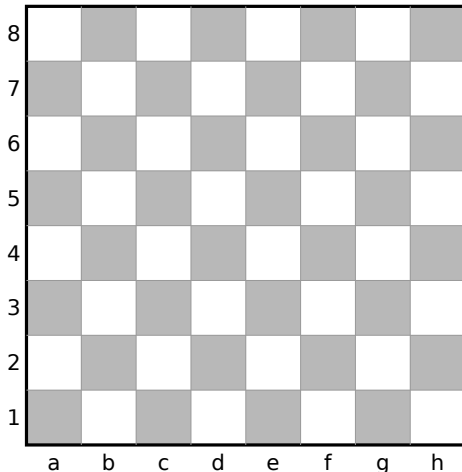
- Write 3-4 **candidate moves**.
- Mark checks and captures.
- Write the idea behind each move.
- Test each one for **safety**.
- Give a verdict: **Good, OK or Blunder**.

Worked example. White to move.

Candidate	Check?	Capture?	Threat or idea	Safe?	Verdict
Bg5	No	No	Pins the knight to the queen; develops.	Yes	Good
cxd5	No	Yes	Opens the c-file; trades a pawn.	Yes	OK
Nf3	No	No	Develops a knight and guards e5.	Yes	Good
Nxd5	No	Yes	Takes a protected pawn.	No	Blunder

Exercise 10 - Your Own Thinking Table

Set up a position from one of your own games (or ask your coach for one). Draw it, then fill in the table.



Position: ____ to move

Candidate	Check?	Capture?	Safe?	Verdict

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 10: The worked example above is complete. For your own table, ask your coach to look at your reasons: a good table shows a check or capture that was tested before it was chosen. In the example Nxd5 fails because the pawn on d5 is protected: after ...exd5 White has given a knight for only a pawn or two.

Section 5 Check-Up

Exercise 11 - Write the Seven Steps

1	2	3	4	5	6	7

Exercise 12 - True or False?

1. You should always play the first good-looking move you see. _____
2. Checks, captures and threats should be looked at first. _____
3. You only need to think about your opponent's pieces at the end. _____
4. A blunder check asks what your opponent can do after your move. _____
5. It is a good habit to look at the board again after you move. _____

Exercise 13 - Thinking Habit Tracker

After each practice game, tick every step you used on **most** of your moves.

Step	G1	G2	G3	G4	G5	G6	G7	G8
STOP	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
LOOK	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
THREATS	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CANDIDATES	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TEST	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CHOOSE	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
PLAY / RE-CHECK	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Coach signature: _____

Section 5 score: ____ / 12

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 11: 1. STOP 2. LOOK 3. THREATS 4. CANDIDATES 5. TEST 6. CHOOSE 7. PLAY & RE-CHECK • **Exercise 12:** 1. False 2. True 3. False 4. True 5. True • **Exercise 13:** Ask your coach to sign after checking your practice games.

SECTION 6 • PAGES 47-60

Tactical Training

Forks, pins, mating patterns and more

A **tactic** is a short, forcing sequence of moves that wins material or checkmates. Tactics decide most games. This section gives you a **toolbox of twelve tactics**, one page each, with three puzzles on every page.

#	Tactic	What it means
1	Fork	One piece attacks two or more enemy pieces at once.
2	Pin	A piece cannot (or should not) move because a more valuable piece is behind it.
3	Skewer	A valuable piece is attacked and must move, exposing a piece behind it.
4	Discovered attack	Moving one piece uncovers an attack by another piece.
5	Double attack	One move makes two separate threats.
6	Removing the defender	Capture or chase away the piece that guards a target.
7	Deflection	Force a defender to leave an important job.
8	Decoy	Lure a piece (often the king) onto a bad square.
9	Overloaded piece	A defender that has too many jobs at once.
10	Back-rank mate	Mate on the edge rank when the king is boxed in by its own pawns.
11	Zwischenzug	An “in-between” move (often a check) before the expected reply.
12	Mating patterns	Common checkmate shapes worth knowing by heart.

LEVELS

- **A** – a first look; the idea is clear.
- **B** – a little harder; check the reply.
- **C** – a challenge; look for the trick.
- Unless the caption says otherwise, it is **White's move**.

HOW TO SOLVE A PUZZLE

- Look at every **check**, then every **capture**, then every **threat**.
- Ask: **What is loose? What is guarded only once?**
- Check your opponent's best reply before you decide.

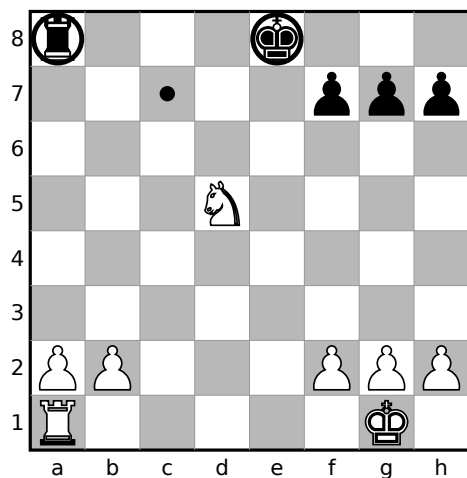
Exercise 1 - Name That Tactic

1. A knight attacks a king and a queen at the same time. _____
2. A rook gives check; when the king moves away, the queen behind it is captured. _____
3. A bishop cannot move because a more valuable piece stands behind it on the same line. _____
4. A knight moves away and uncovers a check from a rook behind it. _____
5. You capture the piece that was guarding another piece, and then win that piece. _____
6. A rook sacrifice on the back rank ends in checkmate because the guard was forced away. _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY**Exercise 1:** 1. Fork 2. Skewer 3. Pin 4. Discovered attack 5. Removing the defender 6. Deflection*(cover this strip while you work)*

The Fork

A **fork** is one move that attacks **two or more** enemy pieces at once. The opponent can only save one of them. Knights are the best forkers because they jump, but queens, rooks, bishops and even pawns can fork too.



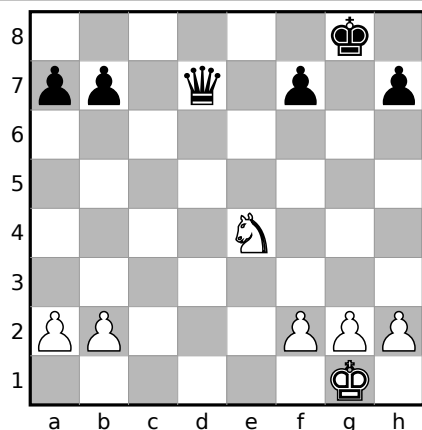
Example. White to move.

Nc7+! The knight on d5 jumps to c7. It gives **check** to the king on e8 and attacks the rook on a8 at the same time. The king must move, and White plays Nxa8 (Nc7+ Kd7 Nxa8).

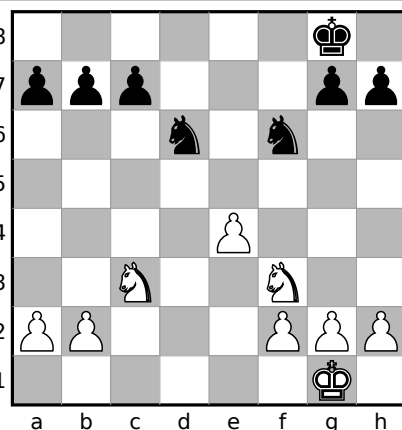
FORK CHECKLIST

- Can a knight reach a square that attacks two valuable pieces?
- Is the forking piece safe on that square?
- A fork with **check** is the strongest: the king must answer it.

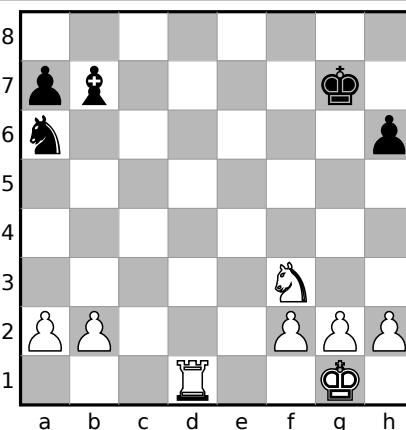
Exercises 2-4 - The Fork



2 (A). White to move. Find the knight fork. Move: ____ Attacks: ____



3 (B). White to move. Find the pawn fork. Move: ____ Attacks: ____



4 (C). White to move. Find the rook fork. Move: ____ Attacks: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

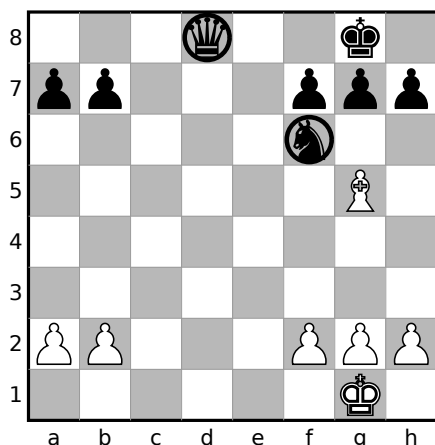
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 2 (A): Nf6+ forks the king on g8 and the queen on d7. After the king moves, Nxd7 wins the queen (Nf6+ Kf8 Nxd7+). • **Ex 3 (B):** e5! forks the knights on d6 and f6. Neither knight can be captured or protected in time, so White wins a piece. (The pawn on e5 is protected by the knight on f3.) • **Ex 4 (C):** Rd7+ forks the king on g8 and the bishop on b7 along the 7th rank. After the king moves, Rxb7 wins the bishop (Rd7+ Kf6 Rxb7).

The Pin

A **pin** happens when a piece cannot move (or should not move) because a more valuable piece stands behind it on the same line. If the piece behind is the **king**, the pin is **absolute**: the pinned piece may not move at all. If it is another piece, the pin is **relative**: it may move, but it would lose the piece behind.



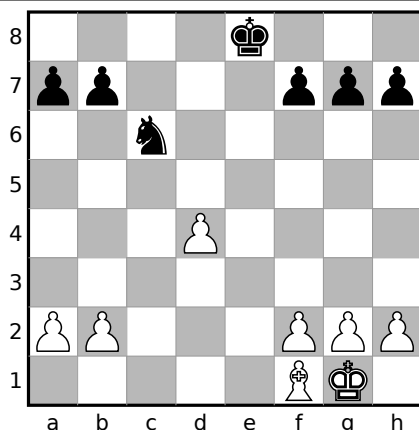
Example. The bishop on g5 pins the knight on f6 to the queen on d8.

If the knight on f6 moves, White plays Bxd8 and wins the queen. This is a **relative pin**. Pieces that can pin: **bishops, rooks and queens** (never knights, pawns or kings).

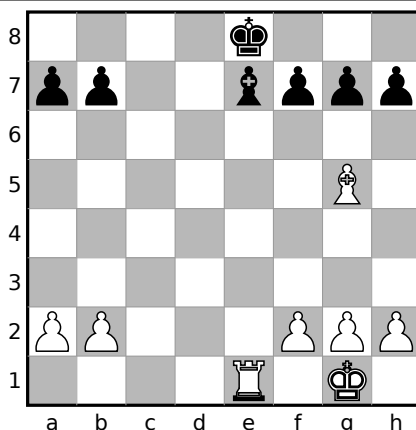
PIN CHECKLIST

- Which enemy piece is **in front** and which is **behind**?
- Can I attack the pinned piece again? Pinned pieces cannot run away.
- A pinned piece cannot protect other pieces if moving would expose the king.

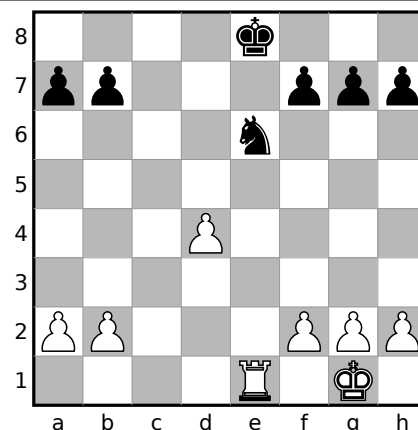
Exercises 5-7 - Pins



5 (A). White to move. Find the move that **pins** the knight on c6 to the king. Move: ____



6 (B). White to move. Win a piece using the pin. Move: ____



7 (C). White to move. Win the pinned knight. Move: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

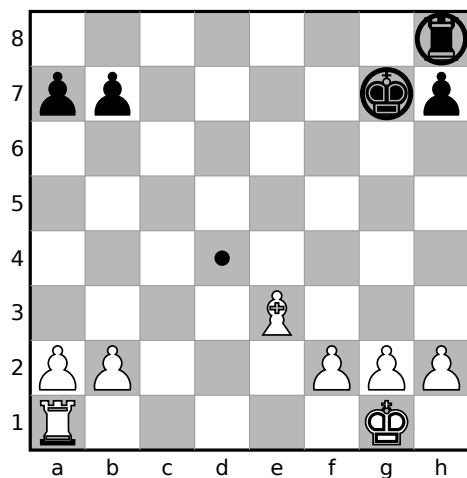
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 5 (A): Bb5 pins the knight on c6 to the king on e8 (an absolute pin: the knight cannot legally move). The pawn on d4 can then attack it with d5. • **Ex 6 (B):** Rxe7+. The bishop on e7 is pinned to its king by the rook on e1, so it cannot capture back, and the bishop on g5 protects the rook: Rxe7+ Kf8 Rxb7. (Bxe7 also wins a piece.) • **Ex 7 (C):** d5! The knight on e6 is pinned to the king by Re1, so it cannot run away. The pawn attacks it: d5 Kd7 dxe6+ fxe6, and White wins a knight for a pawn.

The Skewer

A **skewer** is like a pin in reverse. You attack a **valuable piece** (often the king) that must move away, and this uncovers a **less valuable piece behind it** which you then capture. Only bishops, rooks and queens can skewer.



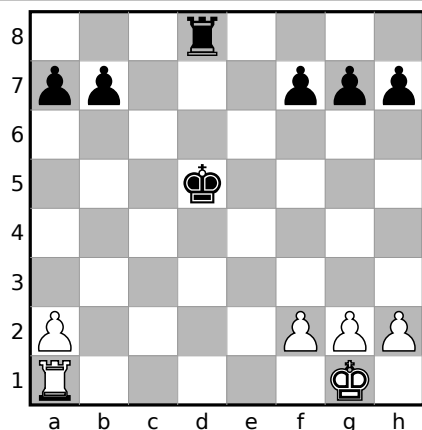
Example. White to move.

Bd4+! The bishop checks the king on g7 along the diagonal. The rook on h8 stands directly behind the king. The king must move, and White plays Bxh8 (Bd4+ Kf7 Bxh8).

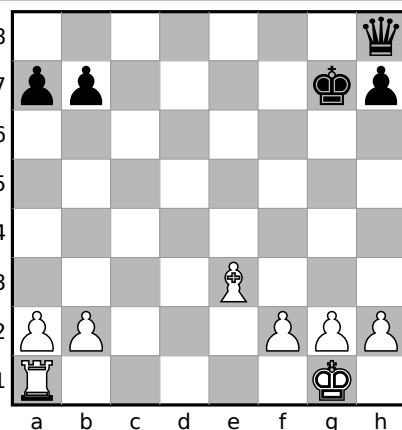
SKEWER OR PIN?

- **Pin:** the less valuable piece is in front.
- **Skewer:** the more valuable piece is in front.
- Look for kings and queens lined up with another piece on a rank, file or diagonal.

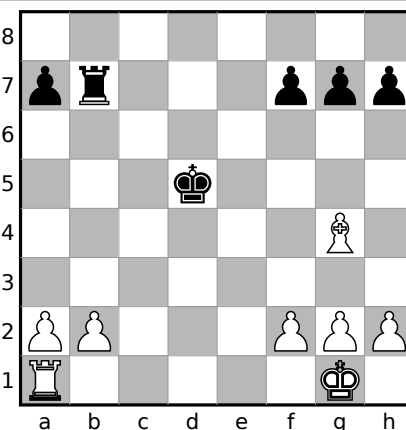
Exercises 8-10 - The Skewer



8 (A). White to move. Find the skewer.
Move: ____ Wins: ____



9 (B). White to move. Find the skewer.
Move: ____ Wins: ____



10 (C). White to move. Find the skewer.
Move: ____ Wins: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

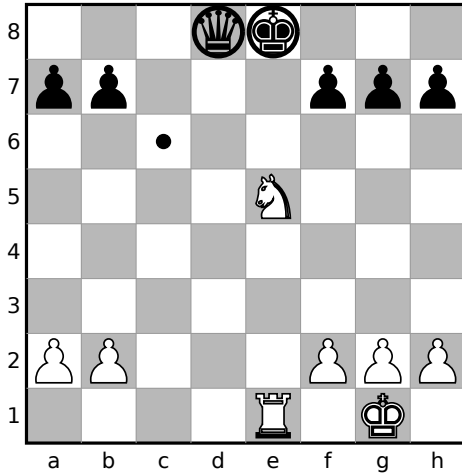
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 8 (A): Rd1+ checks the king on d5; it must move, and Rxd8 wins the rook (Rd1+ Kc4 Rxd8). • **Ex 9 (B):** Bd4+ attacks the king on g7 with the queen behind it on h8. The king moves and Bxh8 wins the queen for a bishop (Bd4+ Kg8 Bxh8 Kxh8). • **Ex 10 (C):** Bf3+ checks the king on d5 along the long diagonal with the rook on b7 behind it. The king moves and Bxb7 wins the rook (Bf3+ Kd6 Bxb7).

The Discovered Attack

In a **discovered attack** you move one piece out of the way and **uncover an attack** by a piece behind it. The moving piece can make its own threat at the same time. If the uncovered attack is a **check**, it is a **discovered check** and is very hard to meet.



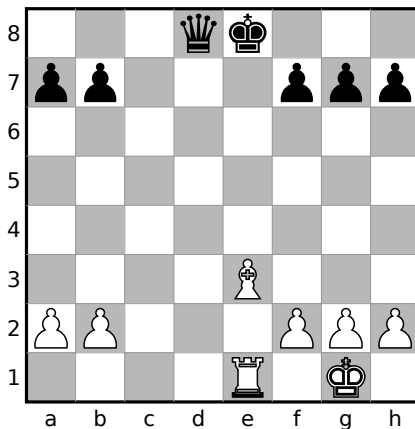
Example. White to move.

Nc6+! The knight moves from e5 and uncovers the rook on e1, which now checks the king. At the same time the knight on c6 attacks the queen on d8. Black must answer the check, so White wins the queen (*Nc6+ Kd7 Nxd8 Kxd8*).

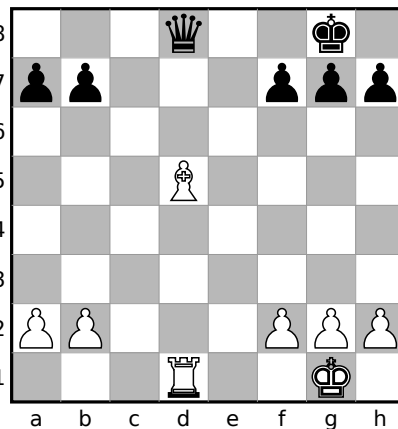
DISCOVERY CHECKLIST

- Which of my pieces stands in front of a rook, bishop or queen?
- Where can it go with a **check**, **capture** or threat of its own?
- A discovered check lets the moving piece do **anything** for one move.

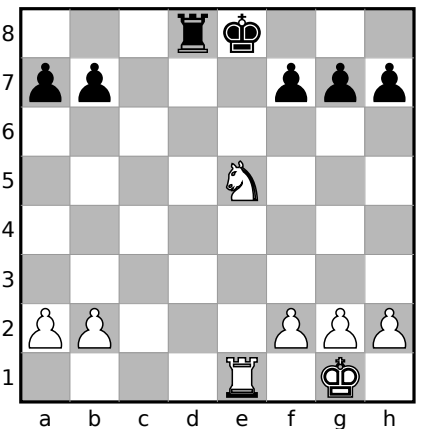
Exercises 11-13 - The Discovered Attack



11 (A). White to move. Find the discovered check. Move: ____ Wins: ____



12 (B). White to move. Find the discovered attack. Move: ____ Wins: ____



13 (C). White to move. Find the discovered check. Move: ____ Wins: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

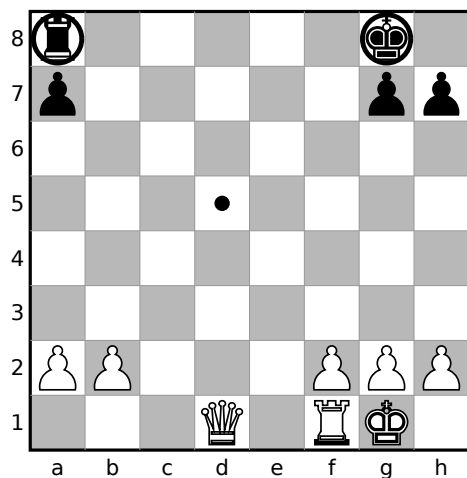
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 11 (A): Bg5+! The bishop moves and uncovers a check from Re1. It also attacks the queen on d8, so White wins the queen (*Bg5+ Kd7 Rd1+ Kc7 Bxd8+*). • **Ex 12 (B):** Bxf7+! The bishop captures with check and uncovers the rook on d1 attacking the queen. After *Kxf7* White plays *Rxd8* (*Bxf7+ Kxf7 Rxd8*). • **Ex 13 (C):** Nc6+! The knight uncovers a check from Re1 and attacks the rook on d8. After the king moves, *Nxd8* wins a rook for a knight (*Nc6+ Kd7 Nxd8 Kxd8*).

The Double Attack

A **double attack** is one move that creates **two threats**. A fork is a double attack made by one piece attacking two targets; other double attacks threaten a capture *and* a checkmate, or a capture *and* something else. A **check plus an attack** is the strongest kind.



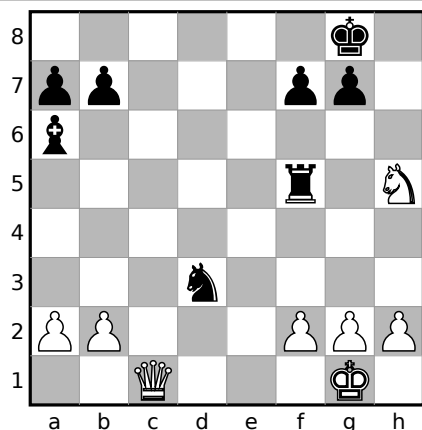
Example. White to move.

Qd5+! The queen checks the king on g8 and attacks the rook on a8. The king must move, and White plays Qxa8+ (Qd5+ Kf8 Qxa8+), winning the rook.

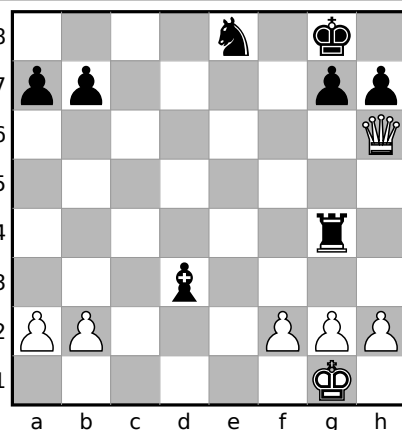
DOUBLE-ATTACK CHECKLIST

- Which enemy pieces are **loose** (not protected)?
- Can one queen move attack two of them, or a piece and the king?
- Make sure your queen is not captured on its new square!

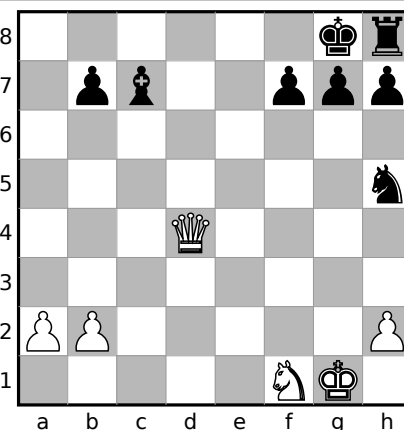
Exercises 14-16 - The Double Attack



14 (A). White to move. Find the double attack. Move: ____ Attacks: ____



15 (B). White to move. Find the double attack. Move: ____ Attacks: ____



16 (C). White to move. Find the double attack. Move: ____ Attacks: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

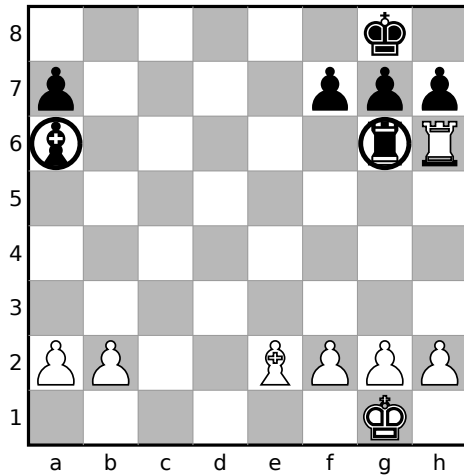
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 14 (A): Qc8+ checks the king and attacks the rook on f5 along the diagonal. After the king moves, Qxf5+ wins the rook (Qc8+ Kh7 Qxf5+). • **Ex 15 (B):** Qe6+ checks the king, and also attacks the rook on g4 and the knight on e8. After the king moves, Qxg4 wins the rook (Qe6+ Kf8 Qxg4). • **Ex 16 (C):** Qc5! attacks the bishop on c7 and the knight on h5 at the same time. Black can only guard one: Qc5 g6 Qxc7.

Removing the Defender

Some enemy pieces are safe only because **another piece protects them**. If you capture (or chase away) that **defender**, the piece it was guarding falls. This tactic is also called **removing the guard**.



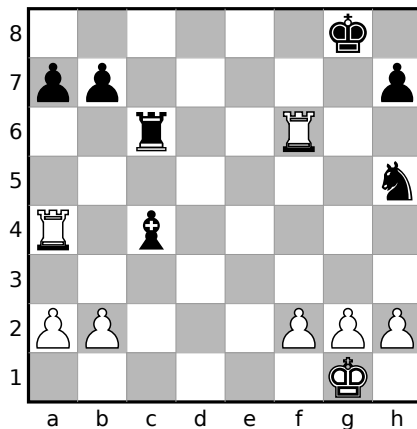
Example. White to move.

Rxg6! The bishop on a6 is protected only by the rook on g6. White captures that rook, Black recaptures, and then the bishop on a6 falls (*Rxg6 fxg6 Bxa6*).

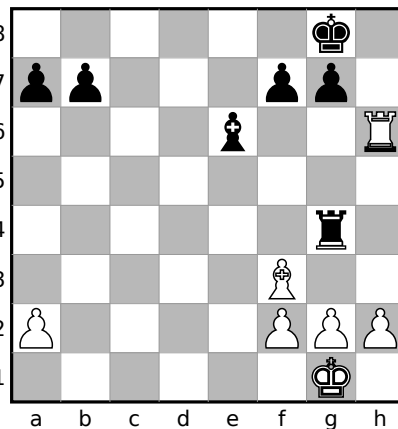
DEFENDER CHECKLIST

- Which enemy pieces are protected by **only one** defender?
- Can I capture that defender, even if I lose a piece for a piece?
- After the trade, is the target still guarded?

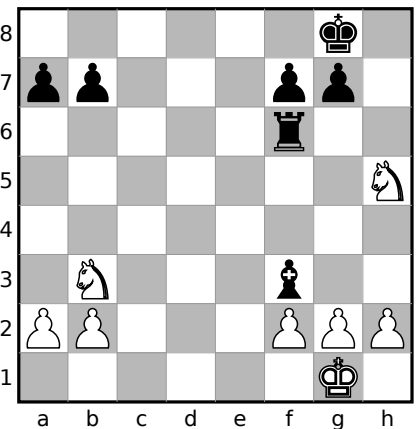
Exercises 17-19 - Removing the Defender



17 (A). White to move. Remove the defender. Move: ____ Then: ____



18 (B). White to move. Remove the defender. Move: ____ Then: ____



19 (C). White to move. Remove the defender. Move: ____ Then: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

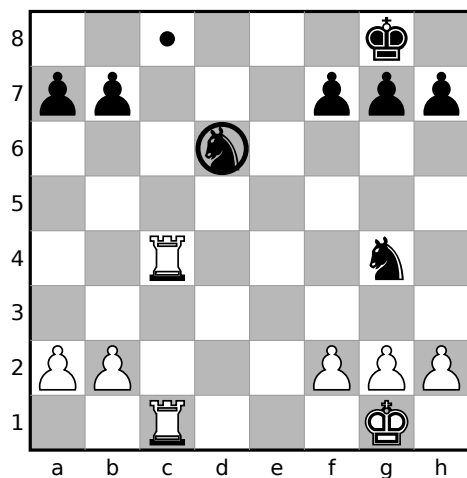
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 17 (A): Rxc6! The rook on c6 guards the bishop on c4. After bxc6, Rxc4 wins the bishop (*Rxc6 bxc6 Rxc4*). • **Ex 18 (B):** Rxe6! The bishop on e6 guards the rook on g4. After fxe6, Bxg4 wins the rook (*Rxe6 fxe6 Bxg4*). • **Ex 19 (C):** Nxf6+! The rook on f6 guards the bishop on f3. After gxf6, gxf3 wins the bishop (*Nxf6+ gxf6 gxf3*).

Deflection

Deflection means forcing an enemy piece away from a job it must do, such as guarding a square, a piece or the back rank. You usually **sacrifice** something to make the piece move, and then you take advantage.



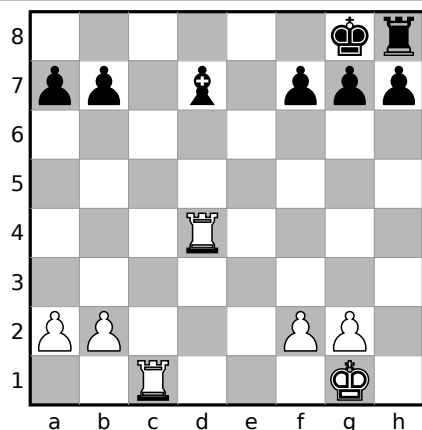
Example. White to move.

Rc8+! The knight on d6 is the only piece guarding c8. Black must take the rook: Nxc8. Then Rxc8# is checkmate because the king has no escape (Rc8+ Nxc8 Rxc8#).

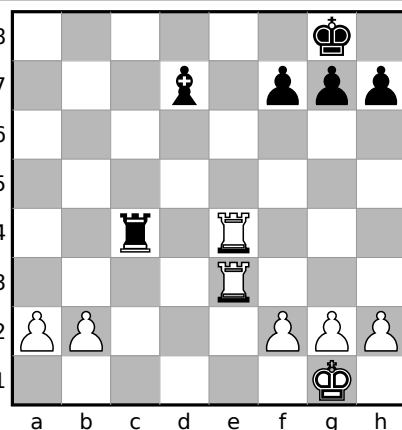
DEFLECTION CHECKLIST

- What is the enemy piece guarding? (a square, a piece, the back rank)
- Can I offer something it **must** capture?
- After it leaves, do I have a winning follow-up?

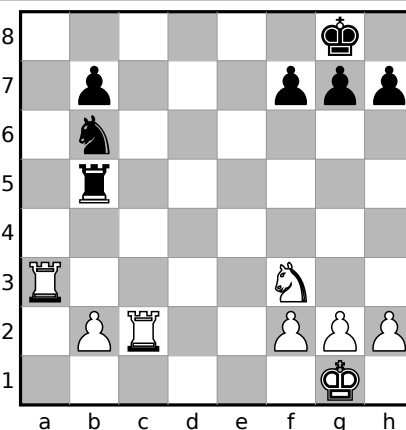
Exercises 20-22 - Deflection



20 (A). White to move. Mate in 2.
Move: ____ Reply: ____ Mate: ____



21 (B). White to move. Mate in 2.
Move: ____ Reply: ____ Mate: ____



22 (C). White to move. Mate in 2.
Move: ____ Reply: ____ Mate: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

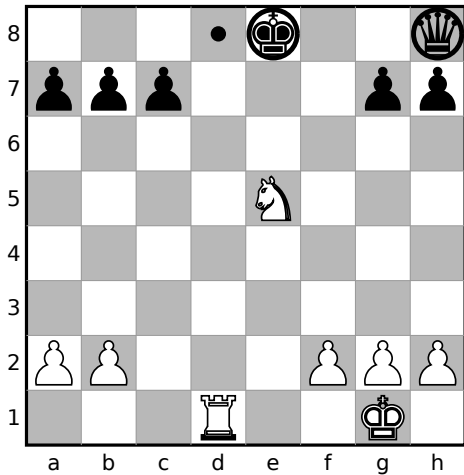
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 20 (A): Rc8+! Bxc8 (the bishop is forced to take) Rd8#. The bishop was guarding d8 and is dragged away (Rc8+ Bxc8 Rd8#). • **Ex 21 (B):** Re8+! Bxe8 Rxe8#. The bishop on d7 guarded e8; it is lured away and the second rook mates (Re8+ Bxe8 Rxe8#). • **Ex 22 (C):** Ra8+! Nxa8 Rc8#. The knight on b6 guarded c8; after Nxa8 the second rook mates (Ra8+ Nxa8 Rc8#).

Decoy

A **decoy** lures an enemy piece (often the king) onto a **bad square**. You sacrifice a piece so that the enemy piece captures it, and then you win material or mate because of where it landed.



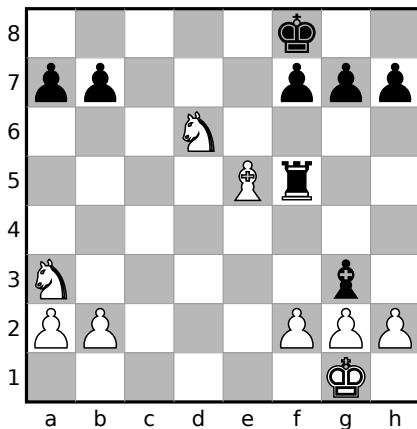
Example. White to move.

Rd8+! The king must capture (Kxd8) or step to e7. After Kxd8, **Nf7+** forks the king on d8 and the queen on h8 (**Rd8+ Kxd8 Nf7+ Ke8 Nxh8**). White wins the queen for a rook.

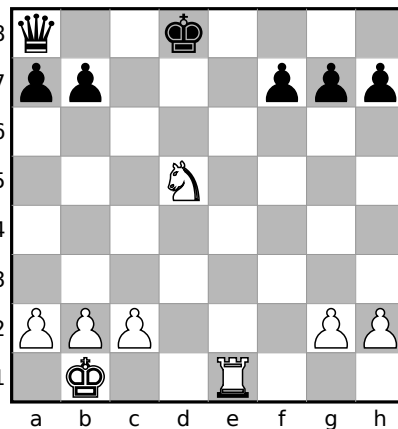
DECOY CHECKLIST

- Can a sacrifice pull the king or queen onto a fork, skewer or check?
- What will the enemy piece attack after it captures?
- Count: is the decoy worth the sacrifice?

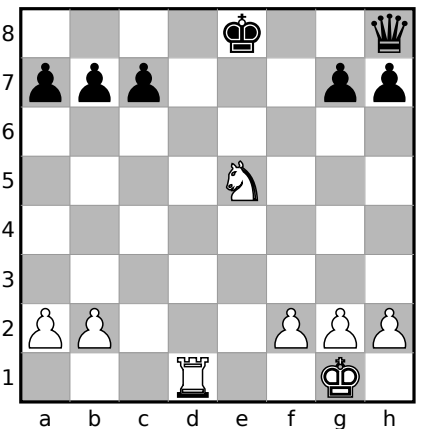
Exercises 23-25 - Decoy



23 (A). White to move. Decoy the king. Move: ____ Then: ____



24 (B). White to move. Decoy the king. Move: ____ Then: ____



25 (C). Same position as the example, but suppose Black replies **Ke7** to **Rd8+**. What does White play? Move: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

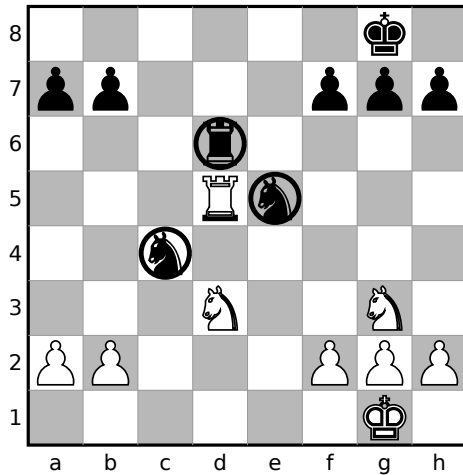
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 23 (A): Bxg7+! Kxg7 pulls the king onto g7, then Nxg7+ wins the rook with check (Bxg7+ Kxg7 Nxf5+). • **Ex 24 (B):** Re8+! Kxe8 Nc7+ forks the king on e8 and the queen on a8 (Re8+ Kxe8 Nc7+ Kd8 Nxa8). • **Ex 25 (C):** After Rd8+ Ke7, the rook simply takes the queen: Rd8+ Ke7 Rxh8. Both king moves lose the queen.

The Overloaded Piece

A defender is **overloaded** when it has **two jobs** at once, for example guarding two different pieces. You attack one of the pieces it guards. When the defender takes, it can no longer guard the other, and you win it.



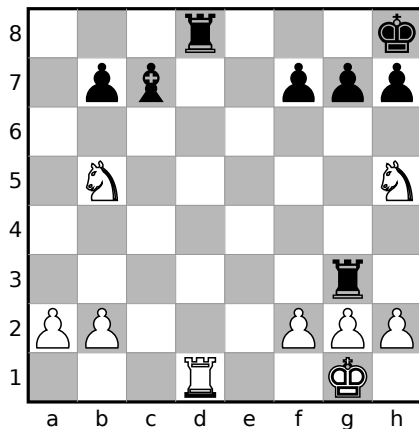
Example. White to move.

Rxd6! The knight on c4 guards both the rook on d6 and the knight on e5. After Rxd6 Nxd6, White plays Nxe5 (Rxd6 Nxd6 Nxe5) and is a knight up. If Black tries Nf3+ first, gxf3 Nxd6 still leaves White ahead.

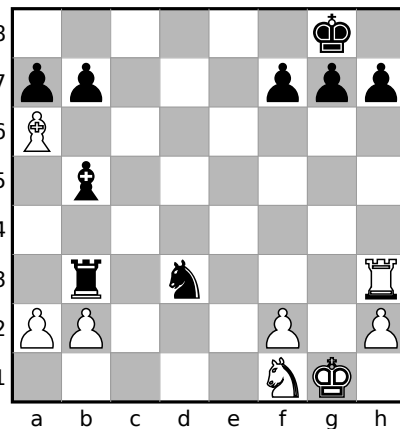
OVERLOAD CHECKLIST

- List what each enemy defender is guarding.
- Is any defender guarding **two** things?
- Attack one of them and take the other.

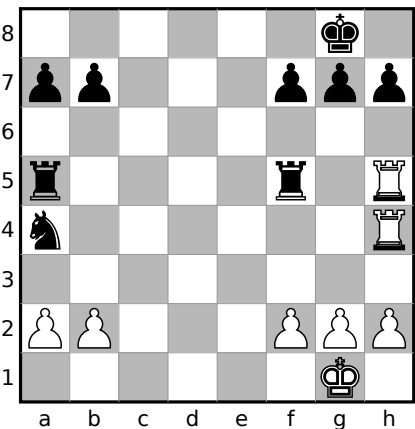
Exercises 26-28 - The Overloaded Piece



26 (A). White to move. Find the overloaded piece. Move: ____ Then: ____



27 (B). White to move. Find the overloaded piece. Move: ____ Then: ____



28 (C). White is a knight down. Find the overloaded piece. Move: ____ Then: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

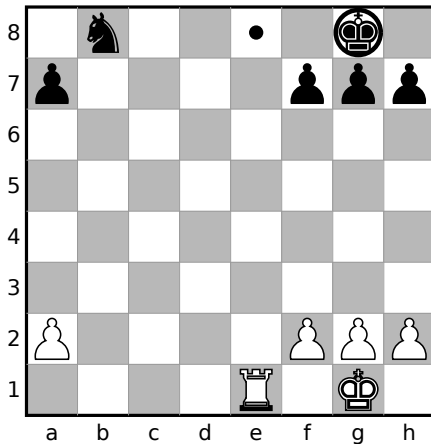
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 26 (A): Rxd8+! The bishop on c7 guards both the rook on d8 and the rook on g3. After Bxd8, Nxg3 wins the other rook (Rxd8+ Bxd8 Nxg3). • **Ex 27 (B):** Bxb5! The rook on b3 guards both the bishop on b5 and the knight on d3. After Rxb5, Rxd3 wins the knight (Bxb5 Rxb5 Rxd3). • **Ex 28 (C):** Rxf5! The rook on a5 guards both the rook on f5 and the knight on a4. After Rxf5, Rxa4 wins the knight back (Rxf5 Rxf5 Rxa4).

Back-Rank Mate

A **back-rank mate** happens when the king is trapped on its first rank (or eighth rank for Black) by its **own pawns**, and a rook or queen gives check along that rank. You can stop it in advance by making **luft** (a little window): move a pawn such as h3 or g3 so the king has an escape square.

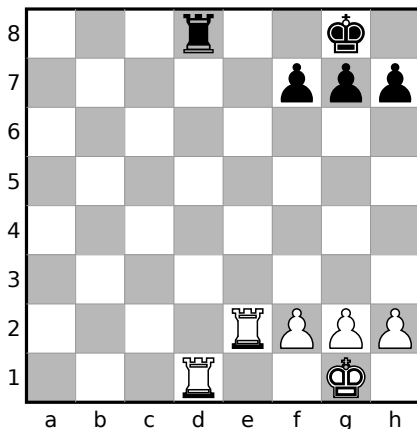


Example. White to move: **Re8#**. The pawns on f7, g7 and h7 block the king.

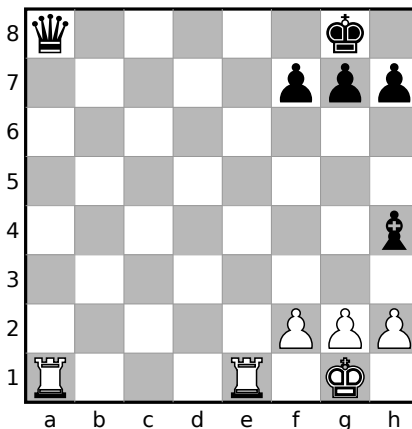
BACK-RANK CHECKLIST

- Is the enemy king stuck behind its own pawns?
- Which enemy piece guards the back rank? Can I remove it?
- Do I have luft for my own king? Make it before it is too late!

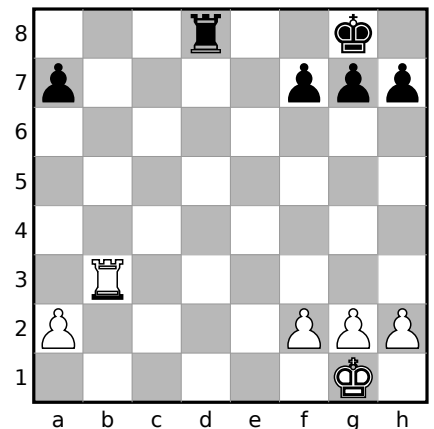
Exercises 29-31 - Back Rank



29 (A). White to move. Mate in 1.
Move: ____



30 (B). White to move. Mate in 2.
Moves: ____



31 (C). White to move. Black threatens mate. Which stop it?
A h3 B Rc3 C Rb1 D Kf1 Answer: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

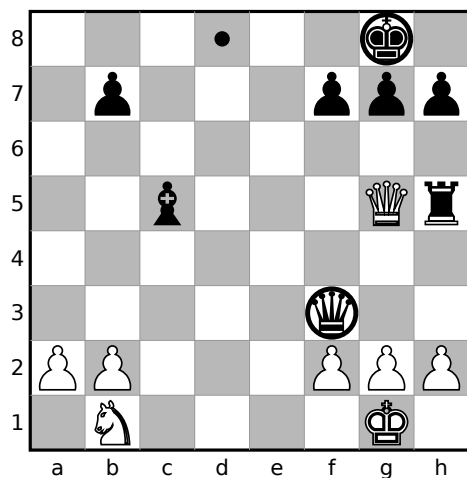
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 29 (A): Rxd8# - the rook captures the guard on d8 and the king has no escape. • **Ex 30 (B):** Rxa8+ Bd8 Rxd8# - the rook takes the queen with check, the bishop must block, and the second rook mates. • **Ex 31 (C):** Black threatens Rd1#. h3 (luft), Rb1 (guarding the first rank) and Kf1 all stop the mate; Rc3 does not. The best habit is to make luft with h3 or g3.

Zwischenzug (the In-Between Move)

A **zwischenzug** (German for “in-between move”) is a move you play **before** the obvious one, usually a **check** or a threat that the opponent must answer. It changes the position so your planned capture works even better.



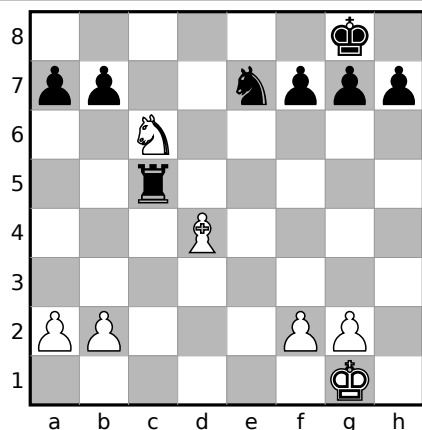
Example. White to move.

Qd8+! White's queen is attacked by the rook on h5, and the obvious gxf3 (capturing the queen) allows Rxc5+. Instead White checks first: Qd8+ Bf8 (forced), and then gxf3 wins the queen (Qd8+ Bf8 gxf3).

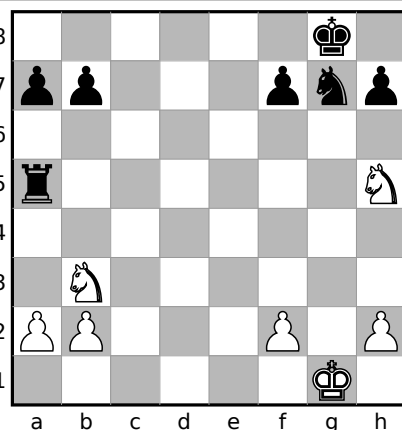
IN-BETWEEN CHECKLIST

- Before making the “obvious” capture, ask: **is there a check?**
- Can a forcing move improve my position or save a piece first?
- Check the opponent's reply to the in-between move.

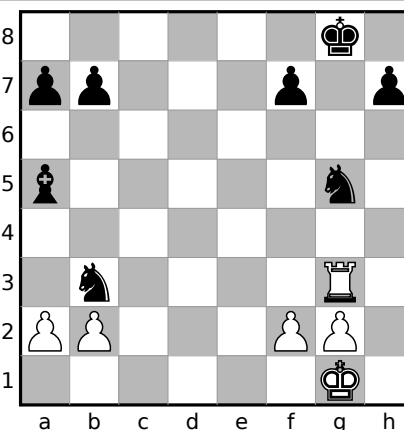
Exercises 32-34 - Zwischenzug (the In-Between Move)



32 (A). White to move. Find the in-between move. Move: ____ Then: ____



33 (B). White to move. Find the in-between move. Move: ____ Then: ____



34 (C). White to move. Find the in-between move. Move: ____ Then: ____

In my own words, this tactic works because...

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Ex 32 (A): Nx7+! Check first, then Bxc5. If White plays Bxc5 at once, Black recaptures Nxc6 (Nx7+ Kf8 Bxc5). • **Ex 33 (B):** Nf6+! The knight on h5 is attacked, but it escapes **with check**, and then Nxa5 wins the rook (Nf6+ Kf8 Nxa5). • **Ex 34 (C):** Rxg5+! Capturing with check comes first. Only after the king moves does White pick up more material (Rxg5+ Kf8 axb3). Playing axb3 at once is worse: Black keeps the knight on g5 and stays better.

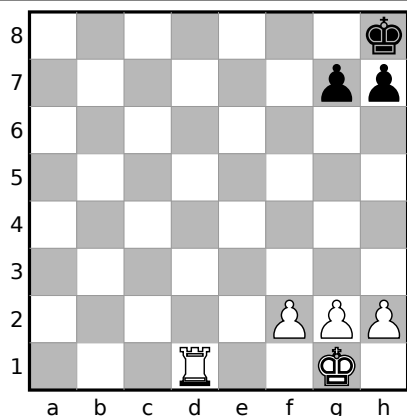
Basic Mating Patterns

Strong players recognise **mating patterns** instantly. Learn these six shapes. In each diagram **White can give checkmate in one move**. Find the move and name the pattern.

THE SIX PATTERNS

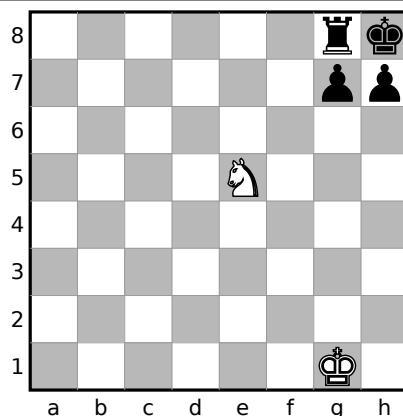
- **Back-rank mate:** a rook or queen checks along the edge rank; the pawns trap the king.
- **Smothered mate:** a knight checks a king that is surrounded by its own pieces.
- **Queen and king:** the queen checks, protected by the king, so it cannot be captured.
- **Two-rook (ladder) mate:** one rook controls a rank, the other checks on the next rank.
- **King and rook:** the king covers the escape squares and the rook gives check.
- **Queen and bishop:** the queen captures next to the king, protected by a bishop.

Exercises 35-40 - Mate in One



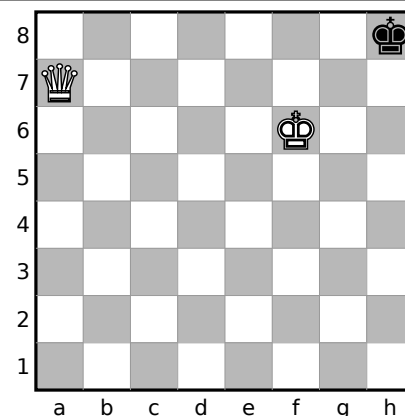
35. White to move. Mate in 1! Move:

Pattern: _____



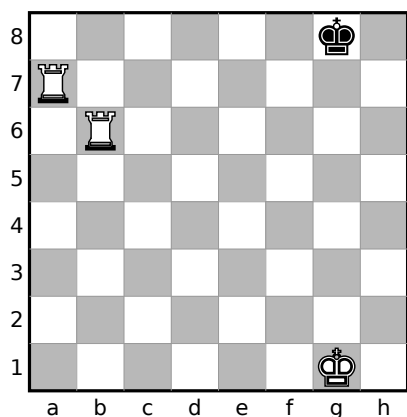
36. White to move. Mate in 1! Move:

Pattern: _____



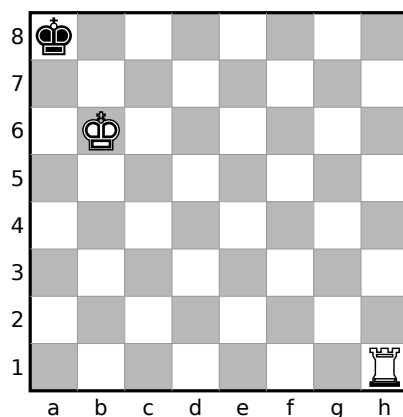
37. White to move. Mate in 1! Move:

Pattern: _____



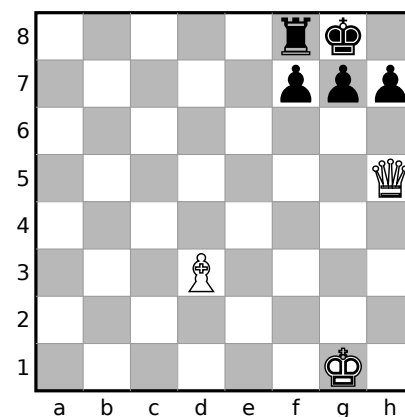
38. White to move. Mate in 1! Move:

Pattern: _____



39. White to move. Mate in 1! Move:

Pattern: _____



40. White to move. Mate in 1! Move:

Pattern: _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

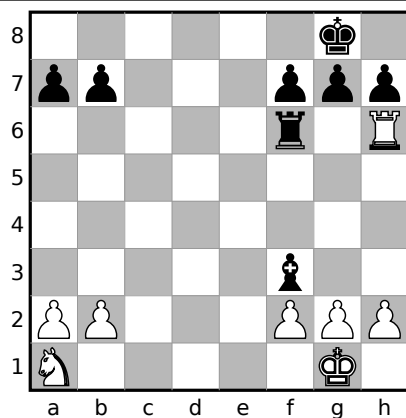
Ex 35-40: 35. Rd8# - Back-rank mate 36. Nf7# - Smothered mate 37. Qg7# - Queen and king mate 38. Rb8# - Two-rook (ladder) mate 39. Rh8# - King and rook mate 40. Qxh7# - Queen and bishop mate

(cover this strip while you work)

Tactical Challenge

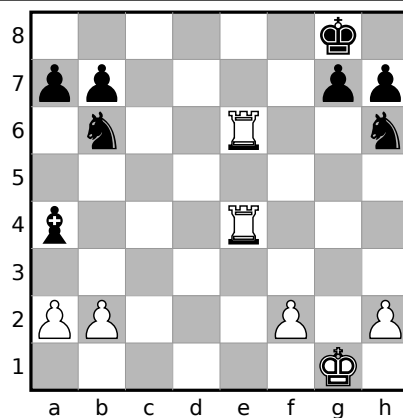
Now mix everything you have learned! Each puzzle uses one of the twelve tactics, but the page does not tell you which. Look for checks, captures and threats. **Level C:** write the tactic's name too.

Exercises 41-46 - Mixed Puzzles



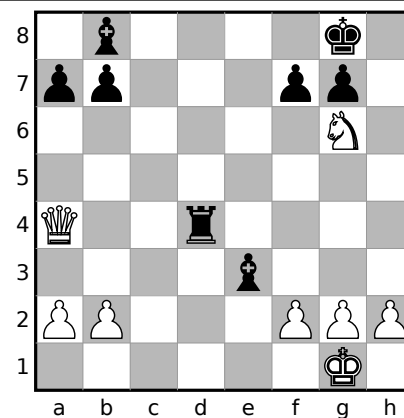
41. White to move. Best move: ____

Tactic: _____



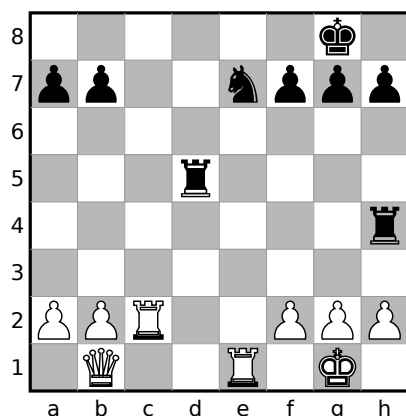
42. White to move. Best move: ____

Tactic: _____



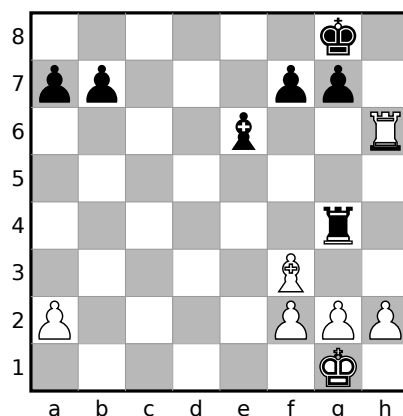
43. White to move. Best move: ____

Tactic: _____



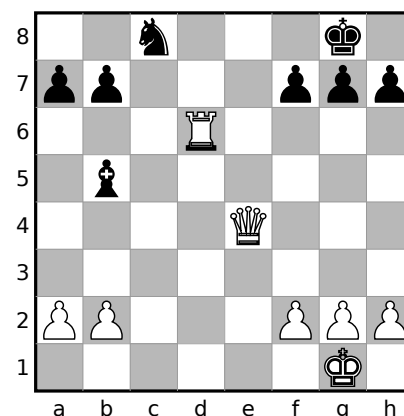
44. White to move. Best move: ____

Tactic: _____



45. White to move. Best move: ____

Tactic: _____



46. White to move. Best move: ____

Tactic: _____

Section 6 puzzles solved: ____ / 46

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

41. Rxf6! gxf6 gxf3: the rook on f6 guards the bishop on f3 (removing the defender). Rxf6 gxf6 gxf3. • 42. Rxb6! axb6 Rxa4: the knight on b6 guards the bishop on a4 (removing the defender). Rxb6 axb6 Rxa4. • 43. Qe8+! forks the king and the bishops: after the king moves White captures a bishop. Qe8+ Kh7 Nf8+ Kh6 Qxe3+. • 44. Rc8+! Nxc8 Re8#: deflection and back-rank mate. Rc8+ Nxc8 Re8#. • 45. Rxe6! fxe6 Bxg4: the bishop on e6 guards the rook on g4 (removing the defender). Rxe6 fxe6 Bxg4. • 46. Rd8+! Be8 Rxe8#: the rook checks, the bishop must block, and the rook takes it with mate (protected by the queen). Rd8+ Be8 Rxe8#.

SECTION 7 • PAGES 61-68

Calculation Training

See moves ahead without touching the pieces

Calculation is seeing future moves **in your head**, before you touch a piece. Good calculation stops you from blundering and helps you find winning combinations. This section trains that skill step by step.

HOW TO CALCULATE

- **1. Pick a candidate move.** Imagine playing it – do not move the piece yet.
- **2. Ask what your opponent's best reply is.** Consider more than one reply if you are not sure.
- **3. Imagine your answer to that reply.** Keep going a few moves.
- **4. Only then move the piece** – for real, on the board.

Exercise 1 - Calculate, Don't Touch

With a partner or coach, set up any simple position. Without touching the pieces, say out loud what you would play and what you think your opponent would reply. Then check by actually playing it out.

Notes on how it went:

Exercise 2 - What Could Go Wrong?

1. You want to play Nf3, but first check: does anything capture on f3?

2. You plan Qxb7, then ask what recaptures on b7.

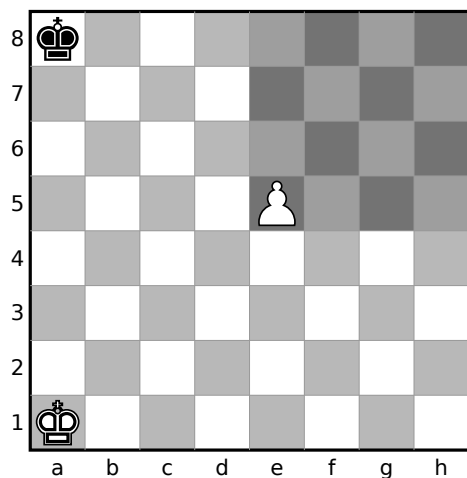
3. You plan a three-move combination and check every reply at each step.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY*(cover this strip while you work)*

Exercise 1: Practice varies – ask your coach to check that you covered every reply, not only the one you expected. • **Exercise 2:** A visualised move is only useful if you check **every** legal reply, not just the one you hope for.

The Rule of the Square

When a king is trying to stop a pawn on its own, draw an imaginary **square** from the pawn to its promotion square. If the defending king can step **inside that square**, it catches the pawn. If not, the pawn runs home and promotes.

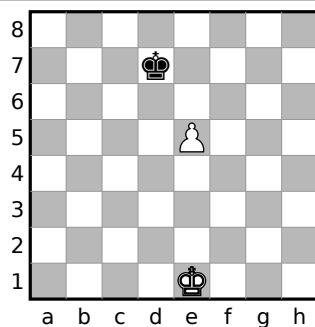


The square of the pawn. If the Black king can enter the shaded square, it catches the pawn.

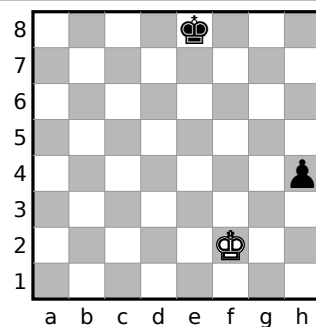
HOW TO DRAW THE SQUARE

- One side of the square is the file the pawn stands on, from the pawn to the last rank.
- The other side is the same number of squares, going sideways.
- If it is the **defender's move**, the square is one square smaller in their favour.

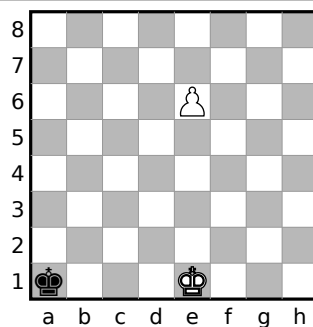
Exercise 3 - In or Out of the Square?



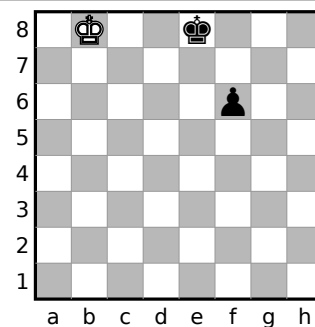
A. Can the lone king catch the pawn? **YES / NO**



B. Can the lone king catch the pawn? **YES / NO**



C. Can the lone king catch the pawn? **YES / NO**



D. Can the lone king catch the pawn? **YES / NO**

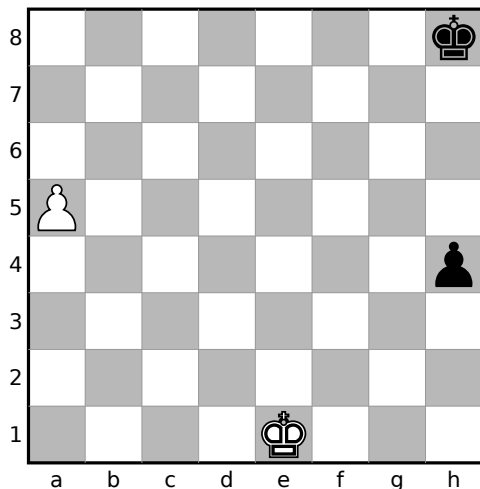
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 3: **A** YES, the king is inside the square - it catches the pawn. **B** YES, the king is inside the square - it catches the pawn. **C** NO, the king is outside the square - the pawn runs home. **D** NO, the king is outside the square - the pawn runs home.

Counting Pawn Races

When two passed pawns race to promote and neither king can catch up, **count the squares** each pawn needs. Whoever needs **fewer pushes** promotes first – and remember who has the move!



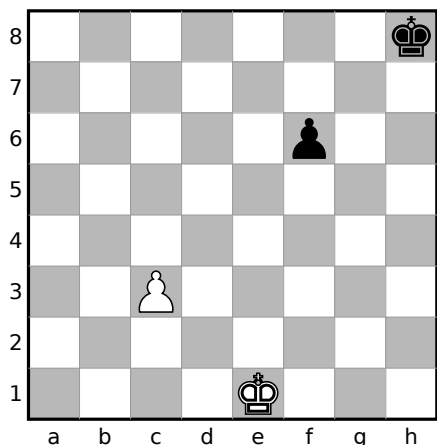
White to move. Both pawns run. Who promotes first?

White's pawn is on a5. It needs to reach a8: that is ____ pushes.

Black's pawn is on h4. It needs to reach h1: that is ____ pushes.

It is White's move. Who promotes first? _____

Exercise 5 - New Race



White to move.

1. How many pushes does the White pawn on c3 need to reach c8? _____

2. How many pushes does the Black pawn on f6 need to reach f1? _____

3. Who promotes first? _____

Careful! A pawn on its **starting square** can move two squares on its first push – do not forget to count that.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 5: White's pawn needs 3 pushes (a5-a6-a7-a8=Q). Black's pawn also needs 3 pushes (h4-h3-h2-h1=Q). White moves first, so White's pawn queens **first**, on move 3, before Black's pawn reaches h1. • **Exercise 6:** Count each pawn's distance to its own promotion rank, then compare – whoever needs fewer pushes (and has the move) wins the race.

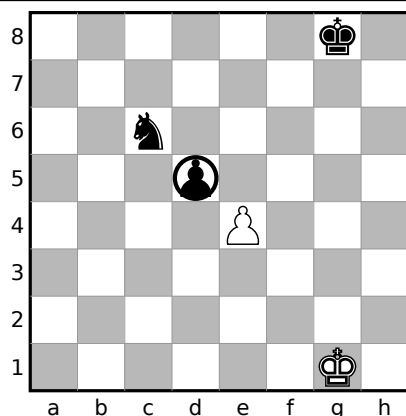
Counting a Chain of Captures

When several pieces can capture on the **same square**, calculate the whole chain before the first capture. Go through it capture by capture, and keep a **running total**. Only the piece values in the chain matter, one at a time.

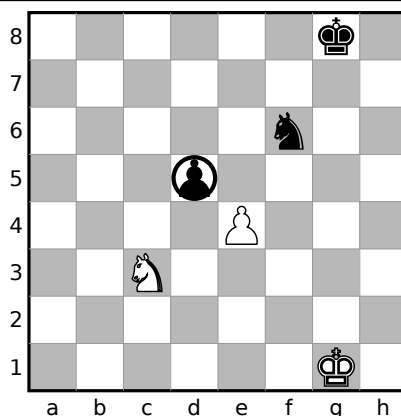
HOW TO COUNT A CHAIN

- List every piece (from both sides) that attacks the square, from **least valuable to most valuable**.
- Capture with your **least valuable** attacker first.
- Add what you win, subtract what you lose, after **every single capture** - not just at the end.
- You may **stop capturing** at any point if it stops being worth it.

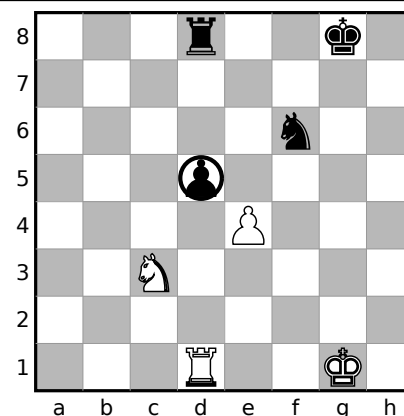
Exercise 7 - Count the Chain



A. White to move. Everyone wants to capture on the marked square. Who ends up ahead, and by how much?



B. White to move. Everyone wants to capture on the marked square. Who ends up ahead, and by how much?



C. White to move. Everyone wants to capture on the marked square. Who ends up ahead, and by how much?

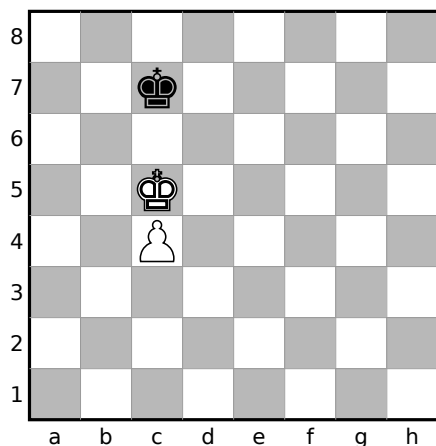
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

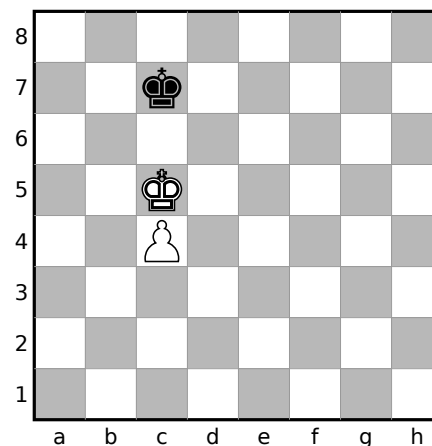
Exercise 7: A White wins a pawn. Nothing recaptures on d5. **B** exd5 (White +1), Nxd5 (Black recaptures, even material on the pawn), Nxd5 (White wins the knight). Net for White: **+3** (a knight). **C** Five captures on d5! Add and subtract as you go: +1, then even (-3+3), then even (-5+5). Net for White: **+1** (a pawn) - White should think twice before starting, since it only wins a single pawn after all the dust settles.

The Opposition

Opposition is when the two kings face each other with **one empty square** between them, on the same file, rank or diagonal. The player who does **not** have to move is said to “**have the opposition**” – and in many king-and-pawn endings, that is a huge advantage, because the other king is forced to step aside.



Black to move. The kings are in opposition. Black must step aside – White wins.



Same position, White to move. Now White must step aside first – the game is a draw.

WHY IT MATTERS

- If you have the opposition, your opponent's king must retreat, and your king can advance to support the pawn.
- If your opponent has the opposition, you must find another plan – sometimes the position is only a draw.
- Whoever is **forced to move** in a face-off often has to give ground.

Exercise 8 – Who Is Better Off?

1. In the left diagram, it is Black's move. What happens to the Black king, and who wins the race for the pawn?

2. In the right diagram, it is White's move. Why does White's king have to give way, and what is the result?

Exercise 9 – Try It Yourself

Set up White Kf5, Pawn f4 and Black Kf7 on a real board. Play it out twice: once with White to move, once with Black to move. What happens each time?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 8: When it is **Black's move**, Black must step away from in front of the pawn, and White's king marches through to help the pawn promote – White wins. When it is **White's move**, White must move first and Black keeps blocking the king – the game is a draw. Whoever does **not** have to move first has the opposition and comes out on top. • **Exercise 9:** Kf5 Pf4 vs Kf7 follows the same pattern: Black to move loses (White wins), White to move draws.

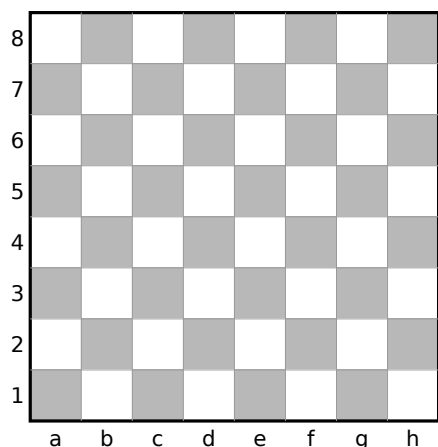
See It Before You Move

Strong players can picture the position several moves ahead **without moving anything**. Practise that skill here: read the moves, picture the board in your head, then answer – **before** you check with real pieces.

Exercise 10 - Picture the Position

Starting from the usual set-up, imagine: **1.Nc3 Nc6 2.Nf3 Nf6**. Do not move any pieces yet.

1. Which square is the White knight from b1 standing on now? _____
2. Which square is the White knight from g1 standing on now? _____
3. Which squares are the two Black knights on now? _____ and _____
4. Has any piece been captured? _____
5. Draw the position after these four moves on the blank board below.



Exercise 11 - Picture the Threat

Now imagine: **1.e4 e5 2.Bc4 Bc5 3.Qh5**. Do not move any pieces yet.

1. Which square is the White queen on now? _____
2. Name two Black pawns or pieces the queen now attacks: _____ and _____
3. Have you seen this idea before? Where?

Now set up the real board and check every answer.

WHY VISUALISING MATTERS

- You cannot touch the pieces in a tournament to “try out” a move – you must see it first.
- The stronger your visualising, the further ahead you can calculate safely.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

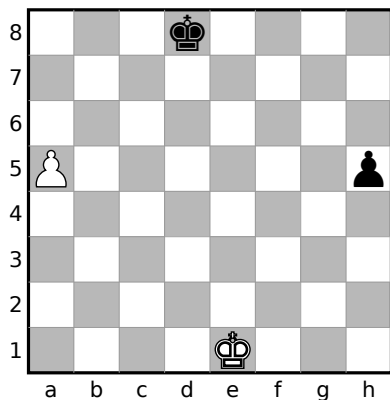
(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 10: After 1.Nc3 Nc6 2.Nf3 Nf6, both White knights sit on c3 and f3; both Black knights sit on c6 and f6. Nothing has been captured. • **Exercise 11:** After 1.e4 e5 2.Bc4 Bc5 3.Qh5, the White queen on h5 attacks the pawn on e5 **and** the pawn on f7 (which is only guarded by the king) – this is the Scholar's Mate idea from page 26!

Calculation Challenge

Use everything from this section: the square of the pawn, counting races, counting exchanges, opposition and visualising ahead. Work out each answer **before** moving any pieces, then set up a board to check yourself.

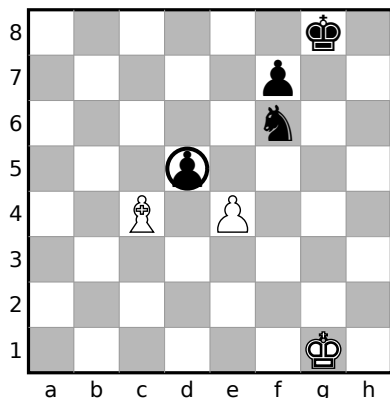
Exercise 12 - Who Queens First?



White to move.

1. How many pushes for the White pawn (a5)? _____
2. How many pushes for the Black pawn (h5)? _____
3. Who promotes first? _____

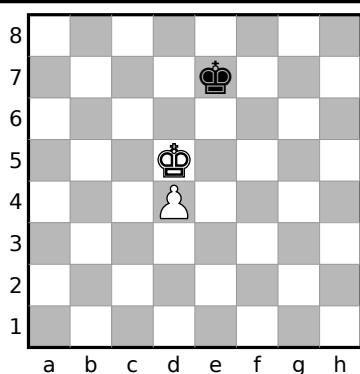
Exercise 13 - Count the Capture Chain



White to move.

White, Black and White can all capture on the ringed square. Work out the full chain and the final result.

Exercise 14 - Opposition Check



Black to move.

Is this the same idea as an earlier page? Which one, and what happens here?

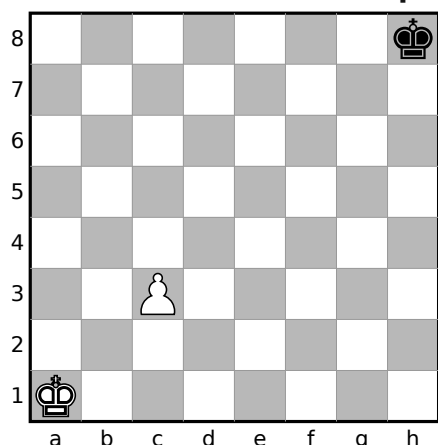
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 12: White's pawn (a5) needs 3 pushes to a8. Black's pawn (h5) needs 4 pushes to h1. White queens first with a move to spare. • **Exercise 13:** exd5 wins a pawn; Black recaptures Nxd5, but then Bxd5 wins the knight too, because the pawn on d5 was not enough protection once the bishop joins in. Net for White: a knight ahead. • **Exercise 14:** This is another example of the opposition from page 65. Whoever does **not** have to move first keeps the advantage.

Section 7 Check-Up

Exercise 15 - Draw the Square



Shade the square of the c3 pawn. Can the Black king reach it in time?

In your own words, how do you draw the square of the pawn?

Exercise 16 - True or False?

1. The rule of the square only works for a lone king against a lone pawn. _____
2. When two pawns race to promote, the one that needs fewer pushes always wins, no matter whose move it is. _____
3. Having the opposition means your opponent's king has to move first when the kings face off. _____
4. In a chain of captures, you should always capture with your most valuable piece first. _____
5. Calculation means picturing moves in your head before playing them. _____

Exercise 17 - My Own Calculation

Choose one position from a recent practice game. Write the move you calculated, your opponent's reply, and your follow-up - exactly what you pictured before moving.

Section 7 score: ____ / 17

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 15: Draw the square from the pawn to its promotion square; if the king can step inside it, it catches the pawn. • **Exercise 16:** 1. True 2. False 3. True 4. False 5. True (2 is false: whoever has the move also matters. 4 is false: capture with your least valuable piece first.) • **Exercise 17:** Ask your coach to check your working. A good answer shows every step, not just the final result.

SECTION 8 • PAGES 69-75

Opening Principles

Start every game on the right foot

The **opening** is the first part of the game, roughly the first 10-15 moves, where both players bring their pieces into play. You do not need to memorise long lines of moves – follow a few simple **principles** instead.

#	Golden Rule	Why it matters
1	Control the centre	Pieces in the middle attack more squares and move to both sides quickly.
2	Develop your pieces	Knights and bishops need to leave the back rank before they can help.
3	Castle early	A king that stays in the centre is easy to attack.
4	Do not move one piece twice	Every extra move with the same piece is a move you are not developing another piece.
5	Keep the queen safe at first	An early queen can be attacked (and chased) by cheap pieces, wasting time.
6	Do not grab pawns at the cost of development	Being a pawn up means little if your king is stuck in the centre.

Exercise 1 - Match the Rule

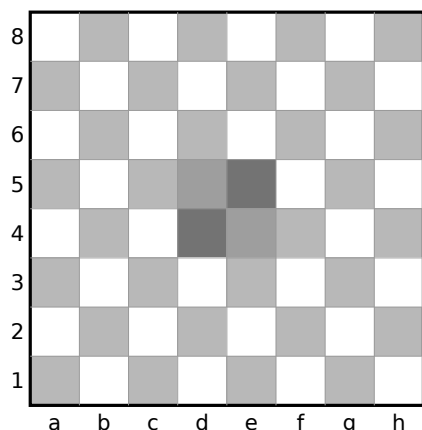
1. Fight for the centre. _____
2. Get your pieces off the back rank early. _____
3. Play O-O or O-O-O in the first ten moves or so. _____
4. Do not play Nf3, then Ng1, then Nf3 again. _____
5. Save Qh5 for later. _____
6. Only push one or two extra pawns before developing. _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY*(cover this strip while you work)*

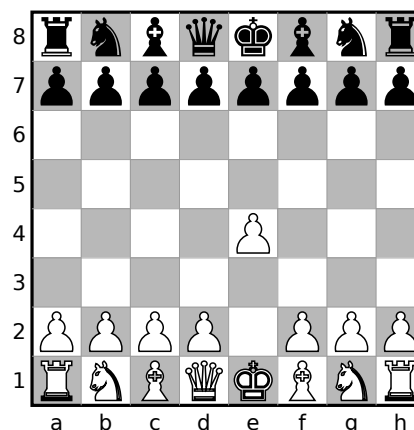
Exercise 1: 1. Control the middle of the board 2. Develop your pieces 3. Castle early 4. Do not move the same piece twice 5. Do not bring the queen out too early 6. Do not make too many pawn moves

Control the Centre

The four **centre squares** – d4, e4, d5 and e5 – are the most valuable squares on the board. A piece there attacks more squares and can swing to either side of the board quickly. Fight for the centre with **pawns and pieces** from your very first move.



The four centre squares.



1.e4 – a strong central pawn move. It opens the bishop and queen.

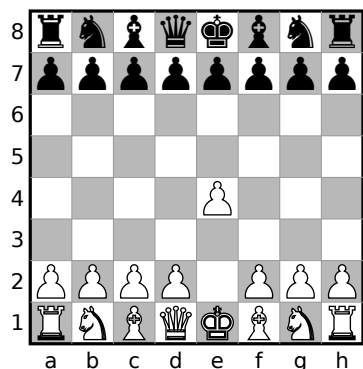
WAYS TO FIGHT FOR THE CENTRE

- Push a central pawn (e4, d4, e5 or d5).
- Develop a knight or bishop so it **attacks** a central square.
- Avoid wasting early moves on the edge of the board (a-file and h-file pawns) unless you have a good reason.

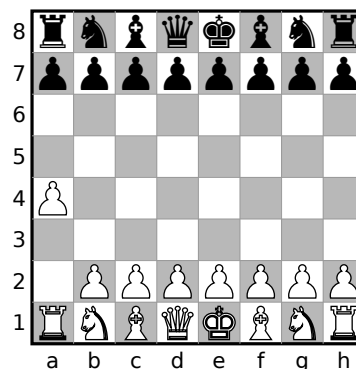
Exercise 3 - Name the Centre Squares

1. Write the names of the four centre squares: _____

Exercise 4 - Which First Move Is Better?



A. 1.e4



B. 1.a4

1. Which move controls the centre? _____
2. Which move does very little for White's position? _____
3. Explain why the better move helps White.

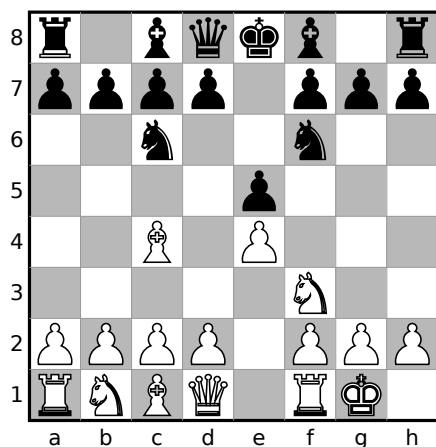
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

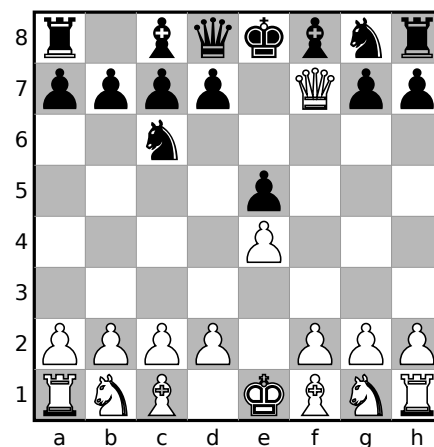
Exercise 3: The centre squares are d4, e4, d5 and e5. • **Exercise 4:** 1. e4 (controls the centre) 2. a4 (an edge pawn move; it does nothing for the centre) 3. e4 is better because it fights for a central square and opens lines for the bishop and queen.

Develop Your Pieces

Developing a piece means moving it off its starting square to a square where it does something useful. In the opening, try to develop a **new** piece with almost every move, rather than moving the same piece again and again.



A. After 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.O-O. Two minor pieces are out, and the king is safe.



B. After 1.e4 e5 2.Qh5 Nc6 3.Qxf7?? A pawn was grabbed, but no minor piece has moved and the queen is exposed.

DEVELOPMENT CHECKLIST

- Aim to develop a **knight or bishop** with each of your first several moves.
- Knights before bishops is a common (not required) order, since a knight's best square is often obvious.
- Castle once two or three pieces are out.
- Count: after move 6 or 7, how many of your minor pieces are developed?

Exercise 5 - Count the Development

1. In Diagram A, how many White minor pieces are developed? ____ Has White castled? ____
2. In Diagram B, how many White minor pieces are developed? ____
3. Which position would you rather have, and why?

Exercise 6 - Quick Questions

1. Which pieces count as "minor pieces" that need developing, and which other piece gets developed by a special move?
2. Why do most players leave their rooks and queen for later?
3. True or False: moving your knight from b1 to c3 to a4 and back to c3 counts as three development moves. ____

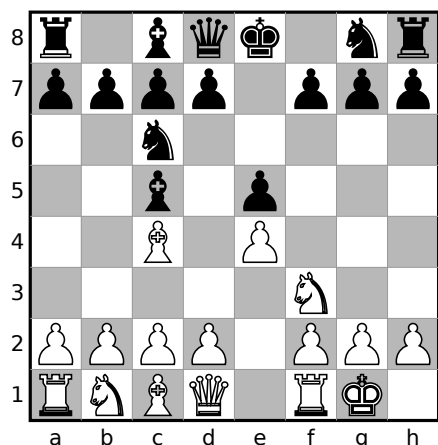
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

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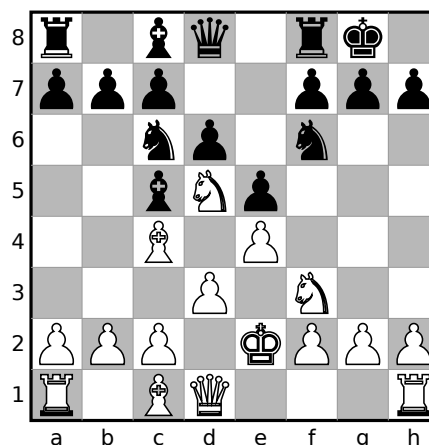
Exercise 5: Position A: White has developed 2 minor pieces (the knight and the bishop) and castled. Position B: White has developed 0 minor pieces - only the queen has moved, and she will likely be chased and lose time. • **Exercise 6:** 1. Knights and bishops (minor pieces), and the king (by castling). 2. The rooks connect and the queen usually develops in the middlegame. 3. True.

Castle Early for King Safety

Castling does two good things at once: it tucks your king away behind its pawns, and it brings a rook toward the centre. Most strong players castle by move 6–10 unless they have a very good reason not to.



A. White castled on move 4. The king is safe behind its pawns.



B. White played 5.Ke2?! (perhaps to guard a pawn) instead of developing. The king is stuck in the centre and can never castle now.

WHAT LOSES YOUR CASTLING RIGHTS

- Moving your **king** for any reason (even one square and back).
- Moving a **rook** – you lose the right to castle on **that side only**.
- Once lost, castling rights on that side are gone for the **rest of the game**.

Exercise 7 - Compare the Kings

1. Which position's king is safer, A or B? Explain in one sentence.

2. In Diagram B, can White still castle? Why or why not?

Exercise 8 - True or False?

1. What two things can make you lose castling rights on one side?

2. Why is castling often a good move even if nothing is attacking your king yet?

3. True or False: it is fine to delay castling forever as long as your pieces are developed. _____

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 7: Position A: White has already castled (king on g1). Position B: White has not castled, has lost the right to castle at all (the king would have needed to castle earlier), and the king is stuck in the centre on move 7 – that is risky. • **Exercise 8:** 1. King move without castling, or rook move on that side. 2. Because it takes the king to safety and connects the rooks in one move. 3. No – you should still finish developing sensibly, but do not delay castling for too long.

Common Opening Mistakes

Most opening mistakes break one of the golden rules from page 69. Learn to spot them - in your own games and your opponent's.

MISTAKE 1

1.e4 e5 2.Qh5?! Bringing the queen out too early. Black can gain time by attacking it, for example with 2...Nc6 and later ...g6.

MISTAKE 2

1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5?! Moving the same knight a third time and abandoning development for a quick (but well-met) attack.

MISTAKE 3

1.a4 a5 2.h4 h5 3.Ra3 Ra6 Playing only edge pawns and rook moves - no fight for the centre and no minor-piece development at all.

MISTAKE 4

1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.Qh5?! Nf6?? The famous Scholar's Mate trap from page 26 - Black forgets to watch f7 and 5.Qxf7# is mate.

Exercise 9 - Spot Your Own Mistake

Look back at a recent game of yours (or ask your coach for one). Did you break a golden rule in the opening? Write what happened.

Exercise 10 - Which Rule Was Broken?

- 1.e4 e5 2.Qh5?! Which golden rule was broken? _____
- 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5?! Which golden rule was broken? _____
- 1.a4 a5 2.h4 h5 3.Ra3 Ra6 Which golden rule was broken? _____
- 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.Qh5?! Nf6?? Which golden rule was broken? _____

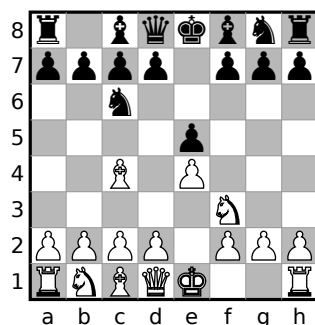
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

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Exercise 9: Personal answers about your own games. Ask your coach to check you identified a real principle that was broken. • **Exercise 10:** 1. Bringing the queen out too early. 2. Moving the same knight a third time and abandoning development for a quick (but well-met) attack. 3. Playing only edge pawns and rook moves - no fight for the centre and no minor-piece development at all. 4. The famous Scholar's Mate trap from page 26 - Black forgets to watch f7 and 5.

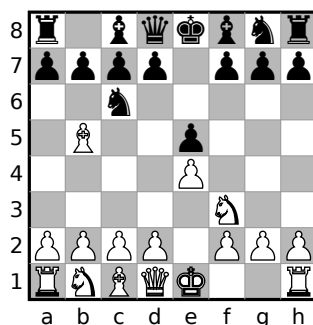
A Few Famous Openings

Chess players have studied openings for hundreds of years, and many have names. You do **not** need to memorise these – just recognise a few common names so you understand your coach and other players.



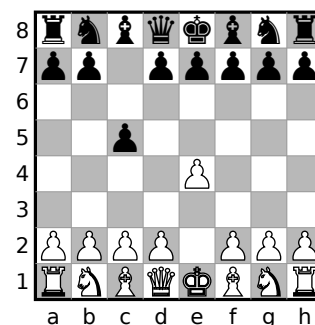
Italian Game

1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4



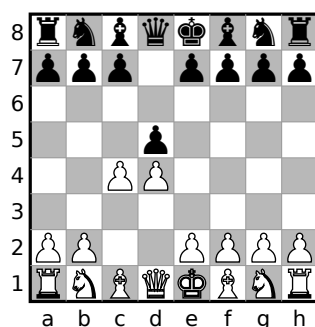
Ruy Lopez (Spanish Game)

1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5



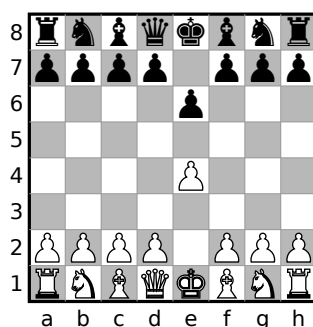
Sicilian Defence

1.e4 c5



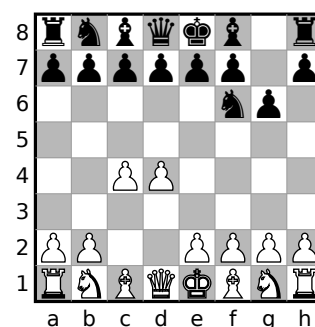
Queen's Gambit

1.d4 d5 2.c4



French Defence

1.e4 e6



King's Indian Defence

1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6

Exercise 11 - Match the Name

Write the opening's name next to its first moves.

1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 - _____

1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 - _____

1.e4 c5 - _____

1.d4 d5 2.c4 - _____

1.e4 e6 - _____

1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 - _____

Exercise 12 - Think About It

1. Do you need to memorise long lines of opening theory as a beginner? Why or why not?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 11: 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 = Italian Game 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 = Ruy Lopez (Spanish Game) 1.e4 c5 = Sicilian Defence 1.d4 d5 2.c4 = Queen's Gambit 1.e4 e6 = French Defence 1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 = King's Indian Defence • **Exercise 12:** You do not have to memorise long lines – knowing a name and the first few moves is enough for now. The most important thing is still to follow the golden rules.

Section 8 Check-Up

Exercise 13 - List the Six Golden Rules

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

Exercise 14 - True or False?

1. Controlling the centre only matters for advanced players. _____
2. Castling brings your king to safety and helps a rook at the same time. _____
3. It is fine to move your queen out on move 2 if it wins a pawn. _____
4. Moving the same piece twice in the opening is usually a waste of time. _____
5. Once you lose castling rights on one side, you cannot get them back. _____

Exercise 15 - Play and Reflect

Play a full game (or ask your coach for a game to look at). Write your first six moves, then answer the questions.

My first six moves: _____

1. Did I control the centre? _____
2. Did I develop a new piece almost every move? _____
3. Did I castle within the first ten moves? _____

SECTION 8 IN ONE BOX

- Control the centre, develop pieces, castle early.
- Do not move one piece twice, and keep the queen safe at first.
- A few extra pawn moves are fine; a whole opening of pawn moves is not.

Section 8 score: ____ / 17

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 13: 1. Control the centre 2. Develop your pieces 3. Castle early 4. Do not move one piece twice 5. Keep the queen safe at first 6. Do not grab pawns at the cost of development. • **Exercise 14:** 1. False 2. True 3. False 4. True 5. True • **Exercise 15:** Ask your coach to check that your opening followed the golden rules.

SECTION 9 • PAGES 76-82

Middlegame Skills

Make a plan once development is complete

The **middlegame** begins once both sides have developed their pieces. There are no more obvious “rules” to follow – now you need a **plan**. This section teaches you to read the position and choose one.

THREE QUESTIONS FOR EVERY MIDDLEGAME MOVE

- What is my weakest piece, and how can I improve it?
- What is my opponent’s plan, and how can I stop it?
- Which files, squares or diagonals are weak, and can I use them?

The rest of this section looks at the clues that help answer these questions: **pawn structure, open files, outposts** and **good and bad bishops**.

Exercise 1 – Ask Yourself

Look at a position from one of your own games, around move 12–15. Answer the three questions above for that position.

What is my weakest piece, and how can I improve it?

What is my opponent’s plan, and how can I stop it?

Which files, squares or diagonals are weak, and can I use them?

COACH’S ANSWER KEY

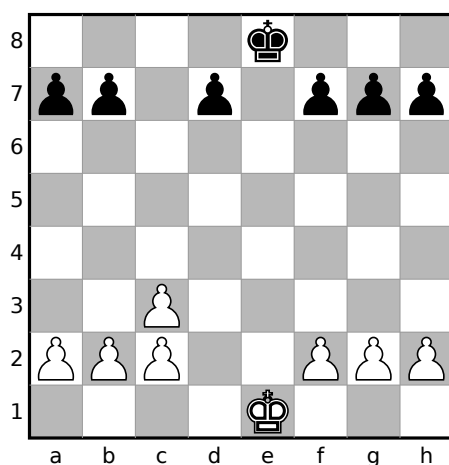
Exercise 1: Personal answers – ask your coach whether your plan used one of the three questions.

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Pawn Structure

Pawns cannot move backwards, so every pawn move changes the position **forever**. The pattern your pawns make is called the **pawn structure**. Some pawn structures are weak and can be attacked; learn to spot them.

Weakness	What it means	Why it matters
Doubled pawns	Two of your pawns on the same file.	They cannot protect each other and one is often weak.
Isolated pawn	A pawn with no friendly pawn on either neighbouring file.	No pawn can ever protect it.
Backward pawn	A pawn that has fallen behind its neighbours and cannot safely advance.	It is stuck and often attacked along its file.



White has doubled c-pawns. Black has an isolated d-pawn.

SPOTTING WEAKNESSES

- Scan each file: are there two pawns of the same colour on it?
- Check both neighbouring files for a pawn of the same colour – none means isolated.
- A weak pawn is not lost immediately – but it is a good long-term target.

Exercise 2 - Find the Weaknesses

1. In the diagram above, name White's weakness and where it is.

Name Black's weakness and where it is.

Exercise 3 - Name the Weakness

1. Two pawns of the same colour on the same file: _____
2. A pawn with no friendly pawn on either side-by-side file: _____
3. A pawn that has fallen behind and cannot safely move forward: _____
4. Why do these pawns matter, even if they are not captured right away?

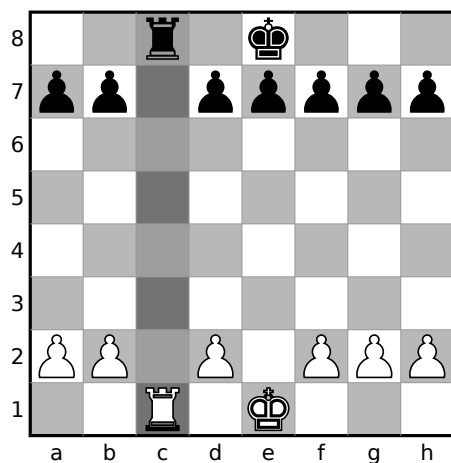
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

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Exercise 2: White has **doubled pawns** on the c-file (c2 and c3). Black has an **isolated pawn** on d7 (no pawn on the c- or e-file to support it). • **Exercise 3:** 1. Doubled 2. Isolated 3. Backward 4. A weakness other pieces can often attack more easily than a healthy pawn.

Open and Half-Open Files

A file with **no pawns at all** is **open**. A file with a pawn of only **one** colour is **half-open** for the side with no pawn there. Rooks and queens are much stronger on open and half-open files, because they can slide all the way along them.



The c-file is open. White's rook already stands on it, ready to use it.

USING AN OPEN FILE

- Move a rook (or both rooks) onto the open file.
- "Doubling rooks" (two rooks on the same open file) is very strong.
- Look to invade the **7th or 2nd rank** once your rook controls the file.

Exercise 4 - Find the Files

1. Which file is fully open in the diagram above? _____

2. Which file is half-open for White? _____

Exercise 5 - Open, Half-Open or Closed?

Look at your own last game's pawn structure (or one your coach gives you). List every open and half-open file.

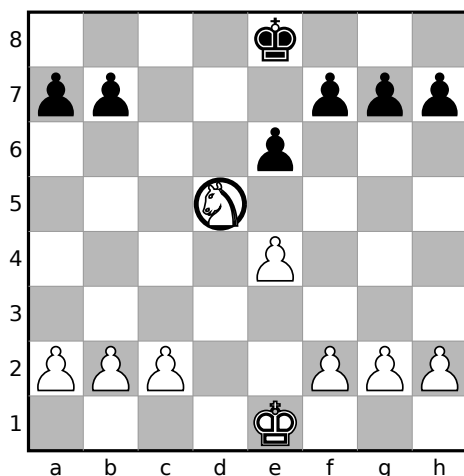
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

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Exercise 4: The c-file is fully **open** (no pawns for either side). The e-file is **half-open** for White (White has no pawn there, but Black still has one on e7). • **Exercise 5:** An open file has no pawns of either colour; a half-open file has a pawn of one colour only. Rooks and queens love open and half-open files because nothing blocks them.

Outposts

An **outpost** is a square – often in the opponent’s half of the board – that **no enemy pawn can ever attack**. A knight placed on a good outpost, protected by one of your own pawns, can be extremely strong and very hard to remove.



The knight on d5 sits on an outpost: no Black pawn can ever reach c6 or e6 to attack it (pawns cannot move backwards).

IS IT A GOOD OUTPOST?

- Check the two files next to the square: does the enemy have a pawn that could still capture there?
- Is it protected by one of **your** pawns?
- Is it in a useful part of the board (usually past the middle of the board)?

Exercise 6 - Spot the Outpost

1. In the diagram above, why can no Black pawn ever attack the knight on d5?

2. Which White pawn protects the knight? _____

Exercise 7 - Outpost or Not?

1. A square that a pawn can still capture on is a good outpost. _____
2. A knight is usually better on an outpost than a bishop is. _____
3. An outpost should ideally be protected by one of your own pawns. _____
4. Outposts are only useful on your own side of the board. _____

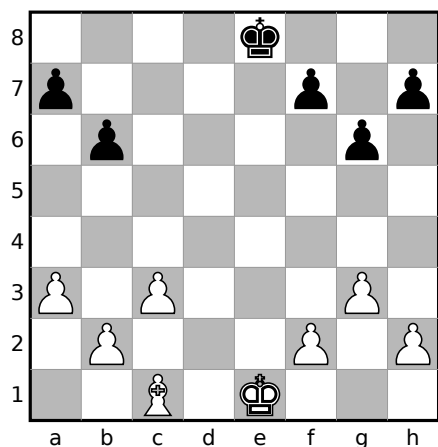
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

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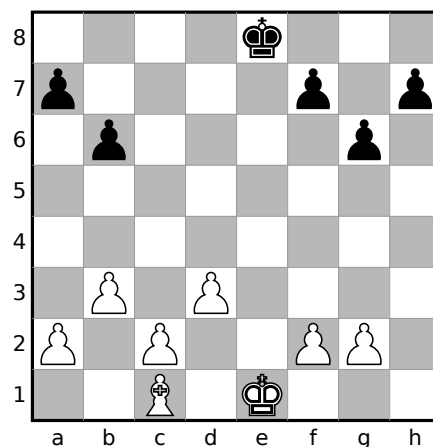
Exercise 6: The knight on d5 is an **outpost**: no Black pawn can ever attack it (the c-file is empty and the pawn on e6 cannot move backwards to attack d5). It is also protected by White's pawn on e4. • **Exercise 7:** An outpost is a square, usually in enemy territory, that no enemy pawn can ever attack, ideally protected by one of your own pawns. Knights love outposts.

Good Bishop, Bad Bishop

A bishop only ever moves on **one colour** of square. If **your own pawns** sit mostly on that same colour, the bishop is boxed in – a **“bad bishop”**. If your pawns sit mostly on the **other** colour, the bishop has plenty of room – a **“good bishop”**.



Good. White's pawns are mostly on **light** squares. The dark-squared bishop has open diagonals.



Bad. White's pawns are mostly on **dark** squares. The dark-squared bishop is boxed in by its own pawns.

IMPROVING A BAD BISHOP

- Try to trade it for an enemy piece before it gets too cramped.
- Move your pawns off the bishop's colour when you safely can.
- Sometimes reroute the bishop outside your own pawn chain.

Exercise 8 - Which Is Which?

1. Which colour squares does the bishop on c1 move on? _____
2. In the “good bishop” diagram, what colour are most of White's pawns on? _____

Exercise 9 - In Your Own Games

Look at a position with bishops from one of your games. Is each bishop good or bad? Why?

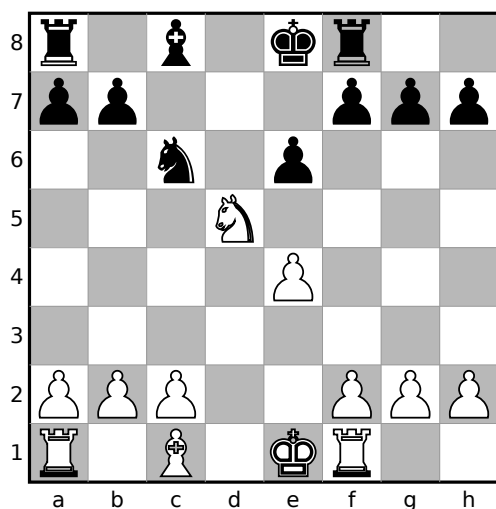
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

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Exercise 8: The bishop on c1 is **dark-squared**. In the “good bishop” diagram, most White pawns stand on light squares, so they do not block the bishop's diagonals. In the “bad bishop” diagram, several pawns stand on dark squares (the bishop's own colour), blocking it in. • **Exercise 9:** A good bishop has most of its own pawns on the opposite colour; a bad bishop has many of its own pawns on its own colour, blocking its diagonals.

Putting It Together: Make a Plan

Now combine everything from this section. Look at the position below and answer the three middlegame questions from page 76 to build a simple plan.



White to move. Both sides have finished developing.

CLUES IN THIS POSITION

- Is there an open file? Who can use it first?
- Is either knight on a strong outpost?
- Are there any weak pawns to aim at?
- Are the bishops good or bad?

Exercise 10 - Write White's Plan

1. Which file is open, and which side can use it more easily?

2. Is the White knight on a good outpost? Why?

3. Write a short plan (2-3 sentences) for White's next few moves.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 10: The d-file is open – a rook belongs there. The knight on d5 is already a strong outpost. A sound plan is: double rooks on the d-file, keep the knight on d5, and look to expand with pawns on the kingside or queenside once the rooks are doubled.

Section 9 Check-Up

Exercise 11 - True or False?

1. Two pawns of the same colour on one file are called doubled pawns. _____
2. An open file has a pawn of one colour but not the other. _____
3. An outpost should ideally be protected by one of your own pawns. _____
4. A bishop is "good" when most of its own pawns block its diagonals. _____
5. Making a plan means answering questions about weak pieces, the opponent's ideas and weak squares. _____

Exercise 12 - Middlegame Vocabulary

Term	Write what it means in your own words
Doubled pawns	
Isolated pawn	
Open file	
Half-open file	
Outpost	
Good bishop	
Bad bishop	

SECTION 9 IN ONE BOX

- Ask: what is my weakest piece? What does my opponent want? Which squares or files are weak?
- Target doubled, isolated and backward pawns.
- Use open and half-open files with your rooks. Plant knights on outposts.

Section 9 score: ____ / 12

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 11: 1. True 2. False 3. True 4. False 5. True (2 is false: that describes a half-open file. 4 is false: that describes a bad bishop.) • **Exercise 12:** Ask your coach to check your working.

SECTION 10 • PAGES 83-89

Endgame Fundamentals

The king becomes a fighting piece

The **endgame** is the final part of the game, when most pieces have been traded off. Many games are decided here, and the endgame follows its **own rules** – the most important being that the king stops hiding and becomes a strong piece.

WHAT CHANGES IN THE ENDGAME

- With fewer pieces on the board, the **king is much safer** – bring it to the centre and use it to fight.
- **Passed pawns** (pawns with no enemy pawn able to stop them) become extremely valuable.
- Small advantages, such as a slightly better king position, matter much more than in the middlegame.
- Knowing the **basic checkmates** and a few key techniques lets you convert an advantage into a win.

Exercise 1 - True or False?

1. The king should hide in the corner during the endgame. _____
2. In the endgame, passed pawns become very valuable. _____
3. There are usually fewer pieces on the board in the endgame. _____
4. You should avoid trading pieces if you are ahead in material. _____

Remember: the king is worth fighting with once there are not many pieces left to attack it!

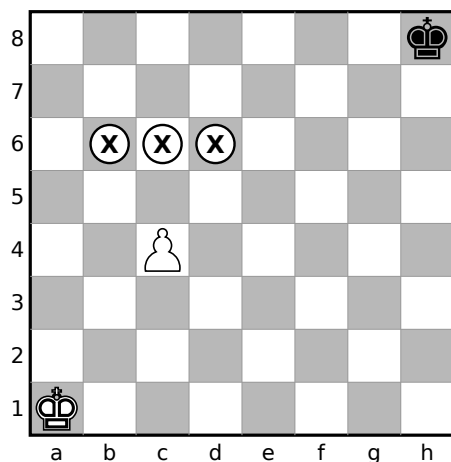
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

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Exercise 1: 1. False 2. True 3. True 4. False (trading pieces usually helps the side that is ahead, as you learned on page 35)

King and Pawn Endgames: Key Squares

You met the **opposition** on page 65. Here is a related idea: **key squares**. For a pawn that has not yet crossed the middle of the board, the key squares are usually the **three squares two ranks ahead of it**. If your king reaches a key square, you win the pawn ending – **even if it is your opponent's move**.



The three key squares for the pawn on c4: b6, c6 and d6.

USING KEY SQUARES

- If your king can reach a key square before the enemy king stops it, the pawn ending is winning.
- If the enemy king gets there first (or blocks you), the ending is usually a draw.
- The further a pawn has advanced, the closer its key squares are to it.

Exercise 2 - Find the Key Squares

1. Name the three key squares for the pawn on c4 in the diagram above: _____

Exercise 3 - Understanding Key Squares

1. Where are the key squares usually found, compared to the pawn?

2. What happens to the key squares as the pawn advances further up the board?

Try it: set up King c5 (or b6/d6), Pawn c4, Black king c8. Play it out – White wins every time.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 2: b6, c6 and d6 are the three key squares for a pawn on c4. If the White king reaches any of them, White wins **no matter whose move it is** – that is what makes a key square special. • **Exercise 3:** Key squares for a pawn are usually two ranks ahead of it (three squares side by side). The further the pawn advances, the closer the key squares come, until on the 6th rank the key squares are right next to the promotion square.

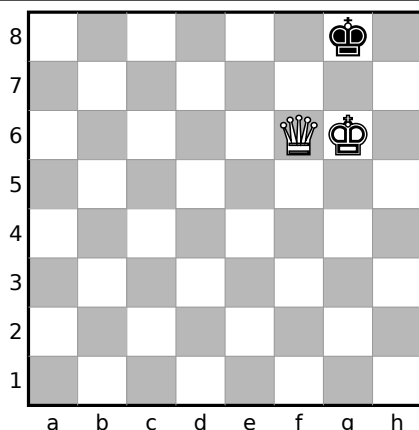
Checkmate with King and Queen

A king and queen can always checkmate a lone king. The technique: use the queen to force the enemy king toward the **edge** of the board, then bring your **own king up** to help deliver the final mate. The queen alone usually cannot mate – she needs her king’s help.

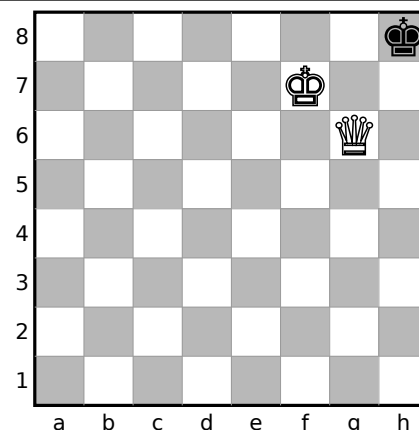
THE TECHNIQUE

- Keep the queen a **knight’s-move away** from the enemy king to box it in without allowing a capture.
- Walk your own king closer, **step by step**.
- Only deliver the final check once your king is close enough to support the queen.
- **Watch out for stalemate!** Never leave the enemy king with no legal moves unless it is also in check.

Exercise 4 - Mate in One



A. White to move. Mate in 1. Move:



B. White to move. Mate in 1. Move:

Exercise 5 - Understand the Technique

1. Describe the technique for mating with king and queen, in your own words.

2. Why can the queen usually not deliver mate without her own king close by?

3. What mistake must you avoid at all costs when the enemy king is almost trapped?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 4: A. Qg7# - the queen mates right next to the king, protected by the White king so it cannot be captured. B. Qg8# - the same idea, mating on the back rank. • **Exercise 5:** 1. Box the king toward the edge using the queen a knight's-move away, then bring your king up to help mate. 2. Because a lone king right next to the enemy king would be an illegal move (kings may never touch) or would let the enemy king escape or capture. 3. Stalemate - giving the enemy king no legal moves without it being in check.

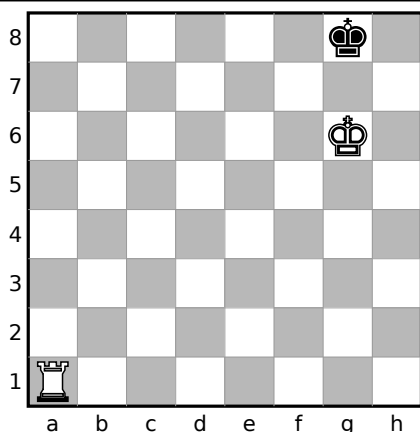
Checkmate with King and Rook

King and rook against a lone king is another **basic checkmate** every player must know. The rook drives the enemy king to the edge of the board, one rank or file at a time, while your own king walks up to help.

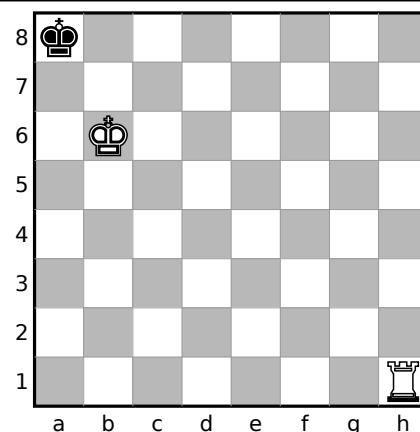
THE "BOX" TECHNIQUE

- Use the rook to cut the enemy king off along a rank or file, shrinking the "box" it can move in.
- When the enemy king moves toward the rook, **step the rook back one** to keep the box safe.
- Bring your own king closer on every move you can.
- Deliver mate only when the enemy king is on the edge and your king is close enough to support the rook.

Exercise 6 - Mate in One



A. White to move. Mate in 1. Move:



B. White to move. Mate in 1. Move:

Exercise 7 - Explain the Technique

1. Describe how to drive the enemy king to the edge with a rook, in your own words.

2. Why must the rook never let the enemy king get close to it while undefended?

3. Summarise the whole plan in one sentence.

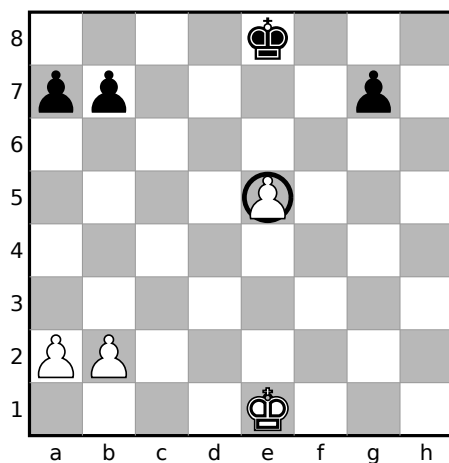
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 6: A. Ra8# - the rook checks along the back rank; the king on g6 cuts off every escape square. B. Rh8# - the same idea on the edge. • **Exercise 7:** 1. Use the rook to push the enemy king to the edge of the board one rank (or file) at a time, walking your own king closer each time. 2. Because the enemy king could simply approach and capture an undefended rook, or escape past it. 3. It walks the enemy king to the edge, then mates along that edge, with the king one knight's-move away for support.

Passed Pawns

A **passed pawn** has no enemy pawn on its own file **or either neighbouring file** that could ever stop it or capture it on its way to promotion. Passed pawns become very dangerous in the endgame, because fewer pieces remain to stop them.



The pawn on e5 is passed – no black pawn can ever stop it.

USING A PASSED PAWN

- **Push it** whenever it is safe to do so.
- **Support it** with your king or a rook behind it.
- A **rook belongs behind** a passed pawn – your own or the opponent's.
- An advanced, protected passed pawn can be worth much more than a normal pawn.

Exercise 8 – Spot the Passed Pawn

1. In the diagram above, which White pawn is passed? Explain why the a- and b-pawns are not.

Exercise 9 – Understanding Passed Pawns

1. In your own words, what makes a pawn “passed”?
2. Why are passed pawns extra dangerous in the endgame compared to the middlegame?
3. What should you generally do with your own passed pawn?

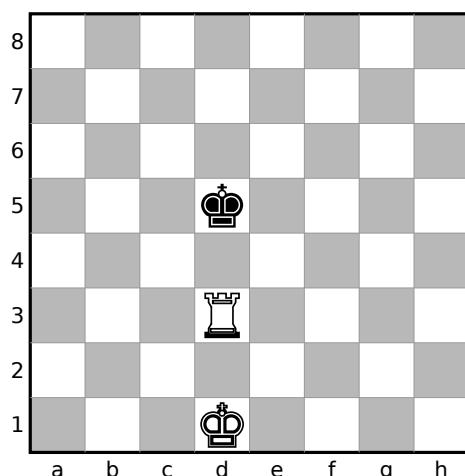
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 8: The pawn on e5 is **passed**: Black has no pawn on the d-, e- or f-files to stop it. The a- and b-pawns for both sides are not passed – they block each other. • **Exercise 9:** 1. A pawn with no enemy pawn on its own file or either neighbouring file, anywhere in front of it. 2. It cannot be stopped by another pawn, only by a piece or the king. 3. Push it, and support it with your king and pieces.

Rook Endgames: Cutting Off the King

Rook endgames are the **most common** of all endgames. One key idea: use your rook to **cut the enemy king off** along a file or rank, so it cannot cross to help its own position. This is often the first step in a winning plan.



Black to move. The rook on d3 cuts the Black king off from the queenside.

CUTTING OFF THE KING

- Place your rook on a rank or file the enemy king must cross.
- The enemy king cannot step onto or past a square controlled by your rook.
- Once cut off, bring your own king around to make progress on the other side.
- Rooks are also strong **behind** passed pawns (see page 87).

Exercise 10 - Explain the Idea

1. In the diagram above, explain what the rook on d3 does to the Black king, and how it helps White.

ENDGAME REMINDERS

- Activate your king – it is a fighting piece now.
- Look for key squares in pawn endings.
- Push and support your passed pawns.
- Use your rook to cut off the enemy king or sit behind a passed pawn.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 10: The rook on d3 cuts the Black king off along the d-file: Black's king can never cross that file. White's king can now approach freely on the other side and help make progress, for example toward a pawn or toward mating the king.

Section 10 Check-Up

Exercise 11 - Name the Idea

1. A king and this piece can always mate a lone king by boxing it toward the edge, needing the king close by. _____
2. A king and this piece drives the enemy king to the edge one rank or file at a time. _____
3. Squares that, once your king reaches them, win a pawn ending no matter who moves. _____
4. Using a rook (or king) to stop the enemy king crossing a rank or file. _____

Exercise 12 - True or False?

1. A key square, once reached by your king, wins the pawn ending no matter whose move it is. _____
2. A queen can usually checkmate a lone king without any help from her own king. _____
3. A passed pawn has no enemy pawn on its file or either neighbouring file in front of it. _____
4. A rook is a bad piece to place behind a passed pawn. _____
5. The king should stay passive and safe throughout the endgame. _____

Exercise 13 - Practise the Basic Mates

With a partner or coach, set up king and queen vs king, then king and rook vs king. Take turns practising the mating technique from both sides.

- ☐ I can checkmate with king and queen from any starting position.
- ☐ I can checkmate with king and rook from any starting position.
- ☐ I know what a key square is and can find one.
- ☐ I understand what makes a pawn passed.

SECTION 10 IN ONE BOX

- Bring your king into the fight once pieces are traded off.
- Learn the king+queen and king+rook mates cold – practise both sides.
- Push passed pawns, support them, and use rooks to cut off the enemy king.

Section 10 score: ____ / 13

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 11: 1. King and Queen 2. King and Rook 3. Key squares 4. Cutting off the king • **Exercise 12:** 1. True 2. False 3. True 4. False 5. False • **Exercise 13:** Ask your coach to check your working.

SECTION 11 • PAGES 90-94

Game Analysis

Learn the most from every game you play

Playing games is important, but **reviewing** them afterwards is how you actually improve. Analysing a game means going back through it, move by move, to find your good decisions, your mistakes, and what you can learn.

WHY ANALYSE YOUR GAMES?

- You find out **exactly** where a game was won or lost, not just the final result.
- You spot **patterns** in your mistakes – for example, always forgetting to check for threats.
- You remember opening ideas and tactics better when you review your own games than from a book.
- Even strong players who win still analyse their games – there is always something to learn.

How to Record a Game

To analyse a game later, you first need to **write it down** while you play, using the notation from page 11. Most tournaments require this. Write each move as it happens, for both sides, numbered like this:

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5

Exercise 1 - My Analysis Habits

1. Do you currently write down your games? If not, how could you start?

2. After a game, do you usually look back at it? Why or why not?

A GOOD HABIT TO START TODAY

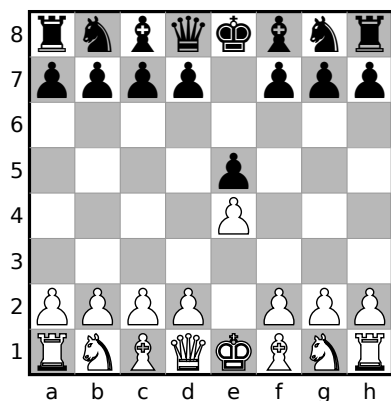
- Keep every score sheet from your games, even the ones you lose – especially the ones you lose!
- Review a game within a day or two, while you still remember how it felt to play it.
- Even five minutes of honest review is worth more than replaying the same mistake again.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY*(cover this strip while you work)*

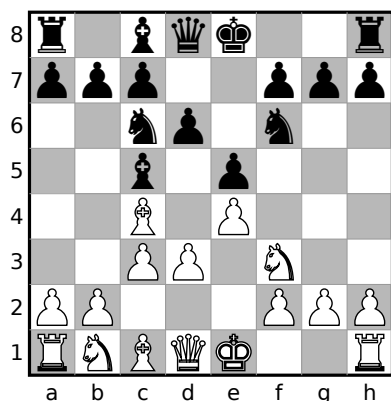
Exercise 1: Personal answers – the aim is to notice patterns (for example, always rushing, or always missing checks) rather than just listing single moves.

A Sample Game - Part 1

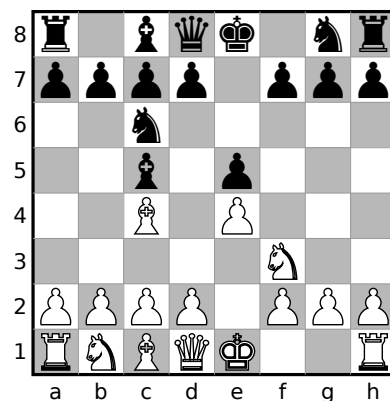
Here is a real-style beginner game, move by move, with notes. Follow along and think about **why** each move is played before reading the note.



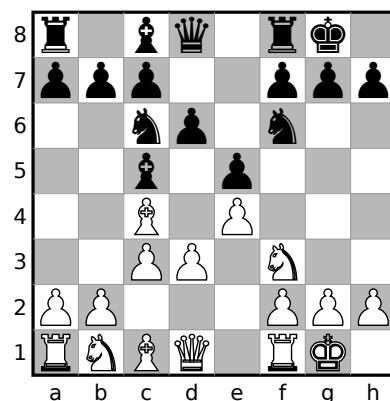
GOOD 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 – both sides control the centre and develop a knight. A calm, principled start.



OK 5.d3 d6 – solid but modest; d4 immediately was also possible, fighting harder for the centre.



GOOD 3.Bc4 Bc5 – both bishops develop actively, aiming at the centre and the f7/f2 squares.



GOOD 6.O-O O-O – both kings reach safety, right on schedule (compare with page 72).

Exercise 2 - Follow Along

1. Which golden rule (or rules) does each move above follow? Write one for each of the four positions.

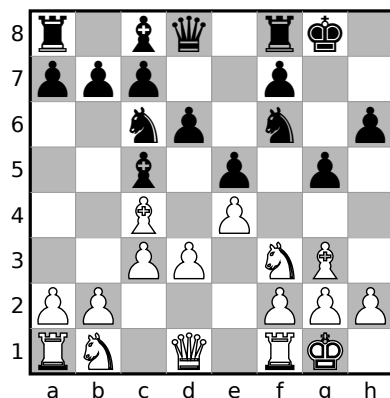
COACH'S ANSWER KEY

Exercise 2: Every move shown here follows the golden rules from Section 8: control the centre, develop pieces, castle early. None of them is a mistake.

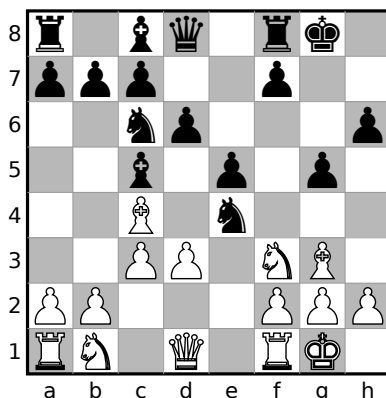
(cover this strip while you work)

A Sample Game - Part 2: The Blunder

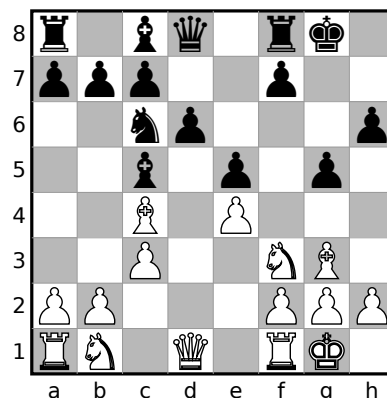
After 9.Bg3, Black played a natural-looking move – but it was a blunder. Look carefully before reading on.



Before. Position after 9.Bg3. It is Black's move.



9...Nxe4?? Black grabs the e4 pawn with the knight.



10.dxe4 White simply recaptures. Black has lost a whole knight for a pawn!

WHAT WENT WRONG

- Black saw a pawn to capture and took it without checking what defends it.
- The pawn on d3 was a defender of e4 the whole time – a one-second blunder check would have caught it.
- This is exactly the mistake from page 43– 44: always ask, **“what can recapture?”** before you capture.

Exercise 3 - Find and Explain the Blunder

1. Which move was the blunder, and what did it miss?

2. What should Black have asked before playing that move?

3. Suggest a better move for Black instead of the blunder.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 3: Black played **9...Nxe4??**, forgetting that the pawn on d3 guards e4. White simply replied **10.dxe4** and won the knight for nothing. Black should have looked at every White piece that could recapture on e4 before playing the move – the blunder check from page 43.

Analysing Your Own Games

Use this checklist after every serious game, win or lose. It only takes a few minutes and is one of the fastest ways to improve.

POST-GAME CHECKLIST

- Play through the whole game again, slowly.
- Mark every move you were **not sure about** with a question mark.
- For each one, ask: what did I miss? What would I play now?
- Find the single **most important moment** of the game – often a missed tactic or a blunder.
- Write one sentence you will remember for next time.

The Mistake Log

Turn back to page 3 – you learned to write down mistakes as you make them. Use the table below to log mistakes from your own games and watch the patterns appear.

Date	What happened	What I missed	What I will do next time

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 4: A good analysis names a specific move, explains what was missed (using words like fork, pin, blunder check, development) and suggests a concrete improvement – not just “I should play better.”

Section 11 Check-Up

Exercise 5 - True or False?

1. You should only analyse games that you lose. _____
2. Writing down your moves during a game lets you analyse it afterwards. _____
3. Even strong players analyse their winning games. _____
4. Analysing your games is mostly a waste of time compared to just playing more. _____
5. Finding the single most important moment of a game is a useful analysis habit. _____

Exercise 6 - Analyse a Full Game

Choose one full game of your own (win, loss or draw). Write it out below (or attach your score sheet), then answer the questions.

My moves:

1. What was the single most important moment of the game?
2. What is one thing you will do differently next time?

SECTION 11 IN ONE BOX

- Write down every game so you can review it later.
- Question every uncertain move; find the single most important moment.
- Keep a mistake log and watch for patterns – that is where the real improvement happens.

Section 11 score: ____ / 7

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 5: 1. False 2. True 3. True 4. False 5. True • **Exercise 6:** Ask your coach to check that your analysis names a specific mistake and a specific improvement.

SECTION 12 • PAGES 95-97

Tournament Preparation

Play your best when it matters most

Playing in a tournament is exciting – and a little different from casual games. A bit of preparation helps you play your best and enjoy the experience, whatever the result.

THE WEEK BEFORE

- Review your basics – checkmates, tactics and your thinking routine – rather than cramming brand-new openings.
- Solve a few puzzles each day to keep your calculation sharp.
- Get plenty of **sleep** in the nights before the event.
- Pack your bag early: scoresheet pen, a chess set for between-round practice, water and a snack.

ON THE DAY

- Eat a proper meal beforehand – a hungry brain does not calculate well.
- Arrive with time to spare; rushing in late is stressful.
- Take a short walk or stretch between rounds if you can – it clears your head.
- Remember your **tournament rules and manners** from page 31.

Exercise 1 - My Tournament Checklist

- ☐ I have reviewed my basic checkmates and tactics.
- ☐ I know what time and where the event starts.
- ☐ I have packed my bag (pen, set, water, snack).
- ☐ I have planned to get a good night's sleep.
- ☐ I have eaten before the round.

Exercise 2 - Think About It

1. Why might studying a brand-new opening the night before a tournament not be a good idea?

COACH'S ANSWER KEY*(cover this strip while you work)*

Exercise 1: Personal answers – a good list covers sleep, food, equipment and a calm mind, not just chess study. • **Exercise 2:** Cramming new openings the night before rarely helps and can leave you tired and confused; reviewing your basics calmly and getting good sleep helps far more.

During the Game

However the game is going, your job is always the same: play the **best move you can find** in the position in front of you right now.

MANAGING YOUR CLOCK

- Do not spend too long on the opening moves you already know.
- Save extra time for **critical moments**: sharp tactics, captures, or unclear positions.
- If you are very low on time, simplify your thinking: look for checks, captures and threats, choose a safe move, and keep going.
- Running out of time (“flagging”) loses the game, even in a winning position – always keep an eye on the clock.

STAYING CALM

- A blunder or a bad position is not the end of the game – keep fighting for the best move available now.
- Take a slow breath if you feel rushed or upset; it costs a few seconds and often saves many more.
- Remember your thinking routine from Section 5, especially when you are tired or under pressure.

Exercise 3 – What Would You Do?

1. You are losing badly and want to give up in your head.

2. You feel your clock time running low.

3. You just blundered a piece.

4. You are winning easily.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 3: 1. Keep playing your best – opponents make mistakes too, and you learn more from fighting on than from giving up. 2. Slow down on the most important decisions, but do not panic – use your thinking routine even faster and simpler. 3. Take a breath, accept it happened, and look for the best move in the new position – do not let one mistake cause a second one. 4. Stay careful until the very end – many winning positions are thrown away by relaxing too soon.

After the Game

What you do after a tournament game matters almost as much as the game itself. Win or lose, there is always something to take away.

EVERY TIME

- Shake hands and thank your opponent, whatever the result (see page 31 for tournament manners).
- Write the result on your scoresheet if required, and hand it in.
- Take a short break before your next round – stretch, have a drink, relax.

WHEN YOU HAVE TIME

- Look back through the game using the analysis habits from Section 11.
- Add anything important to your Mistake Log on page 93.
- Note one thing you did **well** – it is just as useful to remember your good decisions.

Exercise 5 – My Tournament Reflection

1. What is one thing that went well for you in a recent tournament or practice game?

2. What is one thing you want to improve before your next event?

Exercise 6 – Win or Lose?

1. Why is it important to analyse your games even when you win?

SECTION 12 IN ONE BOX

- Prepare calmly: rest, food, and a review of your basics – not late-night cramming.
- During the game, always look for the best move in front of you, and manage your clock.
- After the game, shake hands, rest, and analyse when you can – win or lose.

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Exercise 5: Personal answers – the goal is a specific, honest reflection rather than just “I played well” or “I played badly.” • **Exercise 6:** Both winning and losing games teach you something – the habit of analysing (Section 11) matters more than the result of any single game.

SECTION 13 • PAGES 98-100

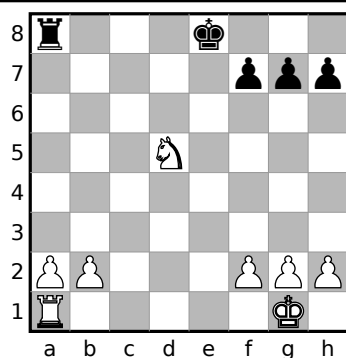
Final Challenge

Show everything you have learned

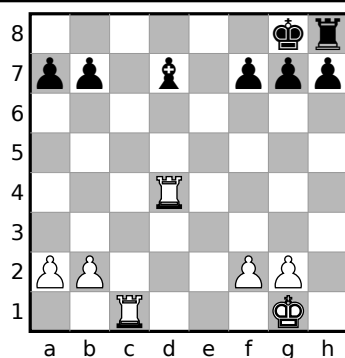
This is your **Final Knowledge Test**, covering the whole workbook. Take your time, and do your best without looking back at earlier pages first.

Part A - Knowledge Questions

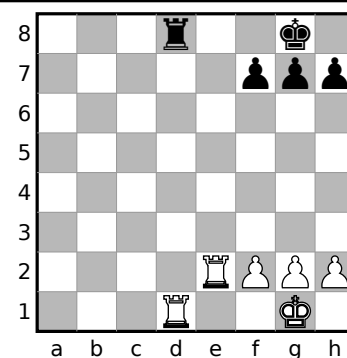
1. Which piece is worth about 9 points? _____
2. Which two pieces are worth about 3 points each? _____
3. What is the notation symbol for a capture? _____
4. What is the notation for kingside castling? _____
5. What do we call it when the player to move has no legal move and is not in check? _____
6. Name the three ways to answer a check. _____
7. What is a fork? _____
8. What is a passed pawn? _____

Part B - Find the Tactic

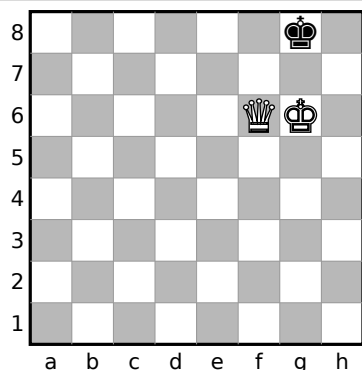
1. White to move. Find the winning move.



2. White to move. Mate in 2.



3. White to move. Mate in 1.

Part C - Basic Checkmate

White to move. Mate in 1.

Write the mating move, and name which basic checkmate pattern this is (see page 85).

COACH'S ANSWER KEY

(cover this strip while you work)

Part A: 1. Queen 2. Knight and bishop 3. x 4. O-O 5. Stalemate 6. Move the king, block the check, capture the checker 7. One move that attacks two or more pieces at once 8. A pawn with no enemy pawn on its file or either neighbouring file in front of it • **Part B:** 1. Nc7+ (fork - wins the rook on a8) 2. Rc8+ Bxc8 Rd8# (deflection mate in 2) 3. Rxd8# (back-rank mate) • **Part C:** Qg7# - the queen mates next to the king, protected by White's own king.

My Progress Report

Well done for reaching the end of **Chess Champion Training Workbook - Level 1**! Fill in your score from every section, then think about what to work on next.

Section	Topic	Pages	My score
1	Chess Foundations	5-14	
2	Know Your Pieces	15-24	
3	Rules & Special Moves	25-32	
4	Piece Values & Trading	33-38	
5	Chess Thinking System	39-46	
6	Tactical Training	47-60	
7	Calculation Training	61-68	
8	Opening Principles	69-75	
9	Middlegame Skills	76-82	
10	Endgame Fundamentals	83-89	
11	Game Analysis	90-94	
12	Tournament Preparation	95-97	

My Chess Skills

Rate yourself honestly from 1 (just starting) to 5 (very confident) for each skill.

Skill	1	2	3	4	5
Knowing how every piece moves					
Understanding check, checkmate and stalemate					
Castling and en passant					
Finding tactics (forks, pins, skewers and more)					
Thinking through a move before playing it					
Basic endgame technique					
Analysing my own games					

What's Next?

1. Which section was your favourite, and why?

2. Which section do you want to practise more?

3. Write one chess goal for the next three months.

Coach / Parent comments: _____

BIRATI CHESS ACADEMY™

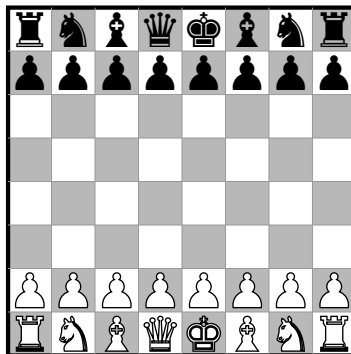
CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION

This certifies that

has successfully completed

CHESS CHAMPION TRAINING WORKBOOK - LEVEL 1

Build Chess Skills, Solve Challenges, Improve Your Game!



Date

Coach Signature

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